The Sūtra of the Renunciation

Abhiniṣkramaṇasūtra · Toh 301 · Derge Kangyur
མདོ་ཡང་འབྱུང་བའི་མདོ

The Sūtra of the Renunciation, known in Sanskrit as the Abhiniṣkramaṇa Sūtra and in Tibetan as Ngönpar Jungwé Do, is a narrative sūtra on the life and lineage of the Buddha, centered on his going forth from household life in pursuit of awakening. It opens with verses of homage to the Three Jewels, praising the Buddha for his boundless generosity in former lives, and goes on to tell the story of the bodhisattva and of the ancestry from which he was born, tracing the Śākya clan back through the Ikṣvāku kings to the founding of Kapilavastu and concluding with the marriage of King Śuddhodana to Queen Mahāmāyā, as the bodhisattva surveys the world from Tuṣita heaven before his final birth. It is Toh 301 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the General Sūtra section, and its colophon records that it was translated by the Indian preceptor Dharmaśrībhadra and the Tibetan translator Rinchen Zangpo.

In the language of India: abhiniṣkramaṇsūtra
In the language of Tibet: The Sūtra of the Renunciation.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

He who gave his own head, glowing with jewels,
And his queen, radiant as an unwithered, opening lotus,
Delighting those who begged, and attained the state of a buddha,
The peaceful one who teaches the Dharma: to him I pay homage.

That which, once found, carries one beyond the fear of the lower realms,
Which brings all the bonds of existence to an end and is peace,
The single bridge that crosses the ocean of saṃsāra with its endless suffering,
The Dharma of the Sugata: to it I pay homage.

Abiding in excellent qualities, it is the field for giving,
Where even a small offering becomes vast;
Praised by the Sugata, adorned by the eight supreme persons,
The noble Saṅgha: to it I pay homage.

When the Sage's words are examined, there is nothing in them at all
That fails to awaken faith or fails to bring benefit.
Yet I lack the power to gather words and to retain them,
And since my mind is scattered, this labor of mine is but slight.

Just as a bee that dwells in the heart of an opened lotus
Circles about and gathers a little from the lotus,
So from the lotus grove of the Sage's mouth
I shall gather a little that delights my own mind.

The Sage's words in their entirety are very hard to fathom;
For a person of faith they grow more vast with every day.
If, on examination, one cannot gauge even the end of half a verse,
What need is there to speak of this collection of a hundred precious sūtras?

When he became a lord of the earth named Prabhāsa,
His fame and renown spread like light in every direction;
Since by the power of his merit he had conquered his enemies, the lesser kings
Bowed down, and the light of their jeweled crowns washed his face.

He saw a lord of elephants, in rut and lusting to mate, seized by desire,
Overcome by affliction, with no means to tame it on the spot.
Wishing to pacify the faults of beings, such as attachment,
He made the aspiration to become a steadfast lord of sages.

From then on, generosity, moral discipline, patience,
Diligence, meditative concentration and unwavering, keen intelligence
He cultivated for a very long time, without regard for his own happiness,
And for the benefit of beings he performed hundreds of very difficult deeds.

However many were the tireless deeds for the good of beings
That this supreme sage, endowed with great compassion, performed in other lives,
Even Śāriputra here could not recount them;
Yet for the sake of some, I shall recount a little.

As the tigress, as Śibi, the elephant, the monkey, the lord of ascetics,
Brahmā and others, he did good over many hundreds of lives.
Then the great being, striving to accomplish every aim, bound to one more birth,
The bodhisattva, took birth in the realm of Tuṣita.

Dwelling there, he looked well upon all beings,
And saw the world pervaded by many who were shelterless, unsteady and in want.
Through great compassion his mind was roused to enthusiasm,

And he contemplated the stream of his own vow to work for the good of others.

Therefore, how he came to the land of humans,
Saw the fears of birth, aging, death and sickness,
Went forth, and with resolute intelligence attained true awakening,
And likewise taught the Dharma, I shall tell. Listen!

Then the bodhisattva who dwelt in the realm of Tuṣita, who over many eons had gathered in many ways immeasurable stores of merit and wisdom and so had completed the accumulations for awakening, who was urged by compassion toward those swept far away by the powerful flood of the afflictions, and who strove constantly to work for the good of others, brought this thought clearly to mind:

"While I wandered through many births, I gave away my own flesh and blood, my head and eyes, my children and wife, in giving and utter giving; I kept difficult moral discipline; I bore patiently the many kinds of disrespect that others inflicted; I had enthusiasm that never slackened; I was unattached to the bliss of meditative absorption and its fruits; and, possessing discernment of the meaning of existence and nonexistence, with an intelligence devoted to the good of others, I generated supreme compassion for wretched creatures whose minds are tormented by many kinds of utterly unbearable painful feelings. Through the power of loving-kindness, in thousands of births such as those as Candraprabha, Śibi, the elephant, Viśvantara, Kṣāntivādin, the lord of monkeys, Sunetra, Mahauṣadha and others, I made aspirations and accumulated merit, thinking: 'How wonderful, and alas! The world is blind, without a guide, without a leader, unrighteous, gone under the sway of desire, pervaded by wrong teachings, its mind overwhelmed by unbearable craving, full of anger, ruined in the thicket of bad views, fettered by jealousy and stinginess, turning its back on taking up good conduct and wholly given over to misconduct. Having become a buddha, I shall ferry across those beings who have not crossed over. I shall free those who are not freed. I shall bring relief to those who have found no relief. I shall bring to complete nirvāṇa those who have not passed into complete nirvāṇa.' This I have long desired, and now the time has come to accomplish that aim. If I look to see what the state of the world is, I will be able to tame it."

Having reflected in this way, "I will be able to tame it," he turned his gaze upon all these worlds: "Who is declining? Who is growing in virtuous qualities? Who has come to harm? Who has become wretched? Who has fallen into suffering? To whom should I give relief through the gift of fearlessness, saying, 'Do not be afraid! Do not be afraid!'? Who is bent toward the lower realms? Who is sliding into the lower realms? Who has fallen into the lower realms? Whom should I draw out of the lower realms and establish in the higher realms and in the fruit of liberation? Who, sunk in the mire of desire, should I pull out by the hand? Who among those bereft of the noble wealth should I establish as lord and master of the noble wealth? Those in whom roots of virtue have not been generated I shall cause to generate them. Those in whom roots of virtue have been generated I shall bring to full ripening. Those who have fully ripened I shall bring to complete liberation."

When he turned upon them the gaze of his wisdom, he saw countless hundreds of thousands of living beings: some in whom roots of virtue had not been generated but who were fit to generate them; some whose roots of virtue had not ripened but who could be brought to full ripening; some whose roots of virtue had fully ripened and who were bent on going to the happy realms; some bent on attaining the first fruit; some bent on attaining the fruit of once-returner, of non-returner, of arhatship, and of solitary awakening; some who had the fortune for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; and some who, having gathered the aspirations of the past, were dependent on a condition, and who, because they had not heard it, had fallen away from the true Dharma.

Having seen this, he thought: "Ah! Over a long time my realization has become complete, and my toil has borne fruit." Rejoicing, he thought: "What I had to do I have done. The burden so hard to bear I have carried to the end. Since I have become a field possessing a fully purified continuum, and the beings to be trained will soon become like a lotus grove, fully ripened and ready to open, not yet touched by the sun, that blossoms when the sun rises, I shall not delay. Since, while staying here, I cannot bring all things to completion, it is not the time to stay. So let me go to the world of humans. Having gone there, with diligence as my companion, I shall realize the unsurpassed wisdom of the Tathāgata. In accordance with their fortunes, I shall cause these beings to generate roots of virtue, bring them to full ripening, and liberate them. Those living beings who have fallen into the ocean of suffering, of birth, aging, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, pain and

mental unhappiness, who are without refuge and without protector, I shall pull out by stretching out the hand of the teaching of the true Dharma. For those utterly burned by the fires of desire, anger and delusion that have clung to them since beginningless time, I shall dispel all suffering, without remainder, by pouring out the flowing water of the noble eightfold path."

Having firmly formed this intention, as he prepared to enter Jambudvīpa he made five kinds of survey: he surveyed caste, country, time, lineage, and the woman.

For what reason do bodhisattvas survey caste? The bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita reflected: "In what kind of caste do bodhisattvas take conception? It is in the brahmin caste or the kṣatriya caste. Of these, sometimes the brahmin caste is honored as the highest, and sometimes the kṣatriya caste." Seeing that at present the kṣatriya caste is honored as the highest, he thought: "So that others will not have grounds to reproach me, saying, 'The bodhisattva took conception in a low caste,' let me take conception in the kṣatriya caste." Thus, because from beginningless time the bodhisattva has performed and accumulated karma that does not lead to disparagement, and because the Dharma taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, is not without fruit, for this reason bodhisattvas survey caste.

For what reason do bodhisattvas survey country? The bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita reflected: "In what kind of country do bodhisattvas take conception?" He looked for a country rich in rice, sugarcane, cattle and buffalo, where hundreds of mendicants gather, where there are no border peoples, where people of the central land dwell, and where, by taming a single person, a great multitude of people would be tamed. Then the bodhisattva thought: "This central country is rich in rows of sugarcane, in rice, cattle and buffalo; hundreds of mendicants gather there; there are no border peoples; people of the central land dwell there; and there, by taming a single person, a great multitude of people will be tamed. So that others will not have grounds to reproach me, saying, 'The bodhisattva took conception in the border lands,' let me take conception in the central country." Thus, because from beginningless time the bodhisattva has performed and accumulated karma that does not lead to disparagement, and because the Dharma taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, is not without fruit, for this reason the bodhisattva surveys country.

For what reason do bodhisattvas survey time? The bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita reflected: "At what kind of time do bodhisattvas take conception in Jambudvīpa?" When the lifespan of beings is increasing, they do not take conception when it reaches eighty thousand years or more; and when the lifespan of humans is decreasing, they do not take conception when it is a hundred years or less. For what reason does a bodhisattva not take conception when the lifespan of humans is eighty thousand years or more? Because when the lifespan of humans is eighty thousand years, they are hard to bring to disenchantment and hard to make weary of existence; they are foolish and of dull faculties; and, being heedless and enjoying much pleasure, they do not become vessels for the truths.

And when the lifespan is decreasing, at a hundred years or less, the five degenerations, namely the degeneration of lifespan, the degeneration of afflictions, the degeneration of beings, the degeneration of views and the degeneration of the age, are predominant. He thought: "So that others will not have grounds to reproach me, saying, 'The bodhisattva took conception at a time when the five degenerations were predominant,' I shall not do so." Thus, because from beginningless time the bodhisattva has performed and accumulated karma that does not lead to disparagement, and because the Dharma taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, is not without fruit, for this reason bodhisattvas survey time.

For what reason do bodhisattvas survey lineage? The bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita reflected: "In what kind of lineage do bodhisattvas take conception?" He looked for a family that is honored as eminent and whose conduct has been without fault through seven generations on both the mother's and the father's side. Then he thought: "This Śākya lineage is honored as eminent, and from the time it was honored by many, its conduct has been without fault. So that others will not have grounds to reproach me, saying, 'The bodhisattva took conception from a low lineage,' let me take conception in the lineage of King Śuddhodana." Thus, because from beginningless time the bodhisattva has performed and accumulated karma that does not lead to disparagement, and because the Dharma taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, is not without fruit, for this reason the bodhisattva surveys lineage.

For what reason do bodhisattvas survey the woman? The bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita reflected: "In the womb of what kind of woman do bodhisattvas take conception?" And he thought: He looked for a woman who is

beautiful in form, of good family, one through whom the family will flourish, not given to anger, not slanderous, not harsh of speech, endowed with faith, good by nature, virtuous in intention, of excellent lineage, of high family, with a family of kinsfolk, excellent in wisdom, excellent in generosity, steady in character, stable by nature, not frivolous and without arrogance, with a mind of loving-kindness, lovely and charming, righteous toward all the world, foremost among all women; one who had made the aspiration before the buddhas of the past, "Ah! May I become the mother of a buddha!"; one able to carry the bodhisattva in her womb for ten months, and one who would not let her own aims decline.

Then the bodhisattva thought: "This Mahāmāyā has been without fault in conduct through seven generations on both her mother's and her father's side; she is endowed with beauty, with good family, with good conduct," and so on as above, up to "foremost among all women"; "she is not given to anger, the family will flourish through her, she is able to carry the bodhisattva in her womb for ten months, and her own aims will not decline. Moreover, Mahāmāyā made the aspiration before the buddhas of the past, 'Ah! May I become the mother of a buddha!' Therefore others will not reproach me, saying, 'The bodhisattva took conception in the womb of a woman with bad marks.'" Thus, because the bodhisattva has performed and accumulated karma that does not lead to disparagement, and because the Dharma taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, is not without fruit, for this reason the bodhisattva surveys women.

Then the bodhisattva, having made the five surveys, said to the classes of gods who live in Tuṣita: "Friends, know this! I shall descend to Jambudvīpa and take conception in the central country. Those of you who seek the deathless, take conception, for the most part, in the six great cities of the central country, namely Śrāvastī, Sāketa, Vaiśālī, Campā, Rājagṛha and Vārāṇasī."

When he had spoken thus, the gods of the Tuṣita class said this to the bodhisattva: "Bodhisattva, please know this! At present the world is stained by evil, beings are of savage intent, and Jambudvīpa is thrown into turmoil by the six dialecticians, the six proclaimers and the six attainers of meditative absorption. Who are the six dialecticians? They are Pūraṇa Kāśyapa, Maskarin Gośālīputra, Sañjayin Vairaṭṭīputra, Ajita Keśakambala, Kakuda Kātyāyana and Nirgrantha Jñātiputra. Who are the six proclaimers? They are the brahmin Illusion-Crosser, the brahmin Ear-Striker, the brahmin Endowed with Goodness, the brahmin Brahmāyus, the brahmin Puṣkarasārin and the brahmin Lohita.

Who are the six attainers of meditative absorption? They are Udraka Rāmaputra, Ārāḍa Kālāma, the wanderer Subhadra, the brahmin youth All-Victorious, the sage Free of Afflictions, and Uruvilvā Kāśyapa the matted-haired ascetic. Here, so that we may hear the Dharma, we shall prepare a seat for you, Bodhisattva, twelve yojanas in size, for we think: 'Since the bodhisattva dwells among us in the realm of Tuṣita, he will teach the Dharma; and once we have heard that Dharma, we shall practice it in whatever way will bring about our long-lasting benefit, welfare and happiness.'"

When they had made this request, the bodhisattva said this to the gods of Tuṣita: "Friends, then strike all the musical instruments!" The gods of the Tuṣita class struck all the musical instruments, and the bodhisattva too blew a conch and said: "Friends, which sound here is the loudest?"

"Blessed One, it is the sound of the conch."

"Friends, just as the sound of the conch overwhelms all the musical instruments, so I too shall go to Jambudvīpa, overwhelm the six dialecticians, the six proclaimers and the six attainers of meditative absorption, and realize the deathless; and with the deathless I shall satisfy beings. I shall blow the conch of impermanence. I shall beat the drum of emptiness. I shall roar the lion's roar of selflessness." Having said this, he spoke again in verse:

"A single lion conquers many hosts of beasts of prey;
A single vajra shatters many mountain peaks;
A single Śakra conquers many lords of the asuras;
A single sun dispels many darknesses.

Friends, those of you who seek the deathless, take conception in the six great cities of the central country."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought: "This bodhisattva intends to take conception in the womb of Queen Mahāmāyā. So let me bestow splendor upon her, and let me also purify her womb." Having thought this, Śakra, lord of the gods, bestowed splendor upon Queen Mahāmāyā and made her womb pure as well.

Then the bodhisattva dwelling in the realm of Tuṣita, having surveyed caste, country, time, lineage and the woman, having made these five surveys, at midnight appeared as an elephant, passed from the realm of the Tuṣita gods, and entered his mother's womb.

At the time when the bodhisattva died and passed from the realm of the Tuṣita gods and entered his mother's womb, this great earth shook violently, and this whole world was lit up by a vast radiance. Even the darkness of the spaces between the worlds, black and pitch-dark, where even the sun and moon, so great in miraculous power and so great in might, cannot shed light with their rays, was at that time lit up by a great radiance. The beings born there, who could not even see their own outstretched hands, saw one another by that light and recognized, "Sirs, other beings too are born here! Sirs, other beings too are born here!"

Just as a vast, well-massed cloud,
Heavy with stored-up water, is stirred by the wind,
So that wise one, dwelling in the womb,
Was like the full moon in the womb of autumn clouds.

When the mighty, peerless one drew near,
Then in the spaces between the continents of the worlds
The covering darkness was dispelled, and in every direction
A great brightness arose: such is the nature of things here.

On the very night when the bodhisattva passed from the realm of the Tuṣita gods and entered his mother's womb, Queen Mahāmāyā saw four dreams: a white baby elephant split open her right side and entered; she walked cross-legged in the sky above; seated on a lion throne, she taught the Dharma to a great multitude of people; and the world with its gods and asuras paid homage to her.

When King Śuddhodana heard this from the queen, he asked the soothsayers what this dream portended, and they said: "May Your Majesty know this! That the queen saw in her dream a white baby elephant split open her right side and enter means that a son who is a wheel-turning king will be born. That she walked in the sky above means that he will be great in miraculous power and great in might. That she sat on a lion throne and taught the Dharma means that he too will sit on a lion throne and teach the Dharma to the fourfold assembly. That the world with its gods and asuras paid homage to her means that if he goes forth, he will be worshiped, honored and praised by the world with its gods and asuras."

It is in the nature of things that, at the time when the bodhisattva passes from the realm of the Tuṣita gods and enters his mother's womb, Śakra, lord of the gods, so that no one, human or nonhuman, may harm her, appoints four sons

of the gods as the mother's guardians: one holding a sword, one holding a spear, one holding a javelin, and one holding a great bow. Of this it is said:

Śakra spoke to the four foremost gods:
"Go, and with respect protect in every way
That mother, supreme among gods and humans,
So that no one may harm her."

They made great effort and, rejoicing,
Received Śakra's command upon the crowns of their heads;
Holding in their hands arrows, spears and swords of every kind,
They protected the mother of the bodhisattva.

Guarded by the four gods, victorious in battle,
Wearing various ornaments day and night,
The queen took her pleasure within her own house
As if she were roaming in the Nandana Grove.

Then, at another time, Queen Mahāmāyā conceived this wish: "Ah! Your Majesty, let all the prisoners be set free!" And King Śuddhodana, heeding the queen's words, set all the prisoners free.

Then, at another time, the queen conceived a wish: "Ah! May Your Majesty give gifts and make merit for the lowly, the blind, the destitute, the wretched and the beggars in the middle of the eastern quarter of the city; and may you give gifts and make merit for the lowly, the blind, the destitute, the wretched and the beggars in the middle of the crossroads to the south, the west and the north."

Then King Śuddhodana, heeding the queen's words, gave gifts in the eastern quarter of the city to the lowly, the blind, the destitute, the wretched and the beggars, according to their wishes and just as they asked, and made merit. Likewise, in the middle of the crossroads to the south, the west and the north, he gave gifts to the lowly, the blind, the destitute, the wretched and the beggars, whatever they wished and just as they asked, and made merit.

When the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had passed from the realm of the Tuṣita gods and dwelt in his mother's womb, he was, like goods placed within a treasury, not soiled by the impurity of the womb, the impurity of mucus, the impurity of blood, or any kind of uncleanness whatever. Just as, for example, a precious jewel is not stained by Kāśī cloth, nor is Kāśī cloth stained by the precious jewel, so, when the bodhisattva dwelt in his mother's womb, he was,

like goods placed within a treasury, not soiled by the impurity of the womb, the impurity of mucus, the impurity of blood, or any kind of uncleanness whatever.

Just as a jewel of colored crystal, luminous and clear,
Is not stained, nor is the spotless Kāśī cloth,
So when the great Sage dwelt in the womb,
The impurity of the womb stained him in no way at all.

When the bodhisattva had passed from the realm of the Tuṣita gods and dwelt in his mother's womb, she saw him dwelling there in her womb, complete in every part. Just as, for example, when a fine, eight-faceted beryl gem of good quality, limpid, clear and flawless, is threaded on a cord of five colors, blue, yellow, red, white and orange, a man with eyes who sees it recognizes, "This is the thread, this is the gem, and the gem is threaded on this thread," so, when the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had passed from the realm of Tuṣita and dwelt in his mother's womb, she saw him dwelling within her womb, complete in every aspect.

Just as a flawless beryl gem,
Luminous and clear, is seen when placed in the hand,
So the great Sage dwelling in his mother's womb
His mother clearly beheld, with knowing and with thought.

It is in the nature of things that, when the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had passed from Tuṣita and dwelt in his mother's womb, his mother did not become weary or fatigued in body from carrying the bodhisattva.

When the ripening of his karma was exhausted, he passed from the higher realm;
When he had entered the womb and dwelt there,
His mother did not carry him with weariness:
Such, at that time, was the nature of things here.

It is in the nature of things that, when the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had passed from the realm of Tuṣita and dwelt in his mother's womb, from then on, for as long as she lived, his mother took up the foundation of the five vows. For as long as she lived she gave up taking life and refrained from taking life. She gave up taking what is not given, unchaste conduct, lying, and grain liquor and fermented liquor, the intoxicants that are a ground for heedlessness; and she refrained from grain liquor and fermented liquor, the intoxicants that are a ground for heedlessness.

Not taking life, not taking what is not given,
Not lying, not craving liquor,
And giving up the unchaste conduct of sexual union:
This is the nature of things for the mother of Siddhārtha.

It is in the nature of things that, when the bodhisattva Śākyamuni had passed from the realm of Tuṣita and dwelt in his mother's womb, his mother did not turn her mind with desire toward men.

She did not become attached to the afflictions,
Her mind was not tormented by the causes of desire,
And that mother did not turn her mind
Toward men endowed with the qualities that are desired.

Then, at another time, Queen Mahāmāyā conceived a wish, thinking, "Ah! I should drink the waters of the four great oceans," and she told King Śuddhodana. King Śuddhodana said to the soothsayers, "Why has the queen conceived such a wish?" The soothsayers explained: "Your Majesty, the queen will give birth to a son whose body is adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being. When he goes forth, he will drink the entire ocean of what is to be known."

King Śuddhodana said, "If she is not given the water of the great oceans to drink, what will happen?"

They said, "She will bear a son whose limbs are incomplete."

The king said, "Should a son of mine, whose name is Śuddhodana, be born with incomplete limbs?" At that time there lived in the city of Kapilavastu a wanderer named Red-Eyes who was skilled in magical illusions. The king summoned him and commanded, "Quickly bring water from the great oceans!" And he, while staying right where he was, drew forth the water of the four great oceans and had the queen drink it, and she was freed of the wish she had conceived.

Then, at another time, Queen Mahāmāyā conceived a wish of this kind, thinking: "Ah! I should go in person into the Lumbinī Grove and stay at the foot of a tree, holding the end of a branch." Then King Śuddhodana, knowing that Queen Mahāmāyā had conceived such a wish, had a palanquin made of the four kinds of precious substances prepared, had the fourfold army of elephant troops, cavalry, chariots and infantry put on armor, and, surrounded by a great multitude of people, set out together with Queen Mahāmāyā and went to the

Lumbinī Grove.

When Queen Mahāmāyā saw the Lumbinī Grove, her mind became one-pointed. She descended from the palanquin, and seeing an aśoka tree in full bloom, joy and delight arose in her. She went over to it, took hold of a branch bending low under the weight of its flowers and leaves, and stood there, surrounded by elderly women.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought: "Queen Mahāmāyā is close to giving birth to her son. So let me receive the bodhisattva when he is first born." Then he thought further: "Queen Mahāmāyā is endowed with modesty, so she will not dare to give birth in front of me. I must arrange some means." Thinking this, Śakra, lord of the gods, transformed himself into the guise of an old woman. He conjured up a fierce wind and rain of such force that those elderly women would flee in the ten directions, and when they had fled, he manifested himself in the guise of an old nurse and stood before Queen Mahāmāyā.

It is the nature of things that a bodhisattva enters his mother's womb knowingly, dwells there knowingly, and emerges knowingly. Then the bodhisattva thought: "It would not be fitting for me to come out through the passage of the womb like an ordinary person. So I shall break through my mother's right side and come forth." Then the bodhisattva broke through his mother's right side and came forth, and Śakra, lord of the gods, received him in his two hands.

The bodhisattva thought, and knew: "This Śakra will grow proud, thinking, 'I received this bodhisattva.'" Knowing this, he blessed his body so that its very nature was the core of a vajra. While in the womb, he had thought, "May my mother not be distressed by carrying me," and so he had made himself light as he dwelt there. Now Śakra, lord of the gods, was unable to hold him, and he trembled. The bodhisattva said, "Kauśika (that is, Śakra), let go, let go!" When he had said this, Śakra, lord of the gods, set the bodhisattva down on the ground.

The very moment he was set down, without anyone holding him, he looked to the four directions, took seven steps toward each, and spoke these words as well: "Kauśika, which direction is this?"
"Bodhisattva, it is the east."
The bodhisattva said, "Kauśika, I shall go before all sentient beings. Which direction is this?"
"It is the south."

"I shall become worthy of the offerings of all beings. Which direction is this?"
"It is the north."
"I shall cross the ocean of existence. Which direction is this?"
"It is the west."
"This will be my last birth."

When the one who puts an end to birth and death was born,
He walked seven steps upon the earth,
And "This has become my final birth,"
So spoke the sole teacher of the three worlds.

It is the nature of things that at the time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni came forth from his mother's womb, this great earth shook violently. This whole world was lit by a vast light. And the darkness between the worlds, gloom upon gloom, pitch-black, where even the sun and moon, so great in magical power and so mighty, cannot give light with their radiance, even those places were at that time lit by a great light. The beings born there, who could not even see their own outstretched hands, saw one another by that light and realized: "Friends, other beings too have been born here! Friends, other beings too have been born here!"

When the Guide was born,
The earth with its mountains shook violently,
And in an instant, throughout the world,
A radiant, illuminating light arose.

Then King Śuddhodana, seeing the great earthquake and the vast light, circumambulated the bodhisattva, bowed at his two feet, and spoke these words: "I have truly gained a great gain, that a son of such great magical power and such might has been born to me."

It is the nature of things that when the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born from his mother's womb, like a sword drawn from its sheath, he was unsoiled by the impurity of the womb, the impurity of the membranes, the impurity of blood, or any other kind of filth whatever.

Just as a fine, clear, radiant crystal
And clean cloth of Kāśī do not soil each other,
So the Sage, when he came forth from the womb,
Was like refined gold drawn out from a great fire.

It is the nature of things that at the time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born from his mother's womb, his mother neither sat nor lay down; standing, that woman of the warrior caste gave birth to one of the warrior caste.

She neither sat nor lay down;
Adorned with the fivefold moral discipline,
She stood, and the supremely virtuous
Youth was received here by Śakra.

It is the nature of things that at the time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born from his mother's womb, the gods held white parasols with jeweled handles above his head.

A parasol like the light of the stainless orb of the moon
The chief of the gods holds above his head,
And with hands ablaze with the rays of bracelets,
They fan him with fine yak-tail whisks.

It is the nature of things that the moment the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born, two streams of water, one cool and one warm, fell from the sky onto the crown of his head, and with them the bodhisattva was bathed.

With stainless, perfectly pure water, cool and likewise warm,
The lord of two-legged beings was bathed,
And to the lineage in which the bodhisattva was born
The nāgas too made offerings.

It is the nature of things that the moment the bodhisattva was born, a great spring appeared before the mother who had given birth and began to flow, and in it his mother performed her ablutions.

When the youth, lord of two-legged beings, was born,
Those gods, their minds filled with joy,
Brought forth fine water there,
And with that water his mother did what was needed.
Divine instruments of sweetest sound
They played in the highest joy;
They scattered garments and garlands,
And others bowed low and likewise sang his praise.

It is the nature of things that the moment the bodhisattva was born, the gods scattered from the sky divine blue lotuses, red lotuses, night lilies, and white lotuses, powdered aloeswood, powdered incense, powdered sandalwood, and

tamāla leaves. They scattered divine māndārava flowers as well. Divine cymbals sounded, and they scattered garments too.

When the Buddha, to whom the wise bow down, was born,
A rain of sweet and supreme fragrances fell,
And then, each with the eloquence that was their own,
With overjoyed minds they spoke their praises:
"This one will attain supreme awakening
And bring beings the benefit of suffering's end.
For beings blinded by the cataract of ignorance,
This supreme physician will bestow the gift of sight.
For beings whose eyes are veiled by delusion, who are blind,
This one will become a great lamp.
To those ruined by wrong views, who have entered false paths,
He will show the straight path they had not sought.
He will block the paths to the lower realms entirely
And open the way to the abodes of the gods."
So the gods who dwell as far as Akaniṣṭha
Proclaimed again and again throughout the abodes of the gods.

At the very time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born, in Śrāvastī a son was born to Aranemi Brahmadatta. Brahmadatta thought: "When my son was born, the land appeared as bright as brightness itself. Therefore his name shall be Prasenajit." And so he named him.

In the city of Rājagṛha a son was born to King Mahāpadma. Mahāpadma thought: "When my son was born, the world appeared as if the orb of the sun had risen, and he is the son of Bimbī. Therefore his name shall be Bimbisāra." And so he named him.

In Kauśāmbī a son was born to King Śatānīka. Śatānīka thought: "When my son was born, the world appeared as if the sun had risen. Therefore his name shall be Udayana." And so he named him.

In the city of Ujjayinī a son was born to King Anantanemi. He thought: "When my son was born, the world became as if lit by a lamp. Therefore his name shall be Pradyota." And so he named him. But it was not as they thought; rather, all of that was the power of the bodhisattva.

At the very time the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born, five hundred Śākya boys, headed by Nanda, were born; five hundred Śākya girls, headed by Yaśodharā, were born; five hundred attendants, headed by Chandaka, were

born; and five hundred horses, headed by Kaṇṭhaka, were foaled. The gods also revealed the openings of five treasures. The petty kings of the provinces and the kings of the fortified towns bowed down deeply, and all of them paid tribute.

Then King Śuddhodana thought: "Since every wish was fulfilled when my son was born, this boy's name shall be Sarvārthasiddha, 'He Who Accomplishes Every Aim.'" Thus he first gave the bodhisattva his name.

It is the nature of things that the moment the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was born, his father and mother presented him to the brahmins who read bodily marks and interpret omens, and it was declared: "Sirs, a boy who possesses these has two destinies and no other. If, as a householder, he remains at home, he will become a wheel-turning king, victorious over the four quarters, a Dharma king who rules by the Dharma, possessed of the seven precious things. These will be his seven precious things: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious queen, the precious householder, and seventh, the precious minister. He will have a thousand sons, heroic and valiant, of supreme form in every limb, crushers of hostile armies. He will conquer this entire great earth, as far as the ocean, in accordance with the Dharma, and will dwell ruling over it, where none dares to do harm, free of violence, without punishment, and without the striking of weapons. But if he shaves off his hair and beard, puts on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, goes forth from home into homelessness, then his name will resound throughout the world as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha. Endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great man, so he truly is, Your Majesty."

From "A boy endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great man has two destinies and no other" up to "he will be known in the world as a perfectly complete buddha": as before, this is the nature of things here.

Concerning this it is said:

When the prince was born, the king questioned
The brahmins who know the marks of a man, and then they spoke:
"If the prince should remain at home,
He will surely become a lord of men,
Valiant, and a wheel-turning king
Holding sway over all other kings.
He will exercise a righteous kingship,

Victorious throughout all the continents.
This precious one, the best of men, will obtain
The seven precious things through the karma of his merit,
And by their power he will rule
The entire earth, his command never broken.

"Well wrought of gold, its hub perfectly round,
With a thousand spokes and a fine, unbroken rim,
That which first conquers the earth:
That wheel he will obtain first.
Well formed in every limb, standing firm upon the ground,
The best of elephants, like a peak of the snowy mountains,
Worthy of a king, traveling through the sky:
That supreme precious thing he will obtain second.
That which at dawn circles all the lands
In every direction and then returns,
With a coat as lovely as a peacock's neck:
That precious horse he will obtain.
A stainless gem whose nature is beryl,
Shedding light a full league all around,
Stainless, making the night just like the day:
That fourth supreme precious thing he will obtain.
She who has fragrance, touch, beauty and radiance,
A noble woman, foremost among the proud,
Endowed, like a goddess, with every virtue:
That precious woman he will obtain here.
And the householder who here offers the king
Pearls and gold and much else besides,
Rich in wealth like the lord of riches:
That precious one he will obtain and enjoy.
Skilled in advancing, in holding firm and in retreating
With the entire army,
The heroic seventh who will appear
Is called the precious minister among men.
A thousand sons will be born to him,
Heroic, valiant, of supreme form in every limb,
Whose splendor and strength are very great,

And to whom other lords of the earth will bow.

"But if, finding the household troubled by many faults,
As a bird forsakes a blazing tree,
He goes forth to the forest for the sake of peace,
Then before long he will become a buddha here.
This son of yours born today,
Such a youth, a unique jewel among beings,
Will go to no destiny other than these two:
So it is seen in the words of the sacred verses."

"Sirs, what are the thirty-two marks of a great man, endowed with which a great man has two destinies and no other," and so on as before, up to "his fame will resound throughout the world"?

"Your Majesty, the prince's feet are well planted. Because his two feet are well planted, they touch the ground evenly. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"On the soles of both his feet there are wheels with a thousand spokes, with hub and rim, complete in every aspect. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's fingers are long, the heels of his feet are broad, and his hands and feet are soft and tender. His hands and feet are as soft and tender as the down of the silk-cotton tree or the down of cotton. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's hands and feet are webbed. His hands and feet are webbed like those of a young king of geese. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's ankle joints do not protrude, his calves are like those of the eṇeya antelope, his body is well knit, and when he stands upright without bending, his hands reach and touch his two kneecaps. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's private parts are withdrawn into a sheath. His private parts are withdrawn into a sheath like those of a thoroughbred elephant or a thoroughbred horse just born. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's arm span is as great as his height, and his height is as great as his arm span, so that, like a banyan tree, his height and breadth are in perfect proportion. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, on the prince's upper body the hairs grow one by one, and the hairs that grow one by one on his body are dark blue and curl to the right. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince is golden in color, has a radiance extending a fathom, and his skin is fine and golden in hue. Because his skin is fine, dust and dirt do not cling to his body. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's body has seven prominent parts. The seven prominent parts with which his body was born are his two hands, his two feet, his two shoulders, and the nape of his neck. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the area between the prince's shoulders is full, his upper body is like a lion's, his body is straight and of large frame, his shoulders are perfectly rounded, he has forty teeth, his teeth are even, his teeth are closely set, his canine teeth are very white, his jaw is like a lion's, and he has the supreme sense of taste. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince's tongue is very long and thin. Because his tongue is so long and so thin, when he extends it from his mouth it covers the entire circle of his face as far as the hairline. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, the prince has the voice of Brahmā, pleasing like the song of the kalaviṅka bird, and resonant as a drum. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man."

"Your Majesty, the prince's eyes are deep blue, his eyelashes are like a cow's, he has the crown protuberance (uṣṇīṣa), and the tuft of hair between his eyebrows is white as a conch and curls to the right. Your Majesty, this is a mark of a great man, the prince's mark of a great man.

"Your Majesty, these are the thirty-two marks of a great man, endowed with which one has two destinies and no other," and so on as before, up to "his fame will resound throughout the world."

The marks of the Great Sage,
Who has cultivated himself well
And holds in his body
The last of his bodies:
These I shall now declare.
His feet are well planted
And touch the ground evenly.
On the soles of his feet and the palms of his hands
Wheels of perfect shape have appeared.
The heels of his feet are broad,
And his fingers long and beautiful.
His hands and feet are webbed
And soft as cotton down.
His ankle joints do not protrude,
And his calves are like the eṇeya antelope's.
Without bending his body, the best of men
Reaches his kneecaps with his hands.
His private parts are withdrawn into a sheath.
Like a banyan, his height and breadth are in proportion.
The hairs of his upper body grow
One by one, and these hairs curl to the right.
His color is like refined gold,
And he has a radiance a fathom wide all around.
The Blessed One's skin is fine,
And seven parts of his body are prominent.
The Blessed One's shoulders are full between,
His upper body like a lion's,
His body straight and of large frame,
His shoulders perfectly rounded.
His teeth, four times ten,
Are complete, with none missing;
Even and closely set,
His teeth are well placed
And very white. His jaw is like a lion's,
He has the supreme sense of taste,
His tongue is very thin,
And the Blessed One has the voice of Brahmā.
His eyelashes are like a cow's, his eyes deep blue,

And the tuft of hair between his eyebrows
Is white as a conch and curls to the right.
Whoever comes to possess
These thirty-two excellent marks
Will have two destinies;
There will be no third.
If he remains at home,
He will become a wheel-turning king,
With many mindful sons,
With few troubles, and wise.
If he goes forth, a perfect buddha,
A person without equal, he will become.
Food and drink, clothing,
And bedding he will receive,
His retinue will never be divided,
And he will delight the hearts of all embodied beings.
The gods will follow him,
And so will humans.
He will become the supreme lord of the Dharma,
And so too throughout the human lands.
Without equal and without peer,
The Guide will be unmatched.

"Your Majesty, these are the prince's marks of a great man." The words "endowed with which one has two destinies and no other," and the rest, are as before.

It is the nature of things that when seven days had passed after the birth of the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, the mother who bore him passed away, and immediately upon passing she was reborn in splendor among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

Then King Śuddhodana entrusted the bodhisattva to nurses: "Nurses, massage this boy at the proper times, bathe him at the proper times, feed him at the proper times, and at the proper times attend to him with every true comfort." The nurses received him joyfully into their two hands, and at the proper times they massaged him, at the proper times bathed him, at the proper times fed him, and at the proper times attended to him with every true comfort.

Then, at that time, having anointed him with the most delightfully fragrant substances there were and adorned him with every ornament, they presented him to his father Śuddhodana. King Śuddhodana received him, set him joyfully on his lap, gazed at him again and again, and was filled with joy.

It is the nature of things that the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was handsome, beautiful and lovely to behold, having entirely surpassed the complexion of humans, though not attaining the complexion of the gods. When men and women gazed at him, they could never have enough, and they were filled with joy. Just as gold from the Jambū River, worked into an ornament by a skilled smith and placed upon a fresh white woolen cloth, is exceedingly bright, blazing and gleaming, so the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was handsome, beautiful and lovely to behold, having surpassed the complexion of humans, though not attaining the complexion of the gods.

It is the nature of things that the bodhisattva Śākyamuni became dear and delightful to the hearts of a great multitude of people. And this great multitude passed him from shoulder to shoulder, just as an autumn lotus, being dear and delightful to the hearts of a great multitude of people, is passed by that great multitude from hand to hand; and so on as before.

It is the nature of things that from the moment of his birth the bodhisattva looked at forms without blinking. In not blinking his eyes, he was like the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

It is the nature of things that from the moment of his birth the bodhisattva, with the divine eye born from the ripening of his former karma, saw for a full league all around, by day and by night.

With his stainless eye, born of karma,
Forms both great and very subtle,
By day and by night, a league all around,
He sees as though they stood before him.

It is the nature of things that from the moment of his birth the bodhisattva's voice was sweet and charming, his voice melodious, his voice delightful. Just as the song of the bird of the snowy mountains is sweet and charming, melodious and delightful, so from the moment of his birth the bodhisattva's voice was sweet and charming, his voice melodious, his voice delightful.

On Mount All-Bearing there lived a sage named Asita, possessed of the five superknowledges, loving by nature, full of compassion, and kind and gentle

toward all creatures. He had a nephew named Naradatta. At that time, while the sage had entered a cave and was meditating, the bodhisattva was born. When Naradatta saw the light by which the whole world was lit with a vast radiance, he said to Asita:

"Master, have all the suns
Risen here at once?
For this mountain, with its caves,
Has been lit up with light."

Asita said to him:

"The light of the sun is always harsh.
My son, these lights
Are cool when they touch the limbs,
So surely this is the light of that Sage.
The radiant bodhisattva
Has surely been born from the womb,
And now that he is born, the great being's
Rays, which are like gold,
Stainless as they are,
Have lit up the three worlds."

Naradatta said, "Master, go! See for yourself whether he will become a wheel-turning king or whether he will realize unsurpassed wisdom."

The sage Asita said, "At present the house of King Śuddhodana is thronged all around with countless hundreds of thousands of regional kings, kings of fortified towns, merchants, guild masters, caravan leaders, brahmins and householders. When it has become quiet, then I shall go to King Śuddhodana."

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "Alas, how unfitting it would be if the sage Asita were to come to Kapilavastu on foot!"

Then the sage Asita rose up into the sky above and came to the gate of King Śuddhodana's palace. In due course the gatekeeper announced to King Śuddhodana, "May it please Your Majesty: the sage Asita has come here." When King Śuddhodana heard this, he was glad, delighted, overjoyed and supremely pleased. He honored the sage with the utmost reverence and said, "Welcome, great sage! For what purpose have you come?"

Asita said:

"Great king, I have come here
To see your son.
I long to see that Sage,
The lord of the world, the Guide."

The king said, "If that is so, wait a while until the prince, who is asleep, awakens."

Asita said:

"Just as thoroughbred horses
Sleep only a quarter of the night,
So the sleep of those intent upon a purpose
Does not stay long in their eyes."

Then the prince Śākyamuni, who was sitting on his nurse's lap, was handed to the sage Asita. The sage Asita received him in both hands, examined him for a moment, and said, "Your Majesty, what have the readers of marks prophesied about this prince?"

King Śuddhodana said, "They say that he will become a wheel-turning king possessed of the seven precious things."

Then the sage Asita, looking at the bodhisattva, spoke in verse:

"Lord of the earth, those examiners are mistaken in their judgment:
In the age of strife no wheel-turning king appears.
This treasury of the Dharma, through supreme merit,
Will triumph over all evil and become a buddha.
One whose marks are not clear becomes a lord of men,
The mighty master of the four continents;
But since the marks of this Lord of Sages are perfectly clear,
The best of men will become a buddha and turn the wheel of Dharma."

Then the sage Asita set about examining the certain end of his own life and the bodhisattva's full awakening. He saw that the bodhisattva, at the age of twenty-nine, would leave his home and practice austerities for six years, and then would realize the deathless. And seeing that he himself would die in the meantime, his eyes filled with tears. When King Śuddhodana saw him so, he was alarmed and spoke in verse:

"He whom men and women gaze upon
And can never have enough of, and are filled with joy:
Now that you have seen him here, fair of body, bringer of good,

Why, great sage, do you seem to weep?
Is there not some danger close at hand
To my prince, or that his life will be cut short?
Tell me of it quickly and plainly,
For your tears make me tremble."

The sage Asita also spoke in verse:

"Even if from the sky upon him
A fierce hail of vajras were hurled down,
It could not stir even a single hair
On the body of the Great Sage.
A great fire driven by the force of the wind,
Sharp weapons, utterly unbearable,
Deadly poison and the sharp venom of snakes:
Should these fall upon the prince, he would not fear for an instant.
He who abides in compassion itself
Grants fearlessness to those tormented by fear.
Since he destroys the fears of the whole world,
How could fear arise for this lord of men?
That great being who has become foremost
Among the great beings of the world,
Whom even the gods together with Brahmā always protect:
How could fear arise for that lord of men?
Lord of men, it is my own misfortune that I see,
For I myself shall not attain that peace.
Having met with this supreme treasury of the Dharma,
I shall die without attaining the goal.
Those who will hear the Dharma of this one,
The peerless and excellent speaker, and having heard it
Will go to the far shore of perfect peace:
They are happy and blessed with merit, and free from every plague."

Then, through the power of having touched the bodhisattva, the sage Asita's magical powers waned. When they had waned, Asita said, "I shall have to leave the city on foot alone."

When King Śuddhodana heard this, he had the entire city cleared of stones, gravel and potsherds, and had it strewn everywhere with incense and fragrant

powders.

Then the sage Asita, with his great magnificence, came out of the city and gradually made his way to Mount All-Bearing. There he said to Naradatta, "I have seen the prince. When he realizes unsurpassed wisdom, I shall not live to see it, for I shall die in the meantime. You must go forth into homelessness in his presence. Utterly crush pride and arrogance, and practice the pure conduct of celibacy. Do not be arrogant on account of your caste, do not be arrogant on account of your clan, and do not be arrogant on account of your lineage. Before long you too will attain the deathless nectar." Having said this, he spoke again in verse:

"If you wish to seek the Tathāgata,
Stay in the eastern region,
And you will see the perfect Buddha,
The renowned one, so hard to find."

Then, at another time, King Śuddhodana looked again and again at the prince sitting on his nurse's lap, thinking, "There is no one on the face of the earth like my son," and he was overjoyed.

Not long after the bodhisattva was born, as he sat on his nurse's lap eating a meal of rice mixed with curds from a golden bowl, the nurse tried to stop him but could not, and he ate a great deal. She set about taking the bowl away from him, but she was unable to take it. So she told King Śuddhodana, and the king, together with the queen, set about taking it away, but they too were unable. Then the king commanded his ministers and the people living in Kapilavastu, but they too were unable to take it away. Then it was tied to five hundred elephants. The bodhisattva thought, "It would not do for my strength to be overcome by these. I shall hold the golden bowl by crooking my little finger." He crooked his finger, held on to the golden bowl and pulled, and the five hundred elephants were turned around and dragged backward, and even they were unable to take the golden bowl away.

King Śuddhodana thought, "Since the bodhisattva's left hand alone has pulled five hundred elephants, then with both hands he could without doubt match a thousand elephants. Therefore the prince shall be named One with the Strength of a Thousand Elephants." And so he was named.

In the city of Kapilavastu there dwelt from of old a yakṣa called Śākyavardhana. It was the custom among the Śākyas that whenever a boy or girl was born to any Śākya, the child would be brought to bow at the feet of

the yakṣa Śākyavardhana. So the king commanded his ministers, "Wise ones, today have the prince bow at the feet of the yakṣa Śākyavardhana."

Then the bodhisattva was mounted on an elephant and, surrounded by countless troops, set out to enter the city of Kapilavastu. The city of Kapilavastu became free of twelve sounds, and when the bodhisattva entered it, it remained still, like a sage. Then King Śuddhodana thought, "This city has become free of twelve sounds: the sound of elephants, the sound of horses, the sound of chariots, the sound of foot soldiers, the sound of conches, the sound of great drums, the sound of kettledrums, the sound of horns, the sound of dancing, the sound of singing, the sound of music, and the sound of the call, 'Give gifts! Make merit! Observe the fast! Take up and keep moral discipline!' Free of these twelve sounds, it remained peaceful, like a sage, when the prince entered it. Therefore the prince shall be named Śākyamuni, Sage of the Śākyas." And so the bodhisattva was named Śākyamuni.

Then the bodhisattva was carried into the presence of the yakṣa Śākyavardhana, and the yakṣa Śākyavardhana saw the bodhisattva drawing near to his shrine. Seeing him, he came out and prostrated, touching the bodhisattva's two feet with his whole body. When King Śuddhodana saw this, he said, "Since even a god touches his feet, he is the god of gods. Therefore the prince shall be called God of Gods." And so the bodhisattva was named God of Gods.

At that time King Śuddhodana, sitting for the purpose, discerned with wisdom words and letters of profound meaning.

Then the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, together with a retinue of five hundred, was sent to the writing master Worm Armor to learn letters. The writing master Worm Armor wrote out a letter and showed it to the bodhisattva, and the bodhisattva said, "This one I know." Then he wrote out two letters, then three, and in the same way up to five hundred, and showed them to him, and the bodhisattva said, "All of these too I know. Tell me others."

Worm Armor said, "Only this many letters are used in the world. Others I do not know."

Then the bodhisattva himself wrote out a letter, gave it to Worm Armor, and said, "Tell me what this letter is called."

He replied, "I do not know."

The bodhisattva said, "It becomes manifest when two have appeared in the world: a bodhisattva and a wheel-turning monarch."

Brahmā, standing in the sky, said, "Worm Armor, it is just as the bodhisattva has said. This script becomes manifest when two have appeared in the world: a bodhisattva or a wheel-turning king."

The bodhisattva read that script aloud with the voice of Brahmā, and because Brahmā, standing in the sky, had mastery over it, it came to be called the Brahmā script.

Then, when the bodhisattva had mastered letters, he and his retinue of five hundred were entrusted to the archery masters called Good Taker and With the Gods, at the archery ground. There the bodhisattva became trained in the five skills: hitting from afar, hitting so that a sound rings out, hitting the vital spot, hitting without missing, and shooting with great force.

Then Good Taker and With the Gods thought, "This bodhisattva is compassionate, so we shall teach him everything there is to teach. But this Devadatta is malicious, and it would not do for him to bring harm to the whole world. So we shall not teach him how to strike the vital spot."

Then, at another time, Devadatta shot a goose with an iron arrow, and it fell into the lap of the bodhisattva, who was sitting on the upper terrace of the palace. The bodhisattva took hold of it, drew out the arrow and anointed it with medicine, and it recovered. Devadatta said, "Bodhisattva, this goose is mine, since I took it. Send it back!"

The bodhisattva said, "I took it long before you. I took it at the very moment I first resolved upon unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

At this, Devadatta felt malice toward the bodhisattva, impatience and unease.

Then five hundred Śākya youths, Devadatta among them, came out, and Devadatta girded himself with a cloth and threw down the five hundred Śākya youths. Some time later the bodhisattva went to that place, and Devadatta said, "Bodhisattva, why do you hold back?" So the bodhisattva also girded himself with a cloth and threw down the five hundred Śākya youths. Then Devadatta girded himself, and the bodhisattva seized him, turned his feet toward the sky and threw him flat on his back. At this, Devadatta conceived toward the bodhisattva malice, impatience and unease a second time.

Then the five hundred Śākya youths went outside carrying bows and arrows and set about shooting at palmyra trees. Some pierced one palmyra tree,

some pierced two, and Devadatta pierced three. The bodhisattva shot an iron arrow and pierced seven palmyra trees, and so on, to be told at length, up to the point where they were shaken by the wind until they all fell down.

Now on the bank of the Rohitaka River there was a tree called Essence of Virtue, which grew a hundred cubits in a single day. At night it could be cut even with a fingernail, but by day it could not be cut even with a weapon. The gods of the Pure Abodes conjured up a wind and a violent rainstorm of such force that it uprooted the Essence of Virtue tree and cast it into the Rohitaka.

When King Śuddhodana and Suprabuddha heard of this, they thought, "Might this tree not destroy the city?" They went, together with countless hundreds of thousands of beings, to where the Essence of Virtue tree lay. But although it was dragged by countless hundreds of thousands of people, they could not move it even a little.

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, tell the bodhisattva."

The king said, "I cannot command the prince."

Udāyin said, "Then all of you raise a loud and great uproar. One way or another I shall get the bodhisattva to come."

Then that crowd of people raised a great uproar with loud voices. Udāyin went to the bodhisattva, and the bodhisattva said, "Udāyin, what is this uproar?" Udāyin explained to him in detail all that had happened. Then the bodhisattva said, "If that is so, let us go and pull it out."

So Udāyin and the bodhisattva set out, and after a while a venomous snake came out of a hole. Thinking, "It may seize the bodhisattva," Udāyin cut it through the middle with a sharp sword. The poisonous breath of the snake struck Udāyin and he turned black, and so he came to be called Kālodāyin, Black Udāyin.

Then the bodhisattva went to where the Essence of Virtue tree was, and said to Devadatta, "Let us see how strong you are. Move it!" Devadatta strained and shifted it a little. Nanda dragged it a little. Then the bodhisattva put forth his strength, lifted the Essence of Virtue tree with his hand and threw it up from the bank of the Rohitaka River. The bodhisattva said, "Wise ones, this Essence of Virtue tree is by nature cooling. If it is applied to bile diseases, swellings and blisters, they will be soothed. Cut it into pieces, carry them off and keep them in your homes."

Again, a precious elephant was born in Vaiśālī. The Licchavis of Vaiśālī found an elephant endowed with the auspicious marks, and they thought, "The son of King Śuddhodana has been prophesied by the sign readers to become a wheel-turning king. It is through his power that this precious elephant has appeared. Let us go and offer it to him."

They adorned the elephant with every ornament, led it off and gradually reached Kapilavastu, where they stationed the excellent elephant at the gate of the royal palace and waited. By chance Devadatta, the doer of wicked deeds, came out. When he saw the excellent elephant so adorned with ornaments, great jealousy arose in him, and with jealousy and impatience he asked, "Whose is this excellent elephant?"

They said, "The assembly of Vaiśālī has offered this precious elephant as a gift to Prince Śākyamuni, whom the sign readers have prophesied will become a wheel-turning king."

Devadatta grew all the more impatient and said, "He has not even become a wheel-turner yet, and already you are offering him a precious elephant?" With that, he killed the elephant with a slap of his palm.

After a while Nanda came to that place. Seeing it, he asked, "Wise ones, who killed this fine elephant?"

They said, "Devadatta."

He thought, "Devadatta has surely shown his might upon this. I too shall show my might upon it." He seized it by the tail and flung it seven paces.

After a while the bodhisattva Śākyamuni came out. Seeing it, he asked, "Where did this elephant come from?" They told him what had happened.

"Who killed it?"

"Devadatta."

"Is this how hospitality is shown to guests? A fine thing he has done! Where was it killed?"

"Over there."

"Who dragged it here?"

"Nanda."

He thought, "Those two have surely shown their might upon this. I too shall show my might upon it." Having thought this, he seized it by the tail and flung

it over the wall, so that it passed over seven walls and seven moats before it landed. Where it fell it made a hollow, and that hollow came to be called the Elephant Pit. On this it is said:

Devadatta slew the lord of elephants;
Nanda dragged it seven paces;
The bodhisattva, with his hand, through the sky
Hurled it far outside, as if it were a stone.

The sign readers had prophesied: "If the prince does not go forth into homelessness before the age of twelve, he will become a wheel-turning king."

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "What if I were to give him the five qualities of sensual pleasure in abundance? Then, delighting in them, he will not go forth." So King Śuddhodana set heaps of clothing and ornaments before the bodhisattva and said, "Today you are to give these ornaments and clothes to the Śākya maidens." Then King Śuddhodana had it proclaimed by bell throughout the city of Kapilavastu: "Today the prince will give away clothing and ornaments. Let all the Śākya maidens come!"

Then five hundred Śākya maidens came, and the bodhisattva gave clothing and ornaments to them all.

Now the Śākya Daṇḍapāṇi had a daughter called Yaśodharā, and he said to her, "The prince will give clothing and ornaments to you as well, so go." Yaśodharā thought, "Who but the bodhisattva will be my husband?" and went to the bodhisattva. By then all the clothing and ornaments had been given away and nothing at all was left. But she saw that one exceedingly beautiful and precious pearl necklace remained on the bodhisattva's neck. Delighted with it, she untied it herself without the least shyness, fastened it around her own neck, and left the bodhisattva's presence.

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "This girl is confident and steady. She will be able to fall in with the prince's mind, so she shall be taken." And so Yaśodharā, with a retinue of twenty thousand women, was taken as the bodhisattva's wife.

King Śuddhodana said to the bodhisattva, "Go and see how far the working estates extend."

The bodhisattva, heeding King Śuddhodana's command, mounted a fine chariot and went outside to view the working estates of his father King Śuddhodana. When he came to the people at work on the estates, he saw five hundred ploughs tilling the fields. The farmers too, pressing down and pulling

the ploughs, were utterly drained of strength, their heads and bodies covered in dust, their bodies rough and their complexions poor from being scorched by wind and heat, their feet and hands cracked. They wore threadbare and filthy clothes, their feet were filthy, and they were sallow with hunger and thirst, their throats, cheeks and the sides of their eyes dried up. And he saw the oxen too: their bodies torn by goads with sharp iron points, so that their backs and hindquarters were covered in blood; panting with hunger and thirst, drawing long, labored breaths from deep in the chest; pus and blood oozing from the sores where the yoke pressed on them, eaten by swarms of flies and insects; their feet wounded by the iron ploughshares; saliva and mucus dripping from their mouths and noses, and covered with flies, gadflies and long-beaked mosquitoes.

Seeing this, with a heart stirred through and through by the compassion that he had generated and gathered as merit from beginningless time, he spoke these words to the farmers: "Good people, to whom do you belong?"

They answered, "We belong to the bodhisattva."

He said, "Good people, from this day on you shall not be slaves, nor shall you be servants. Be free, go wherever you please, and live in the enjoyment of happiness."

He also unyoked the oxen and said, "And you too, from this day on, eat the finest unspoiled grass and drink clear water unmuddied by dust. May cool breezes rise for you from all four directions."

Then the bodhisattva, wearied by what he had seen, looked out over the edge of the fields of his father, the Śākya Śuddhodana, and went to where there stood a rose-apple tree, glossy and green, thick with leaves and giving good shade. Sitting in the shade of the rose-apple tree, he entered into the first meditative concentration: secluded from sensual desires, secluded from evil and unwholesome states, accompanied by initial thought and by investigation, with the joy and bliss born of seclusion, resembling the undefiled.

The great crowd of people did not go near the bodhisattva but stayed apart, beneath other trees.

King Śuddhodana thought, "The bodhisattva has been gone a long time, and the morning is already past. I shall go and look for him." He mounted his chariot and went to the farmers' village, searched here and there for the bodhisattva, and came to the rose-apple tree.

By then the sun had passed midday, and the shadows of the other trees were leaning toward the east, slanting toward the east, and had moved over to the east. But through the bodhisattva's power, the shadow of the rose-apple tree did not leave the bodhisattva's body. King Śuddhodana saw that, although the sun had passed midday and the shadows of the other trees were leaning, slanting and had moved over toward the east, the shadow of the rose-apple tree did not leave the bodhisattva's body. Seeing this, he thought, "The prince has great magical powers and great might. Now that the sun has passed midday, the shadows of the other trees are leaning toward the east, slanting toward the east, and have moved over to the east, yet the shadow of the rose-apple tree does not leave the bodhisattva's body. How great a wonder!"

Then, with joyful reverence, he touched the bodhisattva's two feet and spoke in verse:

"As the earth shook on the day of your birth,
So the rose-apple's shade does not leave your body:
Great-minded one, these are your two marvels.
All-seeing one, I bow down at your feet."

Then the bodhisattva rose from that meditative absorption and mounted his chariot. After a while the guardians of treasure, with long hair, beards and nails, came carrying treasures to where the bodhisattva was, and when they arrived they said to the bodhisattva, "Lord, please accept these treasures."

The bodhisattva said, "Whose are these?"

"Lord, they belonged to men who have passed away."

The bodhisattva said, "Enough of these. What did it profit those fools to hold on to them for a while? I have no need of you. Go!" And he also spoke in verse:

"Those who told me tales of death
Have themselves become tales of the dead.
And I too, not long after I die,
Will become a tale told by others."

They cried out again, "Prince, if you will not accept them, we shall enter the great ocean."

The bodhisattva said, "Enter it as you please," and they entered the great ocean.

Then the gods of the Pure Abodes thought, "Bodhisattvas have the power of the cause, but even so the conditions must be brought about, for even the great power of the cause depends on the power of conditions." So, as the bodhisattva was passing through a charnel ground, the gods showed him a corpse that was bluish, festering, worm-eaten, bloated and gnawed. When the bodhisattva saw it, weariness with the world arose in him.

Then King Śuddhodana had the bodhisattva enter the city of Kapilavastu by another road. Crowds of women of the city of Kapilavastu were watching the bodhisattva from windows, lattice windows and balconies. Gopikā, daughter of the Śākya Good Time, was sitting on the upper terrace of a mansion, and as she gazed at the bodhisattva she dug into the ground with her big toe until it bled, yet she did not feel it. As the bodhisattva in turn gazed at Gopikā, he crushed an arrow to powder in his right hand. The charioteer handed him an iron arrow, and that too he crushed to powder. Then King Śuddhodana thought, "She will be able to fall in with the prince's mind."

Then, as the charioteer drove on, Mṛgajā, daughter of the Śākya Bell Sound, saw the bodhisattva passing by in his chariot. She too was sitting on the upper terrace of a mansion, and she spoke in verse:

"Ah, blissful is his mother,
And his father too is blissful indeed;
Ah, the woman who becomes his wife,
She too has found nirvāṇa."

That supreme being, the meditator,
Hearing the word nirvāṇa,
And knowing nirvāṇa to be peace itself,
Was delighted in his heart by it.

Then the bodhisattva, having heard the word nirvāṇa, was pleased with Mṛgajā. He took a pearl necklace from his neck and threw it to her, and there in the chariot he entered into meditative concentration. The necklace landed and clung around her neck. Then King Śuddhodana thought, "She will be able to fall in with the bodhisattva's mind." So Gopikā, surrounded by twenty thousand women, and Mṛgajā, also surrounded by twenty thousand women, were taken as the bodhisattva's wives. Thus there came to be sixty thousand wives, Yaśodharā, Gopikā, Mṛgajā and the rest.

The sign readers prophesied, "If the bodhisattva does not go forth within seven years, he will become a wheel-turning king." Then King Śuddhodana thought,

"What if I were to give the bodhisattva the five qualities of sensual pleasure in abundance?" And he gave them in abundance. The sign readers prophesied, "If the bodhisattva does not go forth within seven months, he will certainly become a wheel-turning king." Then King Śuddhodana gave the bodhisattva the five qualities of sensual pleasure in still greater abundance, thinking, "In this way too, delighting in them, he will not go forth."

It is the way of things that when the bodhisattva wishes to go to the pleasure grove, he says to the charioteer, "O charioteer, quickly make ready a fine carriage, and riding in it we shall go to the pleasure grove." And so the bodhisattva commanded the charioteer, "O charioteer, quickly make ready a fine carriage, and riding in it we shall go to the pleasure grove."

"As my lord commands," said the charioteer, obeying the bodhisattva Śākyamuni. He quickly made ready a fine carriage, went to where the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was, and said to the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, "My lord, the fine carriage is ready. My lord, please consider that the time for it has come."

Then the bodhisattva Śākyamuni mounted the fine carriage and set out for the pleasure grove. And the bodhisattva Śākyamuni saw a man worn out with age, bent and crooked as a rafter, tottering, leaning forward on a staff, trembling as he walked, his hair grey, quite unlike other people. Seeing him, he said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, what is this man worn out with age, bent and crooked as a rafter, tottering, leaning forward on a staff, trembling as he walks, his hair grey, quite unlike other people?"

"My lord, this man is what is called old."

"Charioteer, what is this called old?"

"My lord, this man will die before long, and so he is called old."

"Charioteer, am I too not beyond the condition of aging, the nature of aging?"

"My lord too is not beyond the condition of aging, the nature of aging."

"Charioteer, then turn the chariot around. We shall go back to the palace. For once I have reached the palace, I must reflect on this very matter that has been spoken: that I am not beyond old age."

The charioteer turned the chariot around and set off for the palace. There the bodhisattva Śākyamuni entered the palace and, thinking, "Consider: I too am not beyond old age!", was displeased and brooded unhappily. On this it is said:

Seeing a man past his prime, aged, bent and grey-headed,
Holding a staff in his hand,
And hearing it said, "I am not beyond this old age,"
He then was displeased and brooded unhappily.

Then King Śuddhodana said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, did the prince go out to the pleasure grove glad at heart and content? Did he delight in the pleasure grove?"

"No, Your Majesty."

"Why was that?"

"Your Majesty, as the prince was going to the pleasure grove, he saw a man worn out with age, bent and crooked as a rafter, tottering, leaning forward on a staff, trembling as he walked, his hair grey, quite unlike other people. Seeing him, he said these words to me: 'Charioteer, what is this man worn out with age, bent and crooked as a rafter, tottering, leaning forward on a staff, trembling as he walks, his hair grey, quite unlike other people?' To that I replied, 'My lord, this is what is called old.' He said, 'Charioteer, what is this called old?' To that I replied, 'My lord, this man will die before long, and so, my lord, he is called old.' He said, 'Charioteer, am I too not beyond the condition of aging, the nature of aging?' To that I replied, 'My lord too is not beyond the condition of aging, the nature of aging.' He said, 'Charioteer, then turn the chariot around. We shall go back to the palace. For once I have reached the palace, I must reflect on this very matter that has been spoken: that I am not beyond old age.' Your Majesty, the prince went into the palace, and then, thinking, 'Consider: I am not beyond old age!', he was displeased and brooded unhappily."

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "Surely the words of those brahmin sign readers and soothsayers will not come true? Will the prince shave off his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith go forth from home into homelessness? What if I were to give the prince the five qualities of sensual pleasure in abundance, so that one way or another he delights in them and does not go forth?" Then King Śuddhodana gave the bodhisattva Śākyamuni the five qualities of sensual pleasure in abundance, so that one way or another he would delight in them and not go forth. On this it is said:

Hearing the words of the charioteer,
His father, fearful for the prince,
So that he would not go again to the grove of delight,

Gave him in abundance the five qualities of sensual pleasure.

Then, as is the way of things, when the bodhisattva wished to go to the pleasure grove, he would say to the charioteer, "O charioteer, quickly make ready a fine carriage, and riding in it I shall go to the pleasure grove." And so the bodhisattva said to the charioteer, "O charioteer, quickly make ready a fine carriage. Riding in it I shall go to the pleasure grove."

"As my lord commands," said the charioteer, obeying the bodhisattva Śākyamuni. He made ready a fine carriage, went to where the bodhisattva Śākyamuni was, and said to the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, "My lord, the fine carriage is ready. My lord, please consider that the time for it has come."

Then the bodhisattva Śākyamuni mounted the fine carriage and set out for the pleasure grove. And the bodhisattva Śākyamuni saw a man who was pallid and bloated, emaciated and feeble, his faculties failing, whom most people could not bear to look at. Seeing him, he said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, what is this man, pallid and bloated, emaciated and feeble, his faculties failing, whom most people cannot bear to look at?"

"My lord, this is what is called one stricken with fever."

"Charioteer, what is this called stricken with fever?"

"My lord, this man has reached the point at which he will die. My lord, this is what is called stricken with fever."

"Charioteer, am I too not beyond the condition of sickness, the nature of sickness?"

"My lord too is not beyond the condition of sickness, the nature of sickness."

"Charioteer, then turn the chariot around. We shall go back to the palace. For once I have reached the palace, I must reflect on this very matter that has been spoken: that I am not beyond sickness."

The charioteer turned the chariot around and set off for the palace. There the bodhisattva Śākyamuni entered the palace and, thinking, "Consider: I too am not beyond sickness!", was displeased and brooded unhappily. On this it is said:

Seeing here a man with wasted body, pallid and bloated,
Stricken by an illness beyond his control,
And thinking, "Consider: I am not beyond sickness,"

He then was displeased and brooded unhappily.

Then King Śuddhodana said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, did the prince go out to the pleasure grove glad at heart and content? Did he come to delight in the pleasure grove?"

"No, Your Majesty."

"Why was that?"

"Your Majesty, as the prince was going out to the pleasure grove, he saw a man who was pallid and bloated, emaciated and feeble, his faculties failing, whom most people could not bear to look at. Seeing him, he said to me, 'Charioteer, what is this man, pallid and bloated, emaciated and feeble, his faculties failing, whom most people cannot bear to look at?' To that I replied, 'My lord, this is what is called one stricken with fever.' He said, 'Charioteer, what is this called stricken with sickness?' To that I replied, 'This man has reached the point at which this affliction will kill him. My lord, that is what is called stricken with fever.' He said, 'Charioteer, am I too not beyond the condition of sickness, the nature of sickness?' To that I replied, 'My lord too is not beyond the condition of sickness, the nature of sickness.'"

He said, "Charioteer, therefore turn the chariot back. We shall go to the palace itself. For in this way, once I have gone to the palace, I must reflect on the very meaning of what has been declared: 'I am not beyond sickness.'" The prince went into the palace and, thinking, "Just look: I too am not beyond sickness!", he was displeased and grew dejected.

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "Surely the words of those brahmins, the readers of marks and interpreters of omens, will not come true?" and so on, as before. Here it is said:

Then, so that he would take delight and not set his mind on leaving,
Forms and sounds, smells and tastes,
And pleasing objects of touch, the very finest,
The five qualities of sensual pleasure, he provided as well.

As the nature of reality would have it, the bodhisattva Śākyamuni came to wish to go out to the grounds of the pleasure garden, and he gave the command to the charioteer, and so on, as before. The bodhisattva Śākyamuni saw a canopy made of cloth of many colors stretched out, a bier being carried, lamps held up in front, a great crowd of people going on ahead, and women

with disheveled hair following behind, weeping.

Seeing this, he said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, what is this, with a canopy made of cloth of many colors stretched out, a bier being carried, lamps held up in front, a great crowd of people going on ahead, and women with disheveled hair following behind, weeping?"

"My lord, this is what is called one who has died."

"Charioteer, what is this called dead?"

"My lord, from now on this man will not see his beloved father and mother, nor his sons and daughters, his male and female servants, his workers, and the people who live on his wages; and from now on they too will not see him. My lord, that is what is called one who has died."

"Charioteer, am I too not beyond the condition of death, the nature of death?"

"My lord too is not beyond the condition of death, the nature of death."

"Charioteer, therefore turn the chariot back. We shall go to the palace itself. For in this way, once I have gone to the palace, I must reflect on the very meaning of what has been declared: 'I am not beyond death.'"

The charioteer turned the chariot back and set out for the palace itself. There the bodhisattva Śākyamuni went into the palace and, thinking, "Just look: I too am not beyond death!", he was displeased and grew dejected. Here it is said:

Seeing the corpse of a man without mind,
Parted from perception, his life span exhausted,
He thought, "Just look: I am not beyond death!"
And then he was displeased and grew dejected.

Then King Śuddhodana said to the charioteer, and so on; this is as before. Here it is said:

In that excellent city, glorious and delightful,
He who had become a god of gods, like a lamp,
Was gladdened in every way by the five qualities of sensual pleasure,
Like the Thousand-Eyed (Indra) dwelling in the Nandana Grove.

Then the gods of the Pure Abodes thought, "Although the bodhisattva possesses the power of the cause, still the condition must be brought about, for even a great power of the cause depends upon the power of the condition." With this thought, they emanated a man with shaven head, wearing saffron robes and holding an alms bowl in his hand, wandering and going from house

to house and from dwelling to dwelling.

As the nature of reality would have it, the bodhisattva came to wish to go out to the grounds of the pleasure garden, and so on; this is as before. When he had come out to the grounds of the pleasure garden, the bodhisattva Śākyamuni saw a man with shaven head, wearing saffron robes and holding an alms bowl in his hand, wandering and going from house to house and from dwelling to dwelling.

Seeing him, he said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, what is this man, with shaven head and an alms bowl in his hand, wandering and going from house to house and from dwelling to dwelling, whose clothing is of a different color, in no way like that of other people?"

"My lord, that is what is called one who has gone forth."

"Charioteer, what is this called one who has gone forth?"

"My lord, that one who has gone forth, knowing that it is good to be disciplined, good to be perfectly restrained, good to act for the benefit of others, good to practice the Dharma, good to practice virtue, and good to practice what is wholesome, shaved off his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith alone went forth from home into homelessness. My lord, this is what is called one who has gone forth."

"Charioteer, therefore turn this chariot aside to where that one who has gone forth is."

"As my lord commands," said the charioteer, and, heeding the bodhisattva Śākyamuni, he turned the chariot to where the one who had gone forth was. Then the bodhisattva Śākyamuni spoke thus to the one who had gone forth: "O man, why do you have a shaven head and an alms bowl in your hand, wandering and going from house to house and from dwelling to dwelling, and why is your clothing of a different color, in no way like that of other people?"

He replied, "Prince, I am what is called one who has gone forth."

"O man, in what way are you called one who has gone forth?"

"Prince, knowing that it is good to be disciplined, good to be perfectly restrained, good to act for the benefit of others, good to practice the Dharma, good to practice virtue, and good to practice what is wholesome, I shaved off my hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith alone went forth from home into homelessness. In that way I am called one who has gone

forth."

"O man, knowing that it is good to be disciplined, good to be perfectly restrained, good to act for the benefit of others, good to practice the Dharma, good to practice virtue, and good to practice what is wholesome, you have shaved off your hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith alone gone forth from home into homelessness. Excellent!"

Then the bodhisattva Śākyamuni said to the charioteer, "Charioteer, therefore turn the chariot back. We shall go to the palace itself. For in this way, once I have gone to the palace, I must reflect on just this matter."

The charioteer turned the chariot back and set out for the palace itself. When he had arrived there at the palace, the bodhisattva Śākyamuni reflected on just this matter, thinking, "Ah! I shall shave off my hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith alone go forth from home into homelessness."

Then King Śuddhodana spoke to the charioteer, and so on; this is as before.

Then the great Mahāprajāpatī dreamed a dream: Indra's banner fell; the Śākyas were filled with sweepings; the earth turned over; glory departed from the house; outside, she saw herself weeping and laughing for an instant; and the sun set in the very place where it had risen. When the bodhisattva heard this, he reflected, "I am the place where the Śākyas' banner of Indra stands, and if I leave the city, glory will depart."

King Śuddhodana too dreamed a dream: the bed of glory broke, and the father's lineage was cut off. When the bodhisattva heard this, he thought, "That is just how it is. I have become the ground of Yaśodharā's glory and the ground of Śuddhodana's paternal lineage, so if I go forth, the lineage of the Śākyas will be cut off."

In the presence of King Śuddhodana, the readers of marks had prophesied, "If the prince does not go forth within seven days, he will become a wheel-turning monarch." They also said this:

"If you wish to see his good fortune,
Then guard him for seven days,
And, O lord of men, just as the parasol is unfurled,
There is no doubt the seven precious things will appear.

Your son will become a king,
The lord of the seven precious things.

The earth bounded by the ocean
He will protect without punishment.

But if he abandons the earth
And goes, unafraid, into the forest,
He will attain omniscience
And bring about the liberation of beings."

So it was heard. Having heard it, the four, Śuddhodana, Śuklodana, Droṇodana and Amṛtodana, gathered together in one place and began to take counsel: "Wise friends, the brahmins who read marks and interpret omens have prophesied of the bodhisattva Śākyamuni that if he does not go forth within seven days he will become a wheel-turning monarch. Therefore we must guard the bodhisattva closely for seven days, and we must guard the city well too."

Then they surrounded the city of Kapilavastu with seven ramparts and seven moats. The doors of the city gates were made of iron, and bells with a very clear ring were fastened to the doors, so that if a gate were opened its sound would be heard for a league all around. In the bodhisattva's mansion they had captivating and beautiful women attend on him with dancing, song and music. They had a very large ladder made that could be moved, which five hundred men were needed to lift. The place where the steed Kaṇṭhaka stood was covered with copper plates and surrounded by a net of golden bells hung around it.

The bodhisattva went into the upper story of the mansion, where there were no men, and there he stayed in great splendor, taking up lutes, flutes, bronze drums, sweet-sounding instruments and other kinds of musical instruments.

At night King Śuddhodana stayed outside the eastern gate with the fourfold army. In the south was Droṇodana, in the west Śuklodana, and in the north Amṛtodana. The one making the rounds of the center of the city was Mahānāman the Śākya, with the fourfold army.

He went to the eastern gate and said, "Who keeps watch? Who keeps watch?"

King Śuddhodana said, "I keep watch."

"My lord, keep watch! Keep watch, and it will go well for you," he said, and he spoke in verse:

"The sleeping world is like a corpse;
The one who sleeps has fallen into Māra's power.

The one who does not sleep is ever wise,
So do not sleep: keep watch!"

He went to the southern gate and said, "Who keeps watch? Who keeps watch?"

Droṇodana said, "I keep watch."

"My lord, keep watch! Keep watch, and it will go well for you," he said, and he spoke in verse:

"The sleeping world is like a corpse;
The one who sleeps has fallen into Māra's power;
The one who sleeps has fallen into the power of the Lord of Death.
So do not sleep: keep watch!"

He went to the western gate and said, "Who keeps watch? Who keeps watch?"

Śuklodana said, "I keep watch."

"My lord, keep watch! Keep watch, and it will go well for you," he said, and he spoke in verse:

"The one who sleeps is always drunk;
He lies like one who has drunk a measure of liquor,
Like one asleep in a lonely forest.
So do not sleep: keep watch!"

He went to the northern gate and said, "Who keeps watch? Who keeps watch?"

Amṛtodana said, "I keep watch."

"My lord, keep watch! Keep watch, and it will go well for you," he said, and he spoke in verse:

"Like one asleep on a mountain or asleep in a mountain gorge,
Or one asleep in the waters of the ocean,
Like one asleep at the top of a tree:
So do not sleep: keep watch!"

He went to the crossroads and the three-way junctions in the center and said, "Who keeps watch? Who keeps watch?"

The guards said, "We keep watch."

"Keep watch! Keep watch, and it will go well," he said, and he spoke in verse:

"Practice the Dharma; do not practice what is not Dharma.
Speak the truth; do not speak falsehood.
Otherwise you will enter into great darkness.
So do not sleep: keep watch!"

Then, when night had turned to dawn, Mahānāman the Śākya said to King Śuddhodana, "My lord, day has broken. Of the seven days, one day has passed and six days remain."

King Śuddhodana said, "Excellent! When six days have passed and the prince has become a wheel-turning monarch, we shall travel across the face of the sky and follow him to the four continents."

It was the same, up to "one day remains."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought:

"This sage, the son of the Śākya lord of men,
The great being who has perfected the six perfections,
Wishes to go to the grove of austerities that gladdens the heart,
The forest in which the noble ones delight."

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Others may come to say of me, on this basis, 'Prince Śākyamuni is not a man; that is why he abandons Yaśodharā, Gopikā, Mṛgajā and sixty thousand women and goes forth.' So I shall make love with Yaśodharā." With that thought, he made love with Yaśodharā, and Yaśodharā conceived a child. She thought, "When dawn comes, I shall tell the bodhisattva."

Then the bodhisattva, in keeping at that moment with the way things arise in dependence, spoke in verse:

"This night is the last time
That I sleep at home with a woman.
From now on I shall not dwell
At home together with a woman."

Then those women, worn out and heavy with fatigue from dancing, singing and music, fell asleep, saliva dripping from their mouths, their hair disheveled, their clothes and arms flung loose, blurting out whatever senseless words came to them. The bodhisattva saw all those women asleep, saliva dripping from their mouths, their hair disheveled, their clothes and arms flung loose, blurting out whatever senseless words came to them. Seeing this, there arose in him the perception of his circle of consorts as a charnel ground. Then

disenchantment arose in the bodhisattva, and he spoke in verse:

"Like a bed of lotuses struck by the force of the wind, here on the ground
They have fallen, their arms and legs sprawled out,
Their hair disheveled, their private parts and buttocks exposed.
Seeing them, the son of the Śākyas is filled with disenchantment by their very nature.

Seeing this throng of young women, devoid of all decorum,
As like the frightful nature of a charnel ground,
If one should still delight today in the domain of childish beings,
Would one not be bereft of mind, intelligence and mindfulness?

Base desires are like a swamp, like arrows and spears, like poison and fire.
They are like a dream, and like the taste of salt water.
Desire brings ruin and has become the cause of strife and evil.
It ends badly, like the mouth of a snake. I shall abandon it."

Then, as the bodhisattva lay on his great couch, that very night he dreamed five dreams. He made the great earth his bed and placed Sumeru, king of mountains, as his pillow; his left hand entered the great eastern ocean, his right hand entered the great western ocean, and his two feet entered the great ocean. A kind of grass called Upright sprang from his navel and rose up, reaching into the sky. Birds that were completely white with black heads touched his two feet and could be seen up as far as his kneecaps. Birds of many kinds came from the four directions and, in front of him, all became a single color. And he walked upon a heap of filth without being soiled by the filth.

Having dreamed thus, he was glad at heart and thought, "Since I have dreamed such dreams as these, before long I shall attain unsurpassed wisdom."

Yaśodharā too saw in a dream that all her teeth fell out, that her conch-shell armlet broke, that the moon fell to the ground, and that the stars wept. When Yaśodharā told the bodhisattva the dream she had dreamed, the bodhisattva said:

"Your teeth are still in your mouth,
And the moon is still in the sky.
So clear away the torment in your mind,
And sleep happily, without fear."

Then Yaśodharā thought:

"Since I have dreamed fearful dreams,
My mind is filled with apprehension.
Tonight, surely I shall not
Be parted from my beloved?"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought, "Although bodhisattvas possess the power of the cause, still it must be accomplished through the condition, for even a great power of the cause depends upon the power of the condition." With this thought, he went to where the bodhisattva was, and when he had arrived, he stayed in the mansion and said this to the bodhisattva:

"Like a monkey of the forest roaming its domain,
Your mind is like a colt left to run free.
If you turn away from the qualities of sensual pleasure,
You will see a light far brighter than these.

Rise up, rise up, you of excellent mind!
Abandon the earth and depart,
And once you have attained omniscience,
Bring beings across to liberation."

The bodhisattva replied:

"Kauśika, do you not see?
Like the lord of beasts encircled by a net am I.
Powerful men bearing bows, weapons and swords,
With horses, elephants, chariots and a great host of troops,
Have encircled the city of Kapilavastu on every side.

This host of Śākyas, Śuddhodana and the rest,
Mounted on elephants and horses, their bodies well armored,
And grim men of every kind with weapons in hand,
Are stationed within the courtyards, the stables and the mansion.

The palace and the doors of the house,
And likewise the gates of the city,
Have been shut and firmly bolted,
And so are guarded on every side.

With the sound of horns, of paṭaha drums and of drums,
Stationed within the courtyards, stables and mansion,
Throngs of people, striving with elephants and cavalry,

Keep constant guard so as not to let me go."

Śakra said:

"Remember the prophecy of the gentle Dīpaṃkara,
And this world tormented by suffering,
And keep in mind your former vow:
Abandon your household and go forth with resolve.

So that you may go, without obstacles,
To the forest this very day,
We gods, together with Brahmā and the rest,
Shall bring it about."

The bodhisattva said, "Excellent!" and was pleased.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, made everyone drunk with sleep and commanded Pāñcika, the great general of the yakṣas: "Friend, the bodhisattva is going to come down from the upper story of the mansion. Bring the ladder!" He fetched the ladder, and the bodhisattva came down.

Then, as soon as Śakra gave the signal, the bodhisattva went to where his attendant Chandaka was. When he found Chandaka overcome by deep sleep, the bodhisattva roused him with effort and spoke to him in the melody of verse:

"Get up, Chandaka! Quickly, from the stable,
Bring my steed, the precious Kaṇṭhaka.
To the grove of austerities enjoyed by the Victors of old,
Which gladdens the sages, I am going."

Chandaka opened his sleepy eyes and said:

"My lord, it is not the hour for the pleasure garden.
Gentle one, you have no quarrel with anyone.
Since you have no enemy whatever,
What need have you of a mount at midnight?"

The bodhisattva declared:

"Chandaka, if never once
Have you disobeyed my word,
Then now, at this my final hour,
Do not disobey this word of mine."

Chandaka said, "Prince, this night is full of fear and terror, so I will not fetch the mount."

The bodhisattva thought, "If I ask him again and again, people will surely wake up. I shall go myself and make ready Kaṇṭhaka, the king of horses." With that thought, he himself opened the door of the palace and set about taking hold of Kaṇṭhaka, the king of horses. But the horse twisted its neck, shied away this way and that, and would not stand still.

Then the bodhisattva stroked its head with his hand, a hand produced by many hundreds of merits, bearing the wheel, the auspicious mark and the swastika, a hand that brings relief to the frightened, and he said:

"Kaṇṭhaka, take up this final burden,
And carry me without hindrance to the forest of austerities.
Once I have attained awakening, I shall swiftly satisfy all beings
With the rain of meditative concentration and liberation."

As is the nature of things, even an animal does not balk once it has been instructed, so Kaṇṭhaka, the king of horses, stood without moving. Then joy arose in the bodhisattva, and he saddled Kaṇṭhaka, the king of horses.

At that moment Mahānāman the Śākya, who was making the rounds, inspecting the people, came to that spot and saw the bodhisattva preparing to depart. Then, his voice choking and his eyes full of tears, he said, "Prince, what are you doing?"

"Mahānāman, I am going."

"Prince, this is not right."

The bodhisattva said, "Mahānāman, this is exactly what is right. For three incalculable eons, through many hundreds of thousands of hardships, I have striven perfectly for awakening for the sake of sentient beings. How, then, could I bear to remain at home now? This is certain: I am going to the grove of austerities.

When the wise swiftly escape
From a great house that is ablaze,
It is not fitting to call this wrong;
It is indeed worthy of praise.

Likewise, when one wishes to escape
From the cage of existence, blazing fiercely

With old age, sickness and death,
What do you see in this that is not right?"

When he rebuked him thus with forceful words, tears streamed like rain from Mahānāman's face, and he broke into lament: "Alas!

Today the hope of King Śuddhodana
And of all the Śākyas,
Pondered on again and again,
Has come to nothing.

Today King Śuddhodana,
Tormented by grief for his son,
Will suffer, raising up his arms,
And utter unbearable cries.

Gopikā, Yaśodharā, Mṛgajā,
And the great circle of consorts as well,
Through being parted from Siddhārtha,
Will undergo terrible suffering."

Having said this, he woke Yaśodharā in alarm and said:

"Know this: Siddhārtha is going!
Lest you be tormented by grief for your husband
And come to be wretched with suffering,
Turn your beloved husband back!

Once your husband has gone, he will be hard to see.
Look at him: this is the last time you will see your husband.

Alas, wretched me! Though I cried out in the night,
No one answered me, so the fault is not mine."

But though he cried out in this way,
Through the blessing of the gods,
Like one shouting in the wilderness,
No one at all awoke.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "To go without seeing my father would not be in keeping with my way." With this thought, he went to where King Śuddhodana was, and when he arrived, King Śuddhodana was overcome by sleep. Then he thought, "Although I have become the father of the whole world, the teacher of

the world and the eldest of the world, even so, father and mother are a person's teachers; they are as gods and as Brahmā to him, and they are his great benefactors." With that thought, he bowed at his father's two feet, circled him three times, and spoke these words:

"I too have love in my heart,
And I too take joy in my kin;
But saṃsāra is evil by its very nature,
And having seen this, I am leaving.

If there were no harmful suffering
That comes from old age, sickness and death
And from parting with beloved kin,
Who would ever leave you?

For, though we do not wish it,
The great circle of our kin,
Our friends, our wives and our wealth
Before long will pass from us.

Therefore, with a mind free of attachment,
In order to be fully freed from saṃsāra,
I have left my loving kin
And set out for the forest where no people are.

Since every gathering of embodied beings
Must surely end in separation,
Think of me with love, and do not
Grieve in your bewilderment."

Having said this, he set out. Then Mahānāman woke King Śuddhodana and said:

"Siddhārtha is departing!
Lord of the earth, turn him back!
Stricken with grief for your son,
Tormented by suffering, you will weep."

So he said, but the king too did not wake.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke to four sons of the gods, Sprout, Maṅkura, Radiant and Leaf-Clad: "Friends, are you able to lift up the bodhisattva?"

They said, "We are well able indeed."

"How much strength do you have?"

Sprout said, "I have such strength that I could carry all the mountains there are on the earth on one shoulder and go along with little fatigue."

Maṅkura said, "I too could carry all the water there is on the earth on one shoulder and go along."

Radiant said, "I too could carry all the dust there is on the earth on my shoulder and go along with little fatigue."

Leaf-Clad said, "I too could carry all the grass, trees, branches and leaves there are on the earth on one shoulder and go along with little fatigue."

Śakra said, "Friends, since you have such strength, you are able to lift the bodhisattva."

Then the four, Sprout, Maṅkura, Radiant and Leaf-Clad, took the precious steed Kaṇṭhaka and went to where the bodhisattva was. When they arrived they said, "Bodhisattva, why do you wait?"

Then the bodhisattva thought, "These will grow proud, thinking, 'We lifted up the bodhisattva and carried him through the sky.'" With that thought, the bodhisattva blessed his body to become a vajra body, and they were not able even to move him. Filled with wonder, they said, "Prince, we did not know that bodhisattvas had such strength."

Then the bodhisattva mounted the precious steed Kaṇṭhaka, and thus, through the bodhisattva power of the bodhisattvas and the divine power of the gods, the precious steed Kaṇṭhaka and Chandaka rose up into the sky above.

Then the gods, Śakra, Brahmā and the rest, surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of gods, went to where the bodhisattva was. When they arrived, they went along encircling the bodhisattva. On the right went the gods who dwell in the form realm, with peaceful bearing; on the left went those who dwell in the desire realm, raising victory banners and pennants, with many kinds of special divine music; and in front went Śakra, Brahmā and the others, each in his own manner.

Many hundreds of thousands of gods stationed in the expanse of the sky scattered divine blue lotuses, red lotuses, night lilies and white lotuses over the bodhisattva. They scattered powdered aloeswood, powdered sandalwood and powdered tamāla leaves, and divine mandārava flowers as well. They played many kinds of divine musical instruments, and they scattered

garments too. Here it is said:

In the sky the gods raised great sounds of laughter,
And with joyful minds they waved their garments.
Some sang the praises of the bodhisattva,
And in the sky they played hundreds of instruments.

Some opened the gates,
And strewed mandārava flowers.
Some held the hooves of his mount,
And, gazing at the Sugata, followed after him.

Some followed after on the right,
And those going on the left followed after too.
Śakra, likewise, together with Brahmā,
And Kubera himself, showed him the way.

Like the full moon amid the hosts of stars,
The great being, with the hosts of gods going before him,
Went, glad at heart, to the forest of austerities that gladdens the sages,
The forest in which the noble ones delight.

Then the bodhisattva, to encourage Kaṇṭhaka, said:

"Do not tire, do not tire; hold fast to your strength.
Take up today this one chance to serve beings.
Before long I shall attain awakening,
And satisfy beings with meditative concentration and liberation."

The bodhisattva traveled twelve leagues and the next morning arrived at the city of Peerless.

Then, as the gods were wondering, "Now that the bodhisattva has gone forth, will he not enter his own city again?", he turned his whole body to the right, looked back with the gaze of an elephant, and said:

"Until I have attained the supreme path
That the buddhas have taught,
I shall not enter again
The city of Kapilavastu."

Then they circled the bodhisattva's feet three times and went back to their own abodes.

The bodhisattva dismounted, took off his ornaments, and told Chandaka, "Chandaka, take the ornaments and the horse, and go back." Here it is said:

"Charioteer, give this horse of mine
And these ornaments to my kin.
Having abandoned vast desires,
I shall go forth right here, now.

These desires are like a razor's edge,
Like a blazing pit of fire, and they end badly.
Out of compassion, to benefit the world, I have abandoned them.
I have gone to the wilderness and will not turn back home."

Then Chandaka, tears streaming like rain down his face, said to the bodhisattva:

"In a forest teeming with lions and tigers,
And full of herdsmen,
All alone, parted from your kin,
How will the noble one get by?"

The bodhisattva said:

"When beings are born, they are born alone.
Likewise, when they die, they die alone.
Alone they undergo suffering.
In saṃsāra there is no companion."

Chandaka said:

"Alas! The prince has never seen suffering.
With tender feet, used to riding elephants and horses,
How will he go on foot over ground that is harsh, full of grass and stones,
And wander in the forest?"

The bodhisattva said:

"The terror of the Lord of Death is never once
Absent for the fortunate, nor for those used to comfort,
Nor for those who have protectors, nor for those of noble birth,
Nor for the brave and the venerable, nor for people who rejoice.

It is said that old age
Brings on the terrors of the Lord of Death.
With one's purpose not done, not even begun,

One goes on to death as well."

Chandaka said, "The aged king will die of grief for his son." But because the bodhisattva had gathered the accumulations for awakening, Chandaka's words did not move his heart.

Then the bodhisattva drew from its scabbard his sword, which was like a blue lotus, cut off his topknot, and tossed it up into the sky. Śakra, lord of the gods, caught it and, showing it great honor, carried it among the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, where he instituted a great festival in honor of the topknot.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, thought, "Because of the pride of his royal caste, the prince will not be able to turn back from this," and he rejoiced.

Then the bodhisattva said to Chandaka, "Do not lead Kaṇṭhaka into the palace." When he had said this, Chandaka, crying aloud, his eyes full of tears, led away Kaṇṭhaka, king of horses, looking back again and again at the bodhisattva as he went, and came to Kapilavastu. There an uproar arose, and at length people said to King Śuddhodana, "Your Majesty, the prince has come; please rejoice." In the city of Kapilavastu, too, a great proclamation rang out. When Kaṇṭhaka, king of horses, entered the palace, the whole company of royal women clung to Kaṇṭhaka's neck and began to weep. Kaṇṭhaka's breath went inward, and he died on that very spot. After his death he took rebirth in the family of a renowned brahmin devoted to the six duties.

Then the bodhisattva, traveling by stages, came to the hermitage of the sage Shunner of Evil. At that time the sage Shunner of Evil's son was sitting with his cheek resting on his hand, brooding. Seeing him like that, the bodhisattva said, "Great sage, why are you sitting with your cheek on your hand, brooding?"

He replied, "In this hermitage of mine the tāla trees bore golden leaves, flowers, and fruit, but they have not remained as they were before."

The bodhisattva said, "Great sage, the one by whose power the tāla trees in this hermitage bore golden leaves, flowers, and fruit has truly seen old age, sickness, and death, has grown weary of the world, and now dwells in the forest of austerities. Had he not truly seen old age, sickness, and death, grown weary, and come to dwell in the forest of austerities, this pleasure grove would have been his."

When he had said this, the son of the sage Shunner of Evil began to examine the bodhisattva. Seeing his handsome form and peaceful bearing, he examined him for a long time, and, filled with wonder, said, "O renunciant, could that one be you?"

The bodhisattva said, "Great sage, it is certainly so."

Then the son of Shunner of Evil, staring with eyes wide in amazement, first invited the bodhisattva to a seat and offered him flowers and fruit.

From "In the city of Peerless there was a householder, rich, wealthy, and of great possessions," up to "ten sons were born to him," all those sons went forth and realized the awakening of a pratyekabuddha. In time, their old mother gave those great beings a pair of hempen garments, and they said, "Mother, please understand this. The son of King Śuddhodana, Prince Sarvārthasiddha, having seen old age, sickness, and death, has gone to the forest with a mind thoroughly weary of the world, and he will fully and manifestly awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Therefore, since we cannot remain in a buddha's field, we shall pass into final nirvāṇa. Offer these hempen garments to the son of King Śuddhodana. That great being will realize unsurpassed wisdom, and you too will obtain a great fruit." Having said this, they performed the miracles of blazing, shining, sending down rain, and flashing lightning, and passed into final nirvāṇa in the element of nirvāṇa without remainder of the aggregates.

When the old woman was at the point of death, she entrusted those garments to her daughter and told her all that had happened. Her daughter in turn was struck by illness, and, knowing she would die, she too placed them at the foot of a tree and prayed to the god dwelling in that tree, "Please offer these to the son of King Śuddhodana."

Since the knowledge and vision of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, reaches down to the realms below, he learned of them and took them. Then, magically transforming himself into what looked like a decrepit old hunter, he put them on, took a bow and arrows in his hand, and sat down in the middle of the road the bodhisattva would travel. The bodhisattva, traveling by stages, came to that road and saw a hunter holding a bow and arrows and wearing ochre garments. Seeing him, he said to the man, "Good man, those hempen garments are fitting for one who has gone forth. Take these fine Kāśī cloths and give those to me."

He replied, "Prince, others would say of me, 'You killed the young prince and took these garments of fine Kāśī cloth,' and on that ground I would be put to death. So I will not give them to you."

The bodhisattva said, "Good man, the whole world knows what power I possess. Who could kill me? Who would believe that you had killed me? Give them without fear."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, touched his head to the bodhisattva's two feet, offered him the hempen garments, and took the fine Kāśī cloths. The hempen garments did not fit the bodhisattva's body, and he thought, "Ah, may these hempen garments fit my body." No sooner had he spoken the words than, by the bodhisattva power of bodhisattvas and the divine power of the gods, those hempen garments came to fit the bodhisattva's body.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Now that I have gone forth, I should take beings into my care." Then the bodhisattva, wandering by stages, arrived at Rājagṛha. Since the bodhisattva was skilled in every craft and trade, he made an alms bowl from the leaves of a karavīra tree, and with calm deportment entered Rājagṛha for alms.

At that time King Bimbisāra, who was on the upper terrace of his palace, saw him going on his alms round, graceful in going and returning, in looking ahead and looking about, in bending and stretching, and in bearing his outer robe and alms bowl. Seeing him, he thought, "Of all the many renunciants who live in Rājagṛha, there is not one with deportment like this renunciant's."

On this it is said:

I shall proclaim the going forth,
How the one with vision went forth,
How he, having examined it well,
Chose the going forth with full resolve.
This household life is suffering;
It is a place of dust,
While going forth is like the open sky:
Knowing this, he then went forth.
Having gone forth, with his body
He abandoned deeds of evil,
And having abandoned evil of speech,
He made his livelihood wholly pure.

Then to the foremost city of Magadha,
Rājagṛha, he went,
And when the protector, vigilant and mindful,
Went there on his round for alms,
The skilled lord of Magadha,
Seated in his palace, saw him.
Seeing him, he reflected, and then
He spoke thus to his ministers:
"Richly adorned with the supreme marks,
Perfect in his bodily frame,
Looking only a yoke's length ahead:
Look at this man, you wise ones!
His eyes are lowered, his mind upright;
He was not born of a lowly family.
Where will he go to stay?"
The king sent messengers to follow him.
Then he commanded the messengers:
"Wherever that monk goes,
And wherever he makes his dwelling,
Follow close behind him."

He, going on his round for alms,
His six doors well restrained,
Vigilant and mindful,
Swiftly filled his alms bowl.
And when he had completed his alms round,
The sage went out from the city,
Went on to Mount Pāṇḍava,
And there he made his dwelling.
Knowing that he had made his dwelling,
One messenger stayed behind,
While the other swiftly returned
And spoke these words to the king:
"Great king, that monk,
Like the cub of a lion or a tiger
Dwelling in a mountain cave,
Dwells upon Mount Pāṇḍava."

Hearing the messengers' words,
The lord of the earth mounted his chariot,
And, surrounded by his ministers,
He set out with all speed.
He rode as far as the ground would allow,
Then he alighted from his carriage,
Went close on foot,
And then he saw the Tathāgata.
The king sat down, and having exchanged
Pleasant and agreeable words,
Neither haughty nor coarse,
He spoke these words:
"Monk, you are in the very bloom
Of your first youth;
For one of such splendor as this,
Wandering for alms is not becoming.
Delightful houses,
Women adorned with ornaments,
And the finest enjoyments, if you would partake of them:
Tell me, I ask, your lineage."

"O king, near the snowy mountains
Lies a country full of wealth
And full of grain,
Renowned by the name of Kosala.
There dwell the Śākyas,
Of the Ikṣvāku line, of the solar clan.
O king, I am of the warrior caste,
And I do not seek the objects of desire.

Though one possessed this earth with its mountains and its oceans,
Rich with every kind of jewel,
A man would never be sated,
Like a fire fed with wood in the scorching heat of summer.
Desires are said to be bound up with enmity;
O lord of men, they are hard to cross, like a swamp of mire.
They are the chief root of suffering, sorrow, and fear,
And those of foolish mind indulge in them.
O king, since even as soon as I came forth

I conceived a distaste for desires,
How could I take back again what I have cast away,
Those terrifying foes of the Dharma?
The vast snowy mountain, the Meru of many peaks,
Might perhaps be shaken by the wind,
But my mind, which rests on liberation,
Cannot be shaken by the force of desire.
This world, sunk in desire,
Wanders round on the wheel of saṃsāra;
O lord of men, I am its refuge, since there is no other,
And I shall free it from its great fear.

Knowing the dangers of desires,
Seeing nirvāṇa as peace,
For the sake of abandoning them,
I shall go wherever my mind delights."

King Bimbisāra said, "O renunciant, what aim do you pursue by this discipline?"

He said, "Unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

The king said, "O renunciant, when you have fully and manifestly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, please think of me too."

The bodhisattva said, "I shall consider it so." Having said this, he left Rājagṛha and went to a hermitage of sages not very far from Vulture Peak Mountain. There he dwelt, applying himself to meditative concentration in his conduct and in his abiding. When those sages stood on one leg for a single watch of the day, the bodhisattva remained so for two watches. If they sat for a single watch of the day in the practice of the five fires, the bodhisattva too sat in that practice for two watches. Then, filled with wonder, they said, "This śramaṇa is a great one," and so he came to be called "the Great Śramaṇa, the Great Śramaṇa."

The bodhisattva said to them, "Sirs, what aim do you pursue by this discipline?"

Some of them said, "To be Śakra himself." Some said, "We seek to be Brahmā himself." Some said, "We seek to be Māra himself."

The bodhisattva thought, "These sages will fall once again; they have entered a wrong path. This path cannot bring knowing, cannot bring seeing, and cannot bring awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Then the bodhisattva, knowing that path to be powerless, went to where Ārāḍa Kālāma was, and when he arrived he said to Ārāḍa Kālāma, "Ārāḍa, if it is no trouble to you, I would practice the holy life in your presence."

He said, "Venerable Gautama, it is no trouble to me; stay just as you please."

The bodhisattva said, "Ārāḍa, how many dharmas have you realized through your own direct knowledge?"

He replied, "Venerable Gautama, up to the sphere of nothingness."

Then the bodhisattva thought, "In what Ārāḍa Kālāma has faith, I too have faith. Just as Ārāḍa Kālāma has diligence, mindfulness, samādhi, and wisdom, I too have diligence, mindfulness, samādhi, and wisdom. Ārāḍa Kālāma has directly realized all those dharmas up to the sphere of nothingness; why should I too not directly realize these dharmas?" Then, in order to attain those very dharmas not yet attained, to understand what was not yet understood, and to realize directly what was not yet directly realized, the bodhisattva dwelt alone and secluded, heedful, ardent, and resolute. As he dwelt alone and secluded, heedful, ardent, and resolute, before long he directly realized those dharmas.

Having directly realized those dharmas, he went to where Ārāḍa Kālāma was, and when he arrived he said to Ārāḍa Kālāma, "Ārāḍa, did you directly realize these dharmas up to the sphere of nothingness through your own direct knowledge?"

He replied, "Indeed, Venerable Gautama, I directly realized those dharmas up to the sphere of nothingness."

The bodhisattva said, "Venerable Ārāḍa, I too have directly realized those dharmas up to the sphere of nothingness through my own direct knowledge."

"Venerable Gautama, in that case, as much as you have, I have as well, and as much as I have, you have as well. In this matter we are equal, the same, and alike. Come here, and the two of us together shall lead this assembly."

Then Ārāḍa Kālāma, who had at first been the bodhisattva's teacher, himself honored the bodhisattva with the highest honor and revered him with the highest reverence, and he was delighted and pleased with his realizations.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "This path cannot bring knowing, cannot bring seeing, and cannot bring awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." Then the bodhisattva, understanding that path to be powerless, went to where Udraka Rāmaputra was, and when he arrived he said to Udraka Rāmaputra, "Udraka, if it is no trouble to you, I would practice the holy life in your presence."

He said, "Venerable Gautama, it is no trouble to me; stay just as you please."

"How many dharmas have you directly realized?"

"Venerable Gautama, up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception."

Then the bodhisattva thought, "In what Udraka Rāmaputra has faith, I too have faith. If I have such diligence, mindfulness, samādhi, and wisdom as Udraka Rāmaputra has, and Udraka Rāmaputra has directly realized all these dharmas up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception, why should I too not directly realize these dharmas?" Then, in order to attain those very dharmas not yet attained, to understand what was not yet understood, and to realize directly what was not yet directly realized, the bodhisattva dwelt alone and secluded, heedful, ardent, and resolute. As he dwelt alone and secluded, heedful and resolute, before long he directly realized those dharmas.

Having directly realized those dharmas, he went to where Udraka Rāmaputra was, and when he arrived he said to Udraka Rāmaputra, "Udraka, did you yourself directly realize these dharmas up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception?"

"Indeed, Venerable Gautama, I directly realized these dharmas up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception."

The bodhisattva said, "Venerable Udraka, I too have myself directly realized these dharmas up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception."

"Venerable Gautama, in that case, as much as you have, I have as well, and as much as I have, you have as well. In this matter we are equal, the same, and alike. Come here, and the two of us together shall lead this community."

Then Udraka Rāmaputra, who had at first been the bodhisattva's teacher, honored the bodhisattva with the highest honor and revered him with the highest reverence, and he was delighted and pleased with his understanding.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "This path cannot bring knowing, cannot bring seeing, and cannot bring awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening." Then the bodhisattva, understanding that this path too was powerless, departed. Then five sages, three from the following of Ārāḍa Kālāma and two from the following of Udraka Rāmaputra, followed after the bodhisattva.

Then the bodhisattva, together with the five, wandered on and came to the market town of the community of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, south of the Ganges. As he walked about there, he saw a delightful place: a beautiful, dense grove; the river Nairañjanā flowing cool, with sandy banks and easy fords, broad on its shores; adorned with blue grasses and many kinds of trees, altogether delightful.

Seeing it, he thought, "Ah, this place is truly delightful: a beautiful, dense grove; the river Nairañjanā flowing cool, with sandy banks and easy fords, broad on its shores; adorned with blue grasses and many kinds of trees, altogether delightful. Ah, if a son of good family who seeks to strive resorts to this forest, he will be able to strive. Since I seek to strive, come now, I too shall resort to this forest and strive."

Then the bodhisattva entered the forest, sat down at the foot of a tree, set his teeth against his teeth, pressed his tongue to his palate, and with his mind he gripped his mind, restrained it, and restrained it utterly. As with his mind he gripped his mind, restrained it, and restrained it utterly, sweat broke out from all the pores of his body. Just as, when a strong man seizes a very weak man, binds him upside down, restrains him, and restrains him utterly, sweat breaks out from all that man's pores, so at that time the bodhisattva set his teeth against his teeth, pressed his tongue to his palate, and with his mind gripped his mind, restrained it, and restrained it utterly, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall enter into the meditations of swelling (āsphānaka)." He began to enter into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and the out-breath through his mouth and nose. When he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, all the wind went up into the crown of his head, and in his head there arose an extremely unbearable pain in the head. Just as, when a strong man drives a sharp iron spike into the crown of a very weak man, an extremely unbearable pain in the head arises in that man's head, so, when the bodhisattva entered into the

meditations of swelling, an extremely unbearable pain arose in his head. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused. His body was not untrained but trained. He was not dull but had mindfulness closely established; his mind was settled one-pointedly in equipoise. Although the bodhisattva experienced such feelings, fierce, unbearable, harsh, burning, and disagreeable suffering, because his body had been thus cultivated, they did not seize hold of his mind and remain.

He thought, "Come now, I shall enter still further into the meditations of swelling." He began to enter still further into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose. Because he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, all the wind went out through the openings of his two ears. Just as, when a smith blows his bellows, the whole stream of air goes out through the two openings at its corners, so, when the bodhisattva entered into the meditations of swelling, the whole stream of wind went out through the openings of his two ears. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall enter yet further into the meditations of swelling." He began to enter further into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose. Because he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, his whole belly swelled up, swelled up utterly. Just as, when a skilled smith blows his bellows, it becomes full, utterly full, so at that time, when the bodhisattva entered into the meditations of swelling, his whole belly swelled up, swelled up utterly. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall enter into the meditations of swelling." He began to enter further into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose. When he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, at that time an extremely unbearable pain arose in his head. Just as, when a strong man binds the head of a very weak man again and again with a cord, an extremely unbearable pain in the head arises in that man's head, so at that time, when the bodhisattva entered into the meditations of swelling, an extremely unbearable pain arose in his head. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained

aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall enter into the meditations of swelling." He began to enter further into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose. When he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, at that time an unbearable pain arose within his belly. Just as, when a skilled butcher of cattle, or a butcher's skilled apprentice, slits open a cow's belly with a sharp cattle-killing knife, an extremely unbearable pain arises within its belly, so at that time, when the bodhisattva entered into the meditations of swelling, an extremely unbearable pain arose within his belly. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall enter into the meditations of swelling."

He began to enter still further into the meditations of swelling, and as he entered into the meditations of swelling, he stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose. When he had stopped the in-breath and out-breath through his mouth and nose, at that time an extremely unbearable burning arose in his body. Just as, when two very strong men seize a very weak man, hold him upside down, and roast him in a fire pit, an extremely unbearable burning arises in that man's body, so at that time, when the bodhisattva entered into the meditations of swelling, an extremely unbearable burning arose in his body. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall practice not eating food at all, in any way whatsoever." Then very many gods, knowing the bodhisattva's mind with their minds, went to where the bodhisattva was, and when they arrived they said to the bodhisattva, "Friend, if you shun human food, are ashamed of it, and despise it, we shall infuse divine radiance through all the pores of your body; please accept it."

Then the bodhisattva thought, "If, having vowed not to eat human food, I were to accept the divine radiance that the gods infuse into all my pores, that would be a falsehood on my part, and whatever is a falsehood on my part is a wrong on my part. On account of whatever is a wrong on my part, some beings here, at the breaking up of the body after death, would be reborn in the lower realms, the bad destinies, the places of ruin, the hells. Come now, I shall reject

the gods' words entirely, in every way, and I shall eat only a little food, a mere handful, or drink broth of mung beans, or broth of peas, or broth of hareṇuka fruit."

Then at that time the bodhisattva rejected the gods' words entirely, in every way, and took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, or else broth of mung beans, or broth of peas, or broth of hareṇuka fruit. Then, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, all his limbs and lesser limbs shrank and shrank completely, and he became withered, his bodily splendor diminished. Just as the stems of the asita creeper and of the kālika creeper shrink and shrink completely, so that they become thin and dry, so at that time, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, all his limbs and lesser limbs shrank and shrank completely, and he became withered, his bodily splendor diminished.

Then at that time, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the skin of his head withered and withered completely, and became shriveled and wrinkled. Just as a gourd cut from its stalk withers and withers completely, becoming shriveled and wrinkled, so at that time, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the skin of his head withered and withered completely, and became shriveled and wrinkled. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "As I take little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the eyeballs of my two eyes have sunk in, sunk deep in, gone deep, very deep, far down, so that they look as if they had been plucked out." Just as one speaks of the reflection of the stars in the water of a deep well as sunk in, sunk deep in, gone deep, very deep, far down, so at that time, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the eyeballs of his two eyes sank in, sank deep in, went deep, very deep, far down, so that they looked as if they had been plucked out. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, at that time the spaces between his ribs became ridged and hollowed. Just as the rafters of a grass hut two or three years old become uneven, so at that time, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the spaces between his ribs became ridged and hollowed. Yet he did not lose heart; his diligence remained aroused, and so on, as before.

Then, as the bodhisattva took little food, scant, meager, a mere handful, the joints of his spine became like a braid of hair, and his buttocks became like a camel's foot. At times, when he wished to rise, he fell forward on his face, and at times, when he wished to sit, he fell over on his back. He supported his lower body by leaning on his upper body, and supported his upper body by leaning on his lower body. He rubbed his body with his two hands, and when he rubbed and rubbed his body all over with his two hands, the hairs, rotted at the roots, dropped to the ground.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come now, I shall take a meal of a single sesame seed," and he took a meal of a single sesame seed. As he took a meal of a single sesame seed, all his limbs and lesser limbs shrank and shrank completely, and he became withered, his bodily splendor diminished. As with a single sesame seed, so too with a single grain of rice, a single chickpea, a single pea, a single lentil, and a single mung bean; and he slept on a bed of grass.

When King Śuddhodana heard of that state of austerity, he sent out two hundred and fifty scouts every day, and King Suprabuddha too sent two hundred and fifty. Every day they carried news to those two kings with all possible speed.

"The bodhisattva is practicing hardships such as these: he takes a meal of a single sesame seed, a single grain of rice, a single chickpea, a single pea, a single lentil, and a single mung bean, and he sleeps on a bed of grass," they reported. When King Śuddhodana heard this, he was overwhelmed by grief for his son, pining for him all the more, his eyes brimming with tears; in his anguish he too lay down on a bed of grass, together with his retinue of queens. Yaśodharā also heard of it, and she was overwhelmed by grief for her husband. She ate only a single sesame seed, and the child within her womb, ill at ease, dwindled away right there.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "By this path, too, one cannot know, one cannot see, one cannot awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Then that bodhisattva thought, "Come, let me eat extremely coarse food," and so he took extremely coarse food. The base food in this case was the urine and dung of calves that, not long born, were still drinking milk. As long as its sustaining radiance had not faded from his body, he would not take a second meal; only when it had faded did he take the next one. He also went to the great charnel ground, placed a corpse beneath his head as a pillow, set one

foot upon the other, and, attending in mind to the perception of light and to a perception endowed with mindfulness and vigilance, lay down to sleep on his right side.

At that time the young men and the young women of the town would come and push sticks into the openings of his two ears and draw them out through both ears, saying, "Hey, look at the piśāca of the rubbish heap! Hey, look at the piśāca of the rubbish heap!" They would also scatter sweepings, donkey dung, and gravel over him. Yet the bodhisattva did not think to give rise to ill will toward those young men or young women of the town, or to utter a harsh word. Because the bodhisattva practiced hardship in great austerity, he came to be called "the Great Ascetic, the Great Ascetic." In this way he practiced austerities for six years.

Then three gods came to where the bodhisattva was, and one god said, "The ascetic Gautama is black." The second said, "He is not black; rather, he is dark blue." The third said, "He is neither black nor dark blue; he is dusky red." The fine complexion that had shone in the bodhisattva's body had vanished altogether.

Then, at that time, three similes never heard before came to the bodhisattva, namely these.

Suppose a piece of wet, sappy wood were taken out of the water and placed close by on dry ground, and then a man who wanted fire, seeking fire, came along, made it into a lower fire stick, set the upper fire stick upon it, and rubbed. Because that wood is wet and sappy, it would not be possible to produce fire or make it blaze. In the same way, there are certain ascetics or brahmins who do not live with body and mind held far away from sensual pleasures; for them, their desire for sensual pleasures, their attachment to sensual pleasures, their delight in sensual pleasures, their clinging to sensual pleasures, their infatuation with sensual pleasures, and their intense clinging to sensual pleasures have not been brought fully to an end in their minds. Such is the case of those who do not live with body and mind held far away. Although they undergo such feelings of self-inflicted suffering, unbearable, harsh, burning, and disagreeable, nevertheless they cannot know, they cannot see, they cannot awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. This was the first simile, never heard before, that came to the bodhisattva at that time.

Suppose, for example, a piece of wet, sappy wood were taken out of the water and placed close by on dry ground, and then a man who wanted fire, seeking fire, came along, made it into a lower fire stick, set the upper fire stick upon it, and rubbed. Because that wood is wet and sappy, it would not be possible to produce fire or make it blaze. In the same way, there are certain ascetics or brahmins who live withdrawn from sensual pleasures in body but not in mind; for them, their desire for sensual pleasures, their attachment to sensual pleasures, their delight in sensual pleasures, their clinging to sensual pleasures, their infatuation with sensual pleasures, and their intense clinging to sensual pleasures remain, not brought fully to an end in their minds. Although they undergo such feelings of self-inflicted suffering, unbearable, harsh, burning, and disagreeable, nevertheless they cannot know, they cannot see, they cannot awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. This was the second simile, never heard before, that came to the bodhisattva at that time.

Suppose a piece of dry, hollow wood without sap were placed on dry ground far from water, and then a man who wanted fire, seeking fire, came along, made it into a lower fire stick, set the upper fire stick upon it, and rubbed. Because that wood is dry and hollow, it would be possible to produce fire and make it blaze. In the same way, there are certain ascetics or brahmins who live with body and mind held far away from sensual pleasures; for them, their desire for sensual pleasures, their attachment to sensual pleasures, their delight in sensual pleasures, their clinging to sensual pleasures, their infatuation with sensual pleasures, and their intense clinging to sensual pleasures have been brought fully to an end in their minds and no longer remain. Although they undergo such feelings of self-inflicted suffering, unbearable, harsh, burning, and disagreeable, nevertheless they can know, they can see, they can awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. This was the third simile, never heard before, that came to the bodhisattva at that time.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "All those who live striving to abandon suffering go no further than this. There is nothing beyond it, and nothing higher than it; and yet by this path, too, one cannot know, one cannot see, one cannot awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Then the bodhisattva reflected, "What, then, is the path by which one can know, by which one can see, by which one can awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?" And he thought this: "When I was living in the

household of my father, the Śākya Śuddhodana, I went out to the edge of the fields where the plowing was being done and sat in the shade of a rose-apple tree. There, secluded from sensual desires, secluded from evil, unwholesome dharmas, I entered and dwelled in the first meditative concentration, with its joy and bliss born of seclusion, accompanied by thought and accompanied by examination." Recalling this, he thought, "That is the path; that is the practice. By it one can know, one can see, one can awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Yet it is not easy for me to bring that about while I am this emaciated, weak, and feeble. Come, let me breathe in at ease and breathe out at ease, let me eat coarse food of rice and warm porridge as I please, anoint my body with butter and sesame oil, and bathe my body with soft water." So he breathed in at ease and breathed out at ease, took coarse food of rice and warm porridge as he pleased, anointed his body with sesame oil and butter, and bathed his body with soft water.

Then those attendants of his thought, "Friends, this ascetic Gautama has grown lax in his restraint, given to abundance, and has fallen away from renunciation. Now he eats plenty of food, rice and warm porridge, anoints his body with clarified butter and sesame oil, and bathes his body with soft water. Now he will not be able to attain anything at all." Having thought this, they abandoned the bodhisattva and went away, and in stages they reached Vārāṇasī and stayed in the Deer Park at Ṛṣivadana.

Then the bodhisattva gradually regained his bodily strength and vigor, and his diligence, and in stages he came to the town of Senānī. He stayed on the bank of the Nairañjanā River near the town called Senānī. A brahmin named Deva, who had formerly been a friend of the bodhisattva, lived in the town of Senānī. Seeing the bodhisattva practicing hardships, he said to two village girls, Nandā and Nandabalā, "Have you heard the prophecy of the soothsayers that if the son of King Śuddhodana did not go forth, he would become a universal monarch?" The two of them said, "We too made the aspiration, 'If he becomes a universal monarch, may we become his queens.'" The brahmin Deva said, "When that great being, his body tormented by austerities, rises from his renunciation, you two must be the very first to offer him alms. That will bring you both benefit and happiness for a long time."

When the girls Nandā and Nandabalā heard this, they milked a thousand cows. Having milked them, they fed that milk to five hundred cows. Having milked the five hundred cows, they fed the milk to two hundred and fifty. Having milked the two hundred and fifty, they fed it to a hundred. Having milked the

hundred, they fed it to fifty. Having milked the fifty, they fed it to twenty. Having milked the twenty, they kindled a fire, poured the milk into a vessel made of crystal, and began to boil a milk porridge. The brahmins thought, "Surely there is going to be a bride taken or a bride given away here," and many brahmins gathered. As the thousandfold-enriched milk porridge boiled, there appeared in it the signs of an auspicious vase, a śrīvatsa, and a swastika. A wandering ascetic called Upaga saw this and thought, "Whoever drinks this milk porridge will attain unsurpassed wisdom. Come, let me beg for it."

Then Śakra thought, "The bodhisattva's body has been weakened by austerities, and he is tormented by hunger and thirst. If the bodhisattva takes the milk porridge, he will realize unsurpassed wisdom. But these brahmins, greedy by nature, have gathered here, and they might do the bodhisattva harm." So he went up Mount Gandhamādana, took a divine medicine, and, emanating himself as a brahmin of great beauty, he sat over the boiling milk porridge, and Śakra, lord of the gods, poured into it the medicine called "Strength-Giving."

Then, having boiled the thousandfold-enriched milk porridge, sweet as honey, Nandā and Nandabalā said to Śakra, lord of the gods, "Are you the son of King Śuddhodana?" Śakra said, "He is my preceptor; I am his student." Then Śakra, lord of the gods, took the thousandfold-enriched milk porridge, sweet as honey. Having taken it, he said to the two of them, Nandā and Nandabalā, "What do you two seek by this gift? For what purpose should the merit of the offering be dedicated?" The two of them said:

"Whatever merit there may be in offering this savory food,
may all the aims of that renowned one, who has accomplished every aim,
who has become supreme among humans, endowed with supreme understanding,
be swiftly and perfectly accomplished!"

Then the bodhisattva entered the Nairañjanā River and bathed. He wished to cross, but because his body was so weak he was unable to cross. The gods bent down the branch of an arjuna tree, and holding on to it the bodhisattva crossed over. He dried his robes and sat on the bank of the Nairañjanā River.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that the bodhisattva was seated at ease, poured the thousandfold-enriched milk porridge, sweet as honey, into a bowl and offered it to the bodhisattva. The bodhisattva ate it and dedicated the merit of the offering.

Then the bodhisattva searched along the bank of the Nairañjanā River, here and there, for a place to stay. At length he saw a great rocky mountain with flowers and all kinds of fruit. He climbed it, and in a secluded and clear spot he sat down with his legs crossed. No sooner had he sat down than that very mountain crumbled.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "What could be the cause that this mountain has crumbled? Are the gods displeased at my coming, or is some obstacle about to arise?" The gods, knowing the bodhisattva's thought, said to him, "Bodhisattva, there are two whom the whole earth cannot bear to hold up: one whose roots of virtue are severed, and one whose roots of virtue are fully refined. You are one whose roots of virtue are fully refined. This is not a place for bodhisattvas. Go on ahead instead; there lies the vajra seat. Seated there, all the bodhisattvas of the past, the future, and the present have attained and will attain unsurpassed wisdom."

Then, as the bodhisattva went along the way the gods had shown him, lotuses sprang up wherever he set his feet. Water came down from the four great oceans, and lotus ponds appeared. When he took a step and pressed down, this great earth began to ring out like a bronze vessel. Jays and wild animals circled around the bodhisattva. The young gods who send the winds sent the wind ever so gently, and the young gods who send the rain let fall a light rain.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Since such auspicious signs as these have appeared for me, this very day I shall attain unsurpassed wisdom."

On the bank of the Nairañjanā River there lived a blind nāga king called Kālika. A dwelling there had come to him, born of the ripening of his karma: when a buddha appears, he gains his sight, and when that buddha passes into parinirvāṇa, he becomes blind once more. At the sound of the earth ringing out, he came out of his dwelling, and from far away he saw the bodhisattva, his body entirely adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and embellished with the eighty excellent features, adorned with a halo a fathom wide, with rays of light surpassing a thousand suns, altogether beautiful like a mountain of jewels in motion. As soon as he saw him, he began to praise the bodhisattva in a chant of verses:

"Hearing the sound of the earth,
all filled with joyful song,
he came out from the nāga dwelling
and looked around in every direction.

The chief of those that move upon their breasts,
the nāga king of great power,
saw on the bank of the Nairañjanā
the guide of the world approaching.

By the power of a buddha's appearing,
the nāga gained his sight,
and with his mind joyful and heart delighted,
he spoke these words:

'When I see you, O Sage,
there is no difference to tell
between you and those buddhas of great power
whom I have seen before.

From the way, O Sage,
you first lift your right foot,
today you will become a buddha
and the field of offerings for the world.

From the way you dried your robes
and the way you entered
the cool water of the Nairañjanā,
today you will become a buddha.

Since you go with a steady gait,
moving majestically like a lordly bull,
O bull among men, supreme among the upholders of the Dharma,
today, here, you will become a supreme buddha.

Since hundreds of jays in the sky
soar about and circle
your vast, vast body,
today, O best of men, you will become a supreme buddha.

Since a fragrant breeze arises,
the herds of deer and flocks of birds are unafraid,
and the trees are not shaken by the wind,
today, O best of men, you will become a supreme buddha.

Since, venerable one, the light of your face,
like the blazing light of stainless gold,
is radiantly beautiful and full of color,

today, O best of men, you will become a supreme buddha.'"

Then the bodhisattva, having been fully praised by the nāga king Kālika, went toward the vajra seat. Then the bodhisattva thought, "I shall sit on a mat of grass." When he had need of grass, Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing in his mind the bodhisattva's intention, took from Mount Gandhamādana a load of grass as pleasant to the touch as cotton down, emanated himself in the guise of the grass seller Svastika, and stood before the bodhisattva. The bodhisattva said, "Good sir, give me grass." Śakra, lord of the gods, touched the bodhisattva's two feet and offered it with reverence.

The bodhisattva accepted the grass from the grass seller Svastika, and with a bearing that captivated the minds of gods and humans, he inspired faith in beings. Along the path the gods had shown, he went to where the seat of awakening was. Taking his place at the vajra seat, which is like the hub of the wheel of the great trichiliocosm world system, he resolutely spread the grass himself, unruffled and neither too thick nor too thin. Then he made a resolve in his mind and spoke it aloud as well:

"Until I have attained the exhaustion of defilements,
the end of all suffering,
even though my life should come to an end,
I shall not break this cross-legged posture."

Having said this, the bodhisattva mounted the vajra seat, sat down cross-legged like the coiled body of a sleeping serpent king, held his body straight and upright, set mindfulness before him, and remained there. The very moment he sat down, the abode of Māra, the Evil One, was shaken.

Then Māra, the Evil One, thought, "Why has my abode been shaken?" At length he saw the bodhisattva seated on the vajra seat. Then Māra, the Evil One, thought, "The son of the Śākya Śuddhodana is sitting on the vajra seat. As long as he has not passed beyond my domain, I shall make obstacles for him." Having thought this, he emanated himself in the form of a messenger carrying a letter, his hair standing on end and wearing a lower garment of hemp, and went to where the bodhisattva was. Arriving, he said in haste, "The city of Kapilavastu has been overrun by Devadatta, the palace has been destroyed, and the Śākyas have been subjugated. Why are you sitting here, settled in this place?"

Then three evil, unwholesome thoughts arose in the bodhisattva, namely: the thought of desire, the thought of ill will, and the thought of harming. The thought of desire was toward Yaśodharā, Mṛgajā, and Gopikā. The thought of ill will was toward Devadatta. The thought of harming was toward the Śākyas who lived as his followers. Then the bodhisattva reflected, "Why have three evil, unwholesome thoughts arisen in me?" At length he saw that Māra, the Evil One, had come near in order to stir up trouble. Then three wholesome thoughts arose in the bodhisattva, namely: the thought of renunciation, the thought free of ill will, and the thought free of harming.

Again Māra said, "Why are you sitting at the seat of awakening?" The bodhisattva said, "In order to attain unsurpassed wisdom." Māra said, "How could you attain unsurpassed wisdom?" The bodhisattva said, "Evil One, if you, by performing just one sacrifice, became the lord of the desire realm in all his splendor, then what need is there to say that I, who for three incalculable eons have performed many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of sacrifices, and for the sake of beings have given away my head, hands, feet, eyes, flesh, blood, sons, wife, wealth, gold, and so on, shall attain unsurpassed wisdom? Your hope that I shall not attain unsurpassed wisdom is vain."

When he had said this, Māra said, "As for how I attained lordship of the desire realm through my one sacrifice, you are my witness. But who is your witness that, in order to attain unsurpassed wisdom, you performed many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of sacrifices over three incalculable eons, and gave away your head, hands, feet, eyes, flesh, blood, sons, wife, wealth, gold, and so on, for the sake of beings?"

Then the bodhisattva touched the earth with his hand, the hand of a Blessed One, marked with the wheel, the auspicious emblem, and the swastika, joined by a web, produced by many hundreds of merits, and bringing relief to the frightened. He said, "This earth is my witness that I performed many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of sacrifices over three incalculable eons, and gave away my head, hands, feet, eyes, flesh, blood, sons, wife, wealth, gold, and so on, for the sake of beings." Then the goddess of the earth broke up through the ground, joined her palms, and cried out, "Evil One, it is just as the Blessed One has said." When she had said this, Māra, the Evil One, fell silent; he became dejected, became abashed, hung his head, lost his confidence, and sat there brooding.

Then Māra, the Evil One, thought, "Though I did that to the son of Śuddhodana, I found no opening. Come, let me make one more obstacle for him." So, together with thirty-six koṭis of troops with mighty forces, resembling elephants, horses, camels, goats, deer, buffalo, pigs, dogs, owls, mongooses, monkeys, foxes, and the like, terrifying, brandishing weapons such as swords, great arrows, spikes, discs, short spears, bows, nooses, axes, and iron clubs, he completely surrounded the bodhisattva and took up position, and Māra, the Evil One, himself stood there with his bow drawn back to his ear.

Then the bodhisattva saw them, of so many forms and equipped with so many kinds of weapons, and this thought arose in him: "Even when one begins to fight with an ordinary person, one applies oneself to the remedy against him; what need then to speak of this lord of the desire realm? Come, let me apply myself to the remedy." Having thought this, he began to consider the means by which they might be pacified. Māra, together with thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas, began to rain down weapons upon the bodhisattva from above: discs, short spears, great arrows, spikes, arrows, and the like. Then the bodhisattva emanated a celestial palace made of crystal, and all the weapons fell upon that celestial palace. At the sound of the celestial palace, the whole army of Māra was terrified and scattered in every direction.

Then, in the first watch of the night, the bodhisattva remained endowed with constant practice and wakefulness, diligently pursuing the yoga of meditating on the dharmas that accord with awakening. In the first watch of the night, when he set his mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the domain of miraculous powers, he experienced the many kinds of miraculous powers: being one, he became many, and being many, he became one; he appeared and disappeared; all this he experienced through the vision of wisdom. With his body he passed straight through walls, mountains, and fences, as a bird does through the sky. He rose up out of the earth and plunged into it, as a bird does in water. He went upon the flowing water without sinking, as a bird does upon the ground.

He traveled through the sky in the cross-legged posture, like a winged bird. Even the sun and moon, so mighty in miraculous power and so great in splendor, he touched and stroked with his hand, and with his body he exercised mastery as far as the world of Brahmā.

Then Māra, the Evil One, thought, "Sound is the thorn of meditative concentration. Come, let me stay far off and raise a din." Having thought this,

he, together with thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas, raised a terrifying sound of great dread. To block it out, the bodhisattva emanated a grove of kadamba trees twelve leagues across, and so the sound was stifled and did not resound.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Come, let me set my mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of the divine ear, and so listen to whatever sounds of gods and humans I wish to hear." Having thought this, when he set his mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of the divine ear, with his divine ear, purified and surpassing that of humans, he heard both kinds of sound, those of humans and those of nonhumans, both those far away and those nearby.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Of the thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas in Māra's retinue, how am I to know which of them intend me harm and which do not?" Then that bodhisattva thought, "It is through the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of the varieties of mind." Having thought this, in the middle watch of the night, when he set his mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of the varieties of mind, with his own mind he fully knew, just as they were, the minds of other beings and other persons, with their thinking and examining. A mind with desire he fully knew, just as it was, as "a mind with desire." A mind free of desire he fully knew, just as it was, as "a mind free of desire." Minds with aversion and free of aversion, with delusion and free of delusion, collected and scattered, sluggish and exerted, agitated and not agitated, not calmed and calmed, not composed and composed, undeveloped and developed, minds not liberated and liberated: these he fully knew just as they were. A mind thoroughly liberated he fully knew, truly and just as it was, as "a thoroughly liberated mind."

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Among these servants of Māra, how am I to know which of them were related to me as mother or as father in other lives, and which were my executioners, my adversaries, or my enemies?" Then the bodhisattva thought, "It is through the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of recollecting former existences." Having thought this, in the middle watch of the night, when he set his mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of recollecting former existences, he recollected many kinds of former existence, namely: one birth, two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, ten, twenty, thirty, forty, fifty births, a hundred births, a thousand births, a hundred thousand births, many hundreds of births, many thousands of births, many hundreds of thousands of births; an eon of dissolution, an eon of formation, an eon of dissolution and formation, many eons of dissolution,

many eons of formation, many eons of dissolution and formation. He recollected: "When I formerly lived among these beings, my name was such, my caste was such, my clan was such. I ate such food. I experienced such pleasure and pain. I lived for so long a life. I remained for such a length of time. I lived out a life of such a span. Then I died, passed on, and was born in such and such a place. From there too I died, passed on, and was born in such and such a place. From there too I died, passed on, and was born here." In this way he recollected many kinds of former existence, with their details and their locations.

Then the bodhisattva thought, "Among these servants of Māra, how am I to know which of them will go to the lower realms and which will not go to the lower realms?" Then the bodhisattva thought, "It is through the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of death, transmigration, and birth." Having thought this, in the last watch of the night, when he set his mind on the higher knowledge that realizes the knowledge of death, transmigration, and birth, he looked with his divine eye, purified and surpassing that of humans, and he fully knew, just as it is, the death, transmigration, and birth of beings, beings of good complexion and of bad complexion, lowly and excellent, going to the happy destinies and to the unhappy destinies, faring just as they actually fare. He fully knew: "Friends, these beings are possessed of misconduct of body, of speech, and of mind. They disparage the noble ones and hold wrong views. Because of having taken up the dharmas and actions of wrong view, by that cause and that condition, when the body breaks up, after death they will be born in the lower realms, the unhappy destinies, fallen into ruin, among the beings of the hells. Friends, these beings are possessed of good conduct of body, of speech, and of mind. They do not disparage the noble ones and hold right view. Because of having taken up the dharmas and actions of right view, by that cause and that condition, when the body breaks up, after death they will be born in the happy destinies, in the heavenly world, among gods and humans."

Then the bodhisattva, seated at the foot of the tree of awakening, constantly applying himself with diligence and vigilance, remained in a yoga of meditation in accord with the dharmas that are factors of awakening. In the last watch of that night, when he directed his mind toward the knowledge that brings about direct realization of the knowledge of the exhaustion of the defilements, he fully understood, just as it is: "This is the noble truth of suffering." He fully understood, just as it is: "This is the origin of suffering. This

is the cessation of suffering. This is the noble truth of the path leading to the cessation of suffering." As he knew thus and saw thus, his mind was liberated from the defilement of desire, and his mind was liberated from the defilement of existence and the defilement of ignorance. Liberated, he realized: "My birth is exhausted. I have lived the holy life. What was to be done has been done. I know no further existence beyond this." And right there he realized: "I have fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." Thus in the last watch of the night the Blessed One, by the weapon of loving-kindness, was victorious over Māra together with his thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas, and attained unsurpassed wisdom.

Then the bow slipped from the hand of Māra the Evil One, his banner turned its tip downward, and his abode was shaken. Then Māra the Evil One, together with his retinue of thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas, suffering, unhappy and distressed at heart, vanished from that very spot and went to his own abode. Suffering, unhappy and defeated, he sank into brooding, and remained there scratching the ground with an arrow.

Then the daughters of Māra, named Tṛṣṇā, Delight-Maker and Delight-Enjoyer, went to where Māra was, and having arrived, spoke to Māra the Evil One as follows:

"Father, why are you not pleased?
Why do you sit like this?
What man is it who harms you,
That you keep brooding on him?
Tell us, and with the noose
Of desire, like an elephant from the forest,
We shall bind him and bring him here:
He will fall into your power."

Māra said:

"That man is utterly free of desire;
He cannot be lured by attachment.
He has passed beyond the domain of Māra:
That is why I grieve so deeply."

Then Tṛṣṇā, Delight-Maker and Delight-Enjoyer, the three daughters of Māra, blazing with splendor like lightning issuing from a cloud, went from their own abode toward where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side,

the three daughters of Māra the Evil One addressed the Blessed One as follows: "O ascetic, we shall honor your feet; Sugata, we shall serve you." But the Blessed One, having attained the unsurpassed state in which craving is completely exhausted and liberated, and the mind is completely and perfectly liberated, paid no attention to them.

A second and a third time the three daughters of Māra addressed the Blessed One as follows: "O ascetic, we shall honor your feet; Sugata, we shall serve you." A second and a third time, the Blessed One, having attained the unsurpassed state in which craving is completely exhausted and liberated, and the mind is completely and perfectly liberated, paid no attention to them.

Then the three daughters of Māra went off to one side, and talking among themselves, they consulted together: "Wise sisters, since men's craving for women differs from one to another, let us conjure ourselves up as hundreds of young women of every complexion, with garments in hundreds of colors; let us conjure ourselves up as women who have never given birth, who have given birth once, twice, three times and four times; let us conjure ourselves up in hundreds of forms of women of middle age, and approach the ascetic Gautama. Having arrived, let us say to the ascetic Gautama: 'O ascetic, we shall honor your feet; Sugata, we shall serve you.'"

Then the three daughters of Māra conjured themselves up as many hundreds of thousands of young women of every complexion, with garments in hundreds of colors, and so on up to hundreds of forms of middle-aged women, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, they addressed the Blessed One as follows: "O ascetic, we shall honor your feet; Sugata, we shall serve you." But the Blessed One, having attained the unsurpassed state in which craving is completely exhausted and liberated, and the mind is completely and perfectly liberated, paid no attention to them. Though the three daughters of Māra addressed the Blessed One thus a second and a third time, a second and a third time the Blessed One paid no attention to them.

Then the three daughters of Māra went off to one side and said to one another: "Sisters, if men who are not free of desire are approached and attended in so many ways as these, it can happen that their minds are thrown into turmoil, or their hearts burst, or they vomit hot blood from their mouths. Yet this ascetic Gautama pays us no attention. But since men's craving for women differs from

one to another, let us conjure ourselves up in hundreds of forms of old women and go before the ascetic Gautama. If we do that, it may be that the ascetic Gautama will develop desire for us." Having said this, the three daughters of Māra conjured themselves up in hundreds of forms of old women and went to where the Blessed One was. They addressed him as before, up to "we shall serve you," but the Blessed One, having attained the unsurpassed state in which craving is completely exhausted and liberated, and the mind is completely and perfectly liberated, paid no attention to them.

Then the Blessed One thought: "These women have made themselves into old women of their own accord. So I too, in order to make them thoroughly disenchanted, shall bless them to remain in this very old age." And the Blessed One blessed the daughters of Māra to remain old women.

Then the three daughters of Māra wished to make that old age disappear, but they were unable to make it disappear. Then the three daughters of Māra, their purpose unfulfilled and as if ashamed of their forms, aged, decrepit and worn out, hunched and bent like a crooked rafter, leaning forward on staffs, their bodies trembling, went to where Māra the Evil One was, and having arrived, spoke to Māra the Evil One as follows: "Father, what you told us is true indeed:

'That man is utterly free of desire;
He cannot be lured by attachment.
He has passed beyond the domain of Māra:
That is why I grieve so deeply.'

There is no means of clouding another's mind
That we did not employ,
And even so he did not fall under our power.
At last, when we took forms like these
And went up close to him,
He blessed us
To remain in old age just as we are.
Therefore, Father, please make
This old age of ours disappear."

Māra said:

"Proud of your forms,
Like lightning from a mass of clouds,
Blazing with splendor,

You went, puffed up with eager pride.
When you reached that great hero,
You were scattered like cotton by the wind.
Whoever would do harm here
To the Buddha, who has put an end to all attachment,
Wants to dig a mountain with fingernails,
To chew iron with teeth,
To topple a mountain
With the stalk of a young lotus.
Whoever wishes to do harm here
To the Buddha, who has put an end to all attachment,
Wants to dig out the ocean
And search for its deepest floor.
Whoever wishes to do harm here
To the Buddha, who has put an end to all attachment,
Wants to bind the wind with a noose,
To bring the moon down from the sky,
To scoop out the ocean with his hands,
To leap across the snowy mountains,
And to embrace a fire
Blazing bright and burning.
Whoever wishes to do the impossible,
This is how it will turn out.
Now then, go for refuge
To that very Sage,
And this form of old age
Will be turned to something else.
Since he has great compassion,
He will surely remove it for you.

In the world with its gods, its māras and its Brahmās, among beings with their ascetics and brahmins, in the world with its gods, humans and asuras, I see no one other than that very Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, who could make your state of old age disappear. Go, and win the favor of that Blessed One."

Then the three daughters of Māra went toward where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down

to one side. Seated to one side, the three daughters of Māra addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Venerable Blessed One, like children, like fools, like the undiscerning, like those unskilled in means, we failed to please the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, as he ought to be pleased. That was our transgression. Blessed One, please accept our confession of this transgression. Sugata, please forgive us. Blessed One, please make our state of old age disappear. Sugata, please make our state of old age disappear." Then the Blessed One made their state of old age disappear. Then the three daughters of Māra, having regained their own forms, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, gained faith in the Blessed One, and vanished from that very spot.

Then King Śuddhodana's own men announced to him: "Your Majesty, rejoice! The prince has attained unsurpassed wisdom." When he heard that, on that very same day Yaśodharā also gave birth to a boy, and to Amṛtodana too a boy was born. On that same day the moon was seized by Rāhu. Then King Śuddhodana, seeing such good fortune, was filled with joy, delight, gladness, great elation and happiness of mind.

Then the city of Kapilavastu was cleared of stones, gravel and potsherds, sprinkled with sandalwood water, and set about with the most fragrant incense. Many silken streamers were hung, banners and flags were raised, and all kinds of flowers were strewn as pleasingly as could be. At the four gates of the city and at the crossroads, almshouses were built. Then at the eastern gate of the city gifts were given to ascetics, brahmins, wandering mendicants (carakas and parivrājakas), the wretched, the friendless, the poor, the destitute and beggars. At the crossroads of the south, the west, the north and the center too, gifts were given and merit was made.

When it came to naming Yaśodharā's son, the people of the queen's retinue said: "When he was born, the moon was seized by Rāhu, so the boy shall be named Rāhula." And so he was named.

Amṛtodana likewise gave gifts and made merit, and then, asking, "What shall the boy be named?", set about naming his son. His relatives said: "When he was born, the whole city rejoiced, so the boy shall be named Ānanda." And so he was named.

King Śuddhodana said: "This son of Yaśodharā is not the son of Śākyamuni." When Yaśodharā heard this, she was cast into despair.

Then she placed him on a stone the size of the bodhisattva's lap, sat down at the edge of the pleasure pond, and made a declaration of truth: "If this child was born of the bodhisattva, then let him float on this pond together with the stone. If not, let him sink." Having said this, she cast him into the water, and like a tuft of cotton he floated together with the stone.

King Śuddhodana, hearing of this marvel, went to the edge of the bodhisattva's pleasure pond surrounded by a great crowd of people, and there he saw the good Rāhula riding on the stone the size of the bodhisattva's lap, floating on the water like a tuft of cotton. Seeing this, he was filled with joy, delight, gladness, great elation and happiness of mind. At once he entered the pond, took the young prince, the good Rāhula, up onto his lap, and stood up.

When the Blessed One, by the weapon of loving-kindness, had subdued Māra's retinue of thirty-six koṭis of bhūtas and attained unsurpassed wisdom, at that moment this great earth shook violently. This whole world too was lit up by a great radiance. Even the spaces between the worlds, in pitch-black darkness, where the light of the sun and moon, so magically potent and so mighty, is never felt, were at that time lit up by a great radiance. The beings who had been born there, seeing one another by that light, recognized one another, saying, "Friends, look, other beings have been born here too! Friends, look, other beings have been born here too!"

The Buddha, the Blessed One, entered the absorption of the fire element and spent seven days in a single cross-legged posture. Then two gods of the Brahmakāyika class, dwelling in the Brahmā world, thought: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, is dwelling in Uruvilvā on the bank of the Nairañjanā River at the foot of the tree of awakening. Not long after his perfect and complete awakening, he has entered the absorption of the fire element and is spending seven days in a single cross-legged posture, and no one has offered him alms. Let us go there and praise him with a verse each."

Then, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or bend his stretched arm, the two Brahmakāyika gods vanished from the Brahmakāyika world, came before the Blessed One, and sat down to one side. One of the two Brahmakāyika gods addressed him in verse:

"Caravan leader, victor in battle,
Free of evil, arise, seer of the world!
Here are those who seek the precious Dharma:
Sugata, please teach the supreme Dharma."

The other also addressed him in verse:

"Destroyer of pride, victor in battle,
Free of evil, arise, seer of the world!
Like the full moon on the fifteenth night,
Your mind is utterly pure."

Having said this, the two Brahmakāyika gods vanished from that very spot. Then the Blessed One arose from that samādhi, and at that time he spoke these verses:

"Whatever pleasure of the senses in the world,
And whatever bliss arises in the realm of the gods,
They are not worth even a sixteenth part
Of the bliss of craving's exhaustion.
Carrying a burden is suffering;
Laying the burden down is happiness.
Having laid down the heavy burden,
Take up no other.
Having abandoned all craving
And exhausted all conditioned things,
When one fully knows all things,
One does not come into existence again."

While the Buddha, the Blessed One, experiencing in his body the joy and bliss of liberation, spent seven days in a single cross-legged posture, no one offered him alms. At that time the two merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika, traveling with some five hundred wagons, set out on that very road. Then a god who had once been a friend, minister, relative and companion of the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika thought: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, is dwelling in Uruvilvā on the bank of the Nairañjanā River at the foot of the tree of awakening. Not long after his perfect and complete awakening, experiencing in his body the joy and bliss of liberation, he has spent seven days in a single cross-legged posture, and no one has offered him alms. If I lead the two merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika to be the first to offer him alms there, it will be for their long-lasting good, benefit and happiness. So I myself shall strive to have them offer alms to the Blessed One."

So that god lit up the wagons and all the merchants with a great radiance and spoke to the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika as follows: "Merchants, merchants, this Buddha, the Blessed One, is dwelling in Uruvilvā on the bank

of the Nairañjanā River at the foot of the tree of awakening. Not long after his perfect and complete awakening, experiencing in his body the joy and bliss of liberation, he has spent seven days in a single cross-legged posture, and no one has offered him alms. If you are the first to offer him alms there, it will be for your long-lasting good, benefit and happiness." Having said this, the god vanished from that very spot.

Then the two merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika thought: "The Buddha is surely supreme, and his teaching of the Dharma is surely supreme too, since even a god strives in this way to have alms offered to that Blessed One." So they rose early in the morning, took plenty of honey and barley meal, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at both the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika addressed the Blessed One as follows:

"Venerable One, we have brought plenty of honey and barley meal here for the Blessed One. Out of compassion, Blessed One, please accept it."

Then the Blessed One thought: "If I accept alms in my hands, I will be like the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). That is not fitting for me. Let me consider in what the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas of the past accepted alms for the benefit of living beings." As he thought this, gods said to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas of the past accepted alms in a bowl in order to benefit living beings." When the Blessed One too reflected and brought forth the vision of wisdom, he saw that the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, had accepted alms in a bowl for the benefit of living beings, and so the thought of a bowl arose in the Blessed One.

Then the Four Great Kings, knowing that the thought of a bowl had arisen in the Blessed One, took from a certain rocky mountain four bowls made of stone, made by nonhumans and kept by nonhumans, clear, clean and free of any foul smell, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at both the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the Four Great Kings addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Venerable One, knowing that the Blessed One has need of a bowl, we have brought here four stone bowls from a certain rocky mountain, made of stone by nonhumans and kept by nonhumans, clear, clean and free of any foul smell. Out of compassion, Blessed One, please accept them."

Then the Blessed One thought: "If I accept one bowl from one Great King, three will be displeased. If I accept from two, two will be displeased. If I accept

from three, one will be displeased. So let me accept four bowls from the Four Great Kings and bless them into a single bowl." Then the Blessed One accepted the four bowls from the Four Great Kings and blessed them into a single bowl.

Then, for the benefit of living beings, the Blessed One accepted alms from the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika. Then the Blessed One spoke to the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika as follows: "Merchants, come, go for refuge to the Buddha, go for refuge to the Dharma, and go for refuge also to what will arise in the future, called the Saṅgha."

"Venerable One, we go for refuge to the Buddha. We go for refuge to the Dharma. We go for refuge also to the Saṅgha that will arise in the future."

Then the Blessed One rejoiced in the gift of the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika:

"For whatever purpose a gift is given,
It serves that very purpose:
If a gift is given for the sake of happiness,
It turns into happiness.
The ripening of merit is happiness,
And one's aspirations too are fulfilled;
Swiftly one realizes nirvāṇa,
The supreme peace.
As for harm arising from others,
The hosts of gods and māras
Cannot obstruct
One who does nothing but merit.
If one who is generous
Strives for the sake of noble wisdom,
He will attain what is called the clear seeing
That puts an end to suffering."

Then the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika, delighting and rejoicing in what the Blessed One had said, bowed their heads at both the Blessed One's feet and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One, having accepted the alms from the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika, went to where the Nairañjanā River was. Having arrived, he sat on the bank of the Nairañjanā River and took his meal. The honey stirred up wind, and the barley meal too stirred up wind, and so the Blessed One fell ill

with a wind disorder.

Then Māra the Evil One, knowing that the Blessed One had fallen ill with a wind disorder, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, the time has come for you to pass into parinirvāṇa. Sugata, the time has come for you to pass into parinirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One thought: "This Māra the Evil One has come here to make trouble." Having thought this, he spoke to Māra the Evil One as follows: "Evil One, as long as there have not arisen monks, nuns, laymen and laywomen who are my hearers, learned, clear-minded and steady, able to refute in accord with the Dharma the arguments of opponents whenever they arise, and able to make their own teaching clear, and as long as my holy life has not been taught widely, truly and well, extensively, to many people, among gods and humans, I shall not pass into parinirvāṇa."

Then Māra the Evil One thought, "Alas! The ascetic Gautama will not pass into parinirvāṇa." Thinking this, suffering, unhappy and full of regret, he vanished from that very spot.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that the Blessed One had fallen ill with a wind disorder, went to a great grove of myrobalan trees not very far from the tree called jambu, after which the continent of Jambudvīpa is named. Taking from there myrobalan fruit endowed with fine color, fragrance and taste, he went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at both the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One as follows:

"Venerable One, knowing that the Blessed One has fallen ill with a chill, I went to a great grove of myrobalan trees not far from the tree called jambu, after which the continent of Jambudvīpa is named, and from there I have brought myrobalan fruit endowed with fine color, fragrance and taste. Blessed One, please eat it. When the Blessed One eats it, it will counter the chill, and the chill will be relieved."

When the Blessed One ate it, it countered the wind, and the wind disorder was relieved. Then the Blessed One became quite at ease and thrived. Then the Blessed One, having stayed at the foot of the tree of awakening for as long as he pleased, went to the abode of Mucilinda, the nāga king. Having arrived, he took his seat at the foot of a tree, crossed his legs, held his body upright, set his mindfulness before him, and remained there.

At that time unseasonable clouds gathered over the abode of Mucilinda, the nāga king, for seven days. Then Mucilinda, the nāga king, knowing that unseasonable clouds had gathered for seven days, rose up out of his abode, thinking, "During these seven days the Blessed One might grow cold, and heat, flies, mosquitoes, wind, sun and the touch of snakes and scorpions might harm his body." So he wrapped his body seven times around the body of the Blessed One and stayed there, spreading the great hood of his head above him.

Then Mucilinda, the nāga king, knowing that the unseasonable clouds of the seven days had gone, unwound his body from the body of the Blessed One. Anointed with unguents and adorned with armlets, earrings, garlands and all kinds of ornaments, he bowed with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was and addressed the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, during these seven days did you not grow cold? Did heat, flies, mosquitoes, chill, sun, or the harm of snakes and scorpions not touch your body?"

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke these verses:

"The joy of truth is happiness,
And so is looking to hearing the Dharma.
With restraint toward living beings,
Being free of harm in the world is happiness.
Being free of desire for the world
And going beyond sense pleasures is happiness.
Whoever has subdued the pride of 'I am':
That is the supreme happiness."

Then the Blessed One, having stayed in the abode of Mucilinda, the nāga king, for as long as he wished, went to the seat of awakening. Having arrived, he sat on the grass mat that had been spread there, crossed his legs, held his body upright, set his mindfulness before him, and spent seven days in a single cross-legged posture, contemplating dependent origination with its twelve links in forward and reverse order, as follows:

When this exists, that exists; from the arising of this, that arises. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance are formations; conditioned by formations is consciousness; conditioned by consciousness are name and form; conditioned by name and form are the six sense bases; conditioned by the six sense bases is contact; conditioned by contact is feeling; conditioned by feeling is craving; conditioned by craving is grasping; conditioned by grasping is becoming;

conditioned by becoming is birth; conditioned by birth arise aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress. Thus does this whole great mass of suffering arise.

When this does not exist, that does not exist; from the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: from the cessation of ignorance, formations cease; from the cessation of formations, consciousness ceases; from the cessation of consciousness, name and form cease; from the cessation of name and form, the six sense bases cease; from the cessation of the six sense bases, contact ceases; from the cessation of contact, feeling ceases; from the cessation of feeling, craving ceases; from the cessation of craving, grasping ceases; from the cessation of grasping, becoming ceases; from the cessation of becoming, birth ceases; from the cessation of birth, aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, unhappiness and distress cease. Thus does this whole great mass of suffering cease.

Then the Blessed One, having let those seven days pass, arose from that meditative absorption, and at that time he spoke these verses:

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
When he knows phenomena together with their cause,
Then all his doubts depart.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
When he knows suffering together with its cause,
Then all his doubts depart.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
When he has attained the exhaustion of feelings,
Then all his doubts depart.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
When he has attained the exhaustion of conditions,
Then all his doubts depart.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
When he has attained the exhaustion of the defilements,

Then all his doubts depart.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
He abides illuminating the whole world,
Like the sun risen in the sky.

When these dharmas arise
For the brahmin, diligent and meditating,
He stands, having crushed the hosts of Māra;
The Buddha is freed from every fetter.

Then the Blessed One thought, "I have realized a Dharma that is profound and profound in appearance, hard to see and hard to comprehend, not within the scope of the reasoning of logicians, subtle, to be understood by the wise, the learned and the knowing. Were I to teach it to others and they did not understand it, that would only weary me, exhaust me, and leave my mind without enthusiasm. So let me dwell alone in the depths of a forest wilderness, devoted to the yoga of dwelling at ease in this very life."

So the Blessed One inclined his mind toward remaining at ease, inactive, and not toward teaching the Dharma.

Then Brahmā Sahāṃpati, lord of this world of endurance, thought, "Alas, this world is lost! Alas, this world is lost! For only rarely, once in a long while, does a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha appear in the world, like the udumbara flower; and now that Blessed One is inclining his mind toward remaining inactive, and not toward teaching the Dharma. Let me go to him and entreat him."

Then, in the time it takes a strong man to stretch out his bent arm or to bend his outstretched arm, Brahmā Sahāṃpati vanished from the Brahmā world and stood before the Blessed One. Then Brahmā Sahāṃpati at that time addressed him in verse:

In Magadha there arose before a Dharma
That is not pure, conceived by the stained.
Open, I pray, the door of the deathless Dharma;
Teach what the stainless one has realized.

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke in verse:

Brahmā, what I have realized
With great hardship, having destroyed the faults,
This Dharma, those bound by existence and attachment
Will not rightly realize.
The path that runs against the stream,
Profound and very hard to see,
Those veiled by a mass of darkness,
Clinging to desire, will not see.

"Venerable One, among the beings born in the world and grown old in the world there are those of sharp faculties, of middling faculties and of dull faculties, those easy to set straight, easy to train, of few afflictions and of little dust; if they do not hear the sublime Dharma, they will be utterly lost. Venerable One, it is like blue lotuses, red lotuses, white water lilies or white lotuses, which are born in the water and grow large in the water: some rise up above the water, some stand level with the water, and some remain sunk within the water. Just so, Venerable One, among the beings born in the world and grown old in the world there are those of sharp faculties, of middling faculties and of dull faculties, those easy to set straight, easy to train, of few afflictions and of little dust; if they do not hear the sublime Dharma they will be utterly lost, and so there will be those who come to understand the precious Dharma. Blessed One, please teach the Dharma! Sugata, please teach the Dharma!"

Then the Blessed One thought, "Let me look upon the world with my own buddha eye." Then the Blessed One looked upon the world with his own buddha eye, and as he looked upon the world with his own buddha eye, he saw that among the beings born in the world and grown old in the world there are those whose nature is of sharp faculties, of middling faculties and of dull faculties, easy to set straight, easy to train, of few afflictions and of little dust, and that if they do not hear the sublime Dharma, they will be utterly lost. And having seen this, he turned his great compassion toward sentient beings. Then the Blessed One at that time spoke in verse:

I shall open the doors of the deathless.
Whoever wishes to listen, cast off your doubt!
Brahmā, to humankind the excellent Dharma
I shall teach in brief, not seeking to find fault.

Then Brahmā Sahāṃpati thought, "Oh, the Blessed One will teach the Dharma! How wonderful, the Sugata will teach the Dharma!" Knowing this, he was joyful, delighted, overjoyed, and filled with vast joy and gladness; he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and vanished right there.

Then the Blessed One thought, "To whom shall I first teach the Dharma?" Then the Blessed One thought, "Let me first teach the Dharma to Ārāḍa Kālāma. He was my very first teacher, and yet he showed me the highest respect and honored me with the highest honor; and he too rejoiced in and had faith in the sublime realizations."

The gods said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, it is seven days since the son of Kālāma died."

The Blessed One, too, entered into contemplation, and when he brought forth the vision of wisdom, he saw that seven days had passed since Ārāḍa Kālāma had died. Then the Blessed One thought, "Ah, Ārāḍa Kālāma, who has died, has been unfortunate! Ah, Ārāḍa Kālāma, who has died, has been most unfortunate, for he did not hear this Dharma and Vinaya. Had he heard this Dharma and Vinaya, he would have understood it."

Then the Blessed One thought, "To whom, then, shall I first teach the Dharma?" Then the Blessed One thought, "Let me first teach the Dharma to Udraka Rāmaputra. He was my very first teacher, and yet he showed me the highest respect and honored me with the highest honor; and he too rejoiced in and had faith in the sublime realizations."

The gods said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, Udraka Rāmaputra died yesterday evening." The Blessed One entered into contemplation, and when he brought forth the vision of wisdom, he saw that Udraka Rāmaputra had died in the evening. Then the Blessed One thought, "Ah, Udraka Rāmaputra, who has died, has been unfortunate! Ah, Udraka Rāmaputra, who has died, has been most unfortunate, for he did not hear this Dharma and Vinaya. Had he heard this Dharma and Vinaya, he would certainly have understood it."

Then the Blessed One thought, "To whom, then, shall I first teach the Dharma?" Then he thought, "Let me first teach the Dharma to the monks of the group of five, for when formerly I dwelt devoted to the yoga of abandoning suffering, they stayed with me with reverence, respect and affection."

Then the Blessed One thought, "Where are the monks of the group of five staying now?" And with his divine eye, purified and surpassing that of humans, the Blessed One saw the monks of the group of five staying at Vārāṇasī, in Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park. Having seen them, he remained at the foot of the tree of awakening for as long as he wished, and then set out, wandering, toward Vārāṇasī, the town of Kāśī.

At that time Upaka the Ājīvika had set out on that very road, and Upaka the Ājīvika saw the Blessed One coming along the road. Seeing him, he said this: "Śramaṇa Gautama, your faculties are serene, the color of your face is utterly pure, and your complexion is radiant. Venerable Gautama, who is your teacher? Under whom did you go forth? Whose Dharma do you delight in?"

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke in verse:

There is none who is like me;
I have no teacher whatsoever.
In the world I alone am a buddha;
I have attained true and supreme awakening.

Overcoming all, knowing all the world,
I am not stained by any of these phenomena.
Having abandoned all, free of craving, fully liberated,
Having directly known it by myself, on whom should I rely?

The Tathāgata, teacher of gods and humans,
Possessed of all the powers of omniscience,
Having realized awakening himself, proclaims it well;
Unequalled and without peer, on whom should he rely?

I am the arhat of the world;
Since I am unsurpassed in the world,
In the world together with its gods
I am the Victor who overcomes Māra.

"Venerable Gautama, do you call yourself a Victor?"

Those who have attained the exhaustion of the defilements
Should be known as victors like me.
Since I have conquered evil things,
Therefore, Upaka, I am a Victor.

"Venerable Gautama, where are you going?"

Having gone to Vārāṇasī,
I shall beat the drum of the Dharma
And set fully turning the wheel of the Dharma
That has not been turned in the world.

The omniscient Buddha, gone to peace,
Who has crossed beyond attachment to the world:
Unless he carries the world across,
The holy being cannot be renowned.

Upaka the Ājīvika said, "Venerable Gautama, Victor, excellent!" and went on along the road.

Then the Blessed One, wandering through the land of Kāśī, arrived at Vārāṇasī. At that time the monks of the group of five were staying at Vārāṇasī, in Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park. The monks of the group of five saw the Blessed One from a long way off. Seeing him, they deliberately took counsel with one another, and when they had sat down properly, they made this agreement: "Friends, the śramaṇa Gautama is unsteady, busy with many affairs, living in abundance, fallen from his renunciation. He eats much rice and warm porridge, anoints his body with butter, cream and sesame oil, and bathes his body in gentle water, and now here he comes. When he comes to us, we will not speak to him, we will not pay him homage, we will not rise, and we will not stand up to offer him a seat. Instead, pointing to a seat set out just as it is, we will say these words: 'Venerable Gautama, there is a seat; sit down if you wish.'" So they agreed.

But the nearer the Blessed One came in order to see the monks of the group of five, the less the monks of the group of five could bear the Blessed One's splendor, glory and dignity, and they rose from their seats. Some prepared a seat for the Blessed One; some set water for washing his feet and a footstool to one side; and some went to meet him, took his robe and his Dharma robes, and said, "Come, friend Gautama! Welcome, friend Gautama! Friend Gautama, sit on this very seat that has been prepared."

Then the Blessed One, knowing, "Alas, these foolish men made a rule and then broke it themselves," sat on the seat that had been prepared.

Then the monks of the group of five went on addressing the Blessed One by his name, by his clan name, and as "Venerable." Then the Blessed One said to the monks of the group of five, "Monks, do not go on addressing the Tathāgata by his name, by his clan name, or as 'Venerable.' That will bring you harm,

disadvantage and suffering for a long time."

"Why is that? Monks, whoever goes on addressing the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, by his name, by his clan name, or as 'Venerable,' that foolish man will meet with harm, disadvantage and suffering for a long time."

They said this: "Venerable Gautama, if by your former way of life, your conduct and your austerities you were unable to attain any distinction of a noble state beyond human qualities, and did not attain even the least knowledge, or seeing, or dwelling in direct contact, then now that you are unsteady, busy with many affairs, living in abundance and fallen from your renunciation, eating much rice and warm porridge, anointing your body with butter, cream and sesame oil, and bathing your body in gentle water, what need is there even to speak of it?"

"Monks, do you see the Tathāgata's complexion and the clarity of his faculties to be otherwise, different from before?"

They said this: "Venerable Gautama, it is so."

Then the Blessed One said to the monks of the group of five, "Monks, one who has gone forth should not resort to these two extremes, should not cultivate them, and should not honor them. What are the two? Devotion to the pleasures of desire among desirable things, which is low, base, vulgar and common; and devotion to the exhaustion of oneself, which is painful, ignoble and harmful. When you do not rely on these two extremes, there is the middle path, which produces vision and produces wisdom, and leads to peace, to direct knowledge, to perfect awakening and to nirvāṇa. And what is the middle path? It is this noble eightfold path: right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness and right meditative absorption."

As the Blessed One went on making the monks of the group of five understand what was to be understood in this way, when the Blessed One gave instruction to two of the monks of the group of five in the morning, three would go into the city for alms, and whatever the three obtained sustained all six of them. When the Blessed One gave instruction to three of the monks of the group of five in the afternoon, two would go into the city for alms, and whatever the two obtained sustained the group of five; for the Tathāgata ate only in the morning.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks of the group of five:

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This is the noble truth of suffering,' vision arose in me, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This is the origin of suffering; this is the cessation of suffering; this is the path that leads to the cessation of suffering,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of suffering is to be fully understood by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the origin of suffering is to be abandoned by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the cessation of suffering is to be actualized by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the path that leads to the cessation of suffering is to be cultivated by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of suffering has been fully understood by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the origin of suffering has been abandoned by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the cessation of suffering has been actualized by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and

realization arose.

"Monks, with regard to things not heard before, as I attended properly to 'This noble truth of the path that leads to the cessation of suffering has been cultivated by me through direct knowledge,' vision arose, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization arose.

"Monks, as long as the vision of these four noble truths, thus repeated three times and turned in twelve aspects, had not arisen in me, as long as there was no knowledge, no insight, no understanding, and realization had not arisen, for that long I did not dwell much with a mind released from this world with its gods, its Māras and its Brahmās, from this generation with its śramaṇas and brahmins, its gods and humans, a mind gone forth from it, detached from it, fully liberated and free of distortion; and, monks, I did not recognize that 'I have fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, true and complete awakening.'"

"Monks, once the vision of these four noble truths, thus repeated three times and turned in twelve aspects, had arisen in me, and knowledge, insight, understanding and realization had arisen, from then on I dwelt much with a mind released from this world with its gods, its Māras and its Brahmās, from this generation with its śramaṇas and brahmins, its gods and humans, a mind gone forth from it, detached from it, fully liberated and free of distortion. And, monks, from then on I recognized that 'I have fully and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, true and complete awakening.'"

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, there arose in the venerable Kauṇḍinya and in eighty thousand gods the eye of Dharma regarding phenomena, free of dust and free of stain.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Kauṇḍinya, "Kauṇḍinya, have you understood the Dharma?"

"Blessed One, I have understood."

"Kauṇḍinya, have you understood the Dharma? Have you understood?"

"Sugata, I have understood. I have understood."

Because the venerable Kauṇḍinya had understood the Dharma, the venerable one was therefore given the name Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, "Kauṇḍinya Who Has Understood."

The earth-dwelling yakṣas raised the cry, "The venerable Kauṇḍinya has understood the Dharma!" and they proclaimed aloud, "Friends, at Vārāṇasī, in Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park, the Blessed One has turned the wheel of the Dharma, the wheel in accord with the Dharma, repeated three times in twelve aspects, which no one in the world, whether śramaṇa, brahmin, god, Māra or Brahmā, has turned in accord with the Dharma. He has turned it for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit and happiness of gods and humans. Therefore the families of the gods will flourish, and the ranks of the asuras will dwindle away."

When the yakṣas who move through the sky heard the cry of the earth-dwelling yakṣas, the cry passed on through them, the gods of the Four Great Kings, the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, the Yāma gods, the Tuṣita gods, the Nirmāṇarati gods and the Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, and in that instant, that moment, that very second, in an instant, a moment, a second, it resounded all the way to the Brahmā world. The Brahmakāyika gods too raised the cry and proclaimed aloud, "Friends, at Vārāṇasī, in Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park, the Blessed One has turned the wheel in accord with the Dharma, repeated three times in twelve aspects, which no one in the world, whether śramaṇa, brahmin, god, Māra or Brahmā, has ever even once turned in accord with the Dharma. He has turned it for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit and happiness of gods and humans. Therefore the ranks of the gods will flourish, and the ranks of the asuras will dwindle away."

Because the Blessed One turned the wheel of the Dharma, the wheel in accord with the Dharma, repeated three times in twelve aspects, at Vārāṇasī, in Ṛṣivadana, in the Deer Park, this discourse on the Dharma was therefore given the name "The Turning of the Wheel of the Dharma."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the monks of the group of five a second time: "Monks, there are these four noble truths. What are the four? The noble truth of suffering, the noble truth of the origin of suffering, the noble truth of the cessation of suffering, and the noble truth of the path that leads to the cessation of suffering.

"What is the noble truth of suffering? Birth is suffering, aging is suffering, sickness is suffering, death is suffering, separation from what is dear is suffering, meeting with what is not dear is suffering, seeking what one wants

and not finding it, that too is suffering; in short, the five aggregates of grasping are suffering. In order to understand it fully, one should cultivate the noble eightfold path.

"What is the noble truth of the origin of suffering? It is the craving for renewed existence, accompanied by delight and passion, that longs for this and that. In order to abandon it, one should cultivate the noble eightfold path.

"What is the noble truth of the cessation of suffering? It is the complete abandoning, without remainder, of that very craving for renewed existence, accompanied by delight and passion, that delights in this and that; its relinquishing, its removal, its exhaustion, freedom from passion for it, its cessation, its pacification and its disappearance. In order to actualize it, one should cultivate the noble eightfold path.

"What is the noble truth of the path that leads to the cessation of suffering? It is the noble eightfold path, namely: right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness and right meditative absorption; and that too should be cultivated."

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the mind of the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya was liberated from the defilements, without grasping. In the remaining monks of the group of five there arose the eye of Dharma regarding phenomena, free of dust and free of stain. At that time there were in the world two arhats: one, and the second was the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One spoke again to the remaining monks of the group of five: "Monks, form is not the self. Monks, if form were the self, form would not lead to harm and suffering, and with regard to form one would obtain what one wished: 'Let my form be like this; let it not be like that.' Monks, because form is not the self, form leads to harm and suffering, and with regard to form one does not obtain what one wishes: 'Let my form be like this; let it not be like that.'

"Monks, feeling, perception, formations and consciousness are not the self. Monks, if consciousness were the self, consciousness would not lead to harm and suffering, and with regard to consciousness one would obtain what one wished: 'Let my consciousness be like this; let it not be like that.'"

"Monks, because consciousness is not the self, consciousness leads to harm and suffering, and with regard to consciousness one does not obtain what one wishes: 'Let my consciousness be like this; let it not be like that.'

"Monks, what do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?"

"Venerable One, it is impermanent."

"Is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable One, it is suffering."

"Would a learned noble śrāvaka regard what is impermanent, suffering and subject to change as the self, thinking, 'This is the self; the self is this; this is my self'?"

"No, Venerable One."

"Monks, what do you think? Are feeling, perception, formations and consciousness permanent or impermanent?"

"Venerable One, they are impermanent."

"Is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable One, it is suffering."

"Would a learned noble śrāvaka regard what is impermanent, suffering and subject to change as the self, thinking, 'This is the self; the self is this; this is my self'?"

"No, Venerable One."

"Therefore, monks, whatever form there is, of whatever kind, whether past, future or present, internal or external, coarse or subtle, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of it should be seen as it really is, with right wisdom, thus: 'This is not the self; the self is not this; this is not my self.' Therefore, monks, whatever feeling, perception, formations and consciousness there are, of whatever kind, whether past, future or present, internal or external, coarse or subtle, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of them should be seen as they really are, with right wisdom, thus: 'This is not the self; the self is not this; this is not my self.'

"Monks, in this way the learned noble śrāvaka sees these five aggregates of grasping as not the self and not belonging to the self. When he sees them in this way, he grasps at nothing whatsoever in the world. When there is no grasping, there is no torment. When there is no torment, he himself attains complete nirvāṇa, and he knows: 'My birth is exhausted; I have lived the holy life; I have done what was to be done; I know no other existence than this.'"

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the minds of the remaining monks of the group of five were liberated from the defilements, without grasping. At that time there were five arhats, and the sixth was the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One stayed on the bank of the Varaṇā River at Vārāṇasī. At that time there lived in Vārāṇasī a young man named Yaśas, the son of the one known as the guild master. Day after day he amused himself with music played by women and indulged in every pleasure he liked, until, his body languid, weary and spent, he quickly fell asleep. Those women too, their bodies languid, weary and spent, fell asleep. When Yaśas, the guild master's son, awoke in the night, he saw all those women lying sprawled, naked, their hair disheveled, their arms flung out, slack and drooling. When he saw them, the perception of a charnel ground arose in him with regard to his wives.

Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, came down from the great upper chamber, put on a pair of jeweled sandals worth a hundred thousand, and went to the door of the bedchamber. Having arrived, he cried out in distress, "Friends, I am oppressed! Friends, I am ruined!" Nonhuman beings opened its door for him and made it so that his voice was not heard. Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, went to the door of the house. Having arrived, he cried out in distress, "Friends, I am oppressed! Friends, I am ruined!" Nonhuman beings opened its door for him and made it so that his voice was not heard. Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, went to the gate of the city. Having arrived, he cried out in distress, "Friends, I am oppressed! Friends, I am ruined!" Nonhuman beings opened its gate for him and made it so that his voice was not heard.

Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, went toward the Varaṇā River. At that time, on the bank of the Varaṇā River, outside his dwelling, in the open air, the Blessed One, awaiting the coming of Yaśas, the guild master's son, was walking up and down, rising again and again to pace. Yaśas, the guild master's son, saw the Blessed One from a long way off, walking up and down on the bank of the Varaṇā River. Seeing him, he cried out in distress, "Śramaṇa, I am oppressed! Śramaṇa, I am ruined!"

Then the Blessed One said this to Yaśas, the guild master's son: "Young man, come here. In this place there is no oppression for you; here there is no ruin."

Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, took off his pair of jeweled sandals worth a hundred thousand on the bank of the Varaṇā River, crossed the Varaṇā River, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at

the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Then the Blessed One led Yaśas, the guild master's son, to his own dwelling, and when he arrived there he sat on the seat that had been prepared. Having sat down, the Blessed One, with talk on the Dharma, instructed Yaśas, the guild master's son, led him to take it up, inspired him and filled him with delight. He explained at length the talk on the Dharma that the buddhas, the blessed ones, give at the outset, namely: talk on generosity, talk on moral discipline and talk on the higher realms; the meager satisfaction and the drawbacks of sensual pleasures; defilement and purification; praise of renunciation and of solitude; and the qualities that belong to the side of purification.

When the Blessed One saw that he had a joyful mind, a wholesome mind, a contented mind, a mind free of obscurations, that he was fortunate, and that he was able to understand if the exalted teaching of the Dharma were explained, he then explained at length the exalted teaching of the Dharma that belongs to the buddhas, the blessed ones, namely the Four Noble Truths: suffering, origin, cessation and the path. Just as a clean cloth without any dark stain, when dipped into a suitable dye, takes the dye well, in the same way Yaśas, the guild master's son, while still seated on that very seat, realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path.

Then Yaśas, the guild master's son, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond uncertainty and crossed beyond doubt; no longer relying on others and no longer led by others; and having gained confidence in the teachings the Teacher had taught, rose from his seat, draped his upper garment over one shoulder, joined his palms, bowed toward the Blessed One, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, I have gone beyond; I have gone utterly beyond. I go for refuge to the Blessed One, to the Dharma and to the Saṅgha. Please accept me as a layman. From this day forth, for as long as I live, even at the cost of my life, I go for refuge with full faith."

That same night a maidservant woke from sleep and saw that young Yaśas was not on his great bed. Seeing this, she went to where the householder, the guild master, was, and when she arrived she said to the householder, the guild master: "Master, please be aware: young Yaśas is not on his great bed."

Then the householder, the guild master, thought: "Surely bandits or rogues have not led the young man away for the sake of his wealth?" Thinking this, he sent messengers on horseback in the four directions, and he himself, together

with men carrying lamps in their hands, went toward the Varaṇā River. On the bank of the Varaṇā River the householder, the guild master, saw a pair of jeweled sandals, worth a hundred thousand, that had been taken off. Seeing them, he thought: "Bandits or rogues have not led the young man away for the sake of his wealth. Since a pair of jeweled sandals worth a hundred thousand has been taken off here on the bank of the Varaṇā River, surely the young man has crossed the Varaṇā River from this very bank. That is why a pair of jeweled sandals worth a hundred thousand has been left here on the bank of the Varaṇā River." Having thought this, he crossed the Varaṇā River from that very bank and went to where the Blessed One was.

The Blessed One saw the householder, the guild master, from far away. Seeing him, he thought: "I shall bring about a feat of miraculous power of such a kind that the householder, the guild master, will not see young Yaśas even while he sits on this very seat." Then the Blessed One brought about a feat of miraculous power such that the householder, the guild master, did not see young Yaśas, even though he was sitting on that very seat.

Then the householder, the guild master, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, have you perhaps seen young Yaśas?"

"Householder, in that case, sit down. There is a chance that you will see young Yaśas sitting on this very seat."

Then the householder, the guild master, thought: "Without doubt the Blessed One has seen young Yaśas, for the Blessed One has said, 'Householder, in that case, sit down. There is a chance that you will see young Yaśas sitting on this very seat.'" Understanding this, he felt joy, contentment, supreme joy, vast joy and gladness of mind; he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When he had sat down to one side, the Blessed One instructed the householder, the guild master, with talk on the Dharma, and so on, as before. When this discourse on the Dharma had been taught, the stainless, immaculate eye of Dharma regarding phenomena arose in the householder, the guild master. And the venerable Yaśas, though still adorned with all his ornaments, through non-grasping had his mind liberated from the defilements.

Then the Blessed One withdrew the feat of miraculous power he had brought about, and on that occasion he spoke this verse:

Though adorned with ornaments, one who practices the Dharma,
Tamed and perfectly restrained, living the pure life,
Who has laid down punishment toward all beings,
That one is a brahmin, a renunciant, a monk.

At that time there were six arhats in the world, and the seventh was the Blessed One.

The householder, the guild master, saw young Yaśas sitting on that very seat. Seeing him, he said to young Yaśas: "Come here, young man. Your mother is weary in mind and exhausted in body and is crying out in lament. Let us go home."

Then the Blessed One said to the householder, the guild master: "Householder, what do you think? Would one who, by the knowledge of one beyond training and the view of one beyond training, has fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path, live as a householder in a home and enjoy sensual pleasures with hoarded wealth?"

"No, Venerable One."

"Householder, just as you, by the knowledge of one in training and the view of one in training, have fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path, in the same way young Yaśas, by the wisdom of one beyond training and the view of one beyond training, has fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path."

"Venerable One, it is a gain well gained for young Yaśas that, by the knowledge of one beyond training and the view of one beyond training, he has fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path. Blessed One, it would be good if, with the renunciant Yaśas following behind you as your attendant, you would, out of compassion, come to where the guild master lives."

The Blessed One consented to the householder, the guild master, by remaining silent. Then the householder, the guild master, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and left the Blessed One's presence.

Then, when that night had passed, in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe, took his bowl and robes, and, with the venerable Yaśas following behind as his attendant renunciant, went to where the house of the householder, the guild master, was. At that time the mother and the former

wife of the venerable Yaśas were staying at the inner gate in order to welcome the Blessed One again and again. The mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas saw the Blessed One from far away. Seeing him, they prepared a seat for the Blessed One and said this: "Come, Blessed One. Welcome, Blessed One. Blessed One, please be seated on the seat that has been prepared." When they had said this, the Blessed One sat on the seat that had been prepared.

Then the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they had sat down to one side, the Blessed One, with talk on the Dharma, instructed the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas, led them to take it up, inspired them and filled them with delight. He explained at length the talk on the Dharma that the buddhas, the blessed ones, give at the outset, namely: talk on generosity, talk on moral discipline and talk on the higher realms; the meager satisfaction and the drawbacks of sensual pleasures; defilement and purification; praise of renunciation and of solitude; and the qualities that belong to the side of purification.

When the Blessed One saw that the two of them had joyful minds, contented minds, minds free of obscurations, that they were fortunate, and that they were able to understand if the exalted teaching of the Dharma were explained, he then explained at length the exalted teaching of the Dharma that belongs to the buddhas, the blessed ones, namely the Four Noble Truths: suffering, origin, cessation and the path. Just as a clean cloth without any dark stain, when dipped into a suitable dye, takes the dye well, in the same way the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas, while still seated on those very seats, fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path.

Then the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond uncertainty and crossed beyond doubt; no longer relying on others and no longer led by others; and having gained confidence in the teachings the Teacher had taught, rose from their seats, joined their palms, bowed toward the Blessed One, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, we have gone beyond; we have gone utterly beyond. We go for refuge to the Blessed One, to the Dharma and to the Saṅgha of monks. Please accept us as lay followers. From this day forth, for as long as we live, even at the cost of our lives, we go for refuge with full faith.

Venerable One, therefore, please take your meal here."

The Blessed One consented to the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas by remaining silent. Then the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, and seeing the Blessed One comfortably seated, served him with their own hands pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, and satisfied him. Having served him with their own hands, in many ways, pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, and having satisfied him, and knowing that the Blessed One had finished eating, had washed his hands and had put away his bowl, they took much lower seats and sat before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, with talk on the Dharma, instructed the mother and the former wife of the venerable Yaśas, led them to take it up, inspired them and filled them with delight. Having in many ways instructed them with talk on the Dharma, led them to take it up, inspired them and filled them with delight, he rose from his seat and departed.

In Vārāṇasī, the second, third, fourth and fifth sons of householder guild masters, namely Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāṃpati and Subāhu, these sons of guild masters, heard that Yaśas, the guild master's son, had shaved off his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, gone forth from home into homelessness. When they heard this, they thought: "Oh! The Buddha can surely be no ordinary one, and his teaching of the Dharma can surely be nothing ordinary either, since now even Yaśas, the guild master's son, who is so very young and so fond of comfort, has shaved off his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, gone forth from home into homelessness. Come, let us too shave off our hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, go forth from home into homelessness."

Then those sons of guild masters, the second, third, fourth and fifth, namely Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāṃpati and Subāhu, went out from Vārāṇasī and went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side.

When they had sat down to one side, those sons of guild masters, the second, third, fourth and fifth, namely Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāṃpati and Subāhu, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, if you would grant us the going forth and full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, we

would live the pure life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Those venerable ones received the going forth and full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. Having gone forth in this way, those venerable ones dwelt alone, secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute. Dwelling alone, secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute, they directly realized in this very life, through their own higher knowledge, and accomplished, the unsurpassed culmination of the pure life, for the sake of which sons of good family shave off their hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, go forth from home into homelessness. They understood: "Our births are exhausted. We have lived the pure life. We have done what was to be done. We know no existence beyond this one." And those venerable ones became arhats, endowed with complete knowledge, their minds thoroughly liberated. At that time there were ten arhats in the world, and the eleventh was the Blessed One.

In Vārāṇasī, fifty youths, sons of the foremost townsmen, heard that the sons of guild masters, the first, second, third, fourth and fifth, namely Yaśas, Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāṃpati and Subāhu, had shaved off their hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, gone forth from home into homelessness. When they heard this, they thought: "Oh! The Buddha can surely be no ordinary one, and his teaching of the Dharma can surely be nothing ordinary either, since now even the sons of guild masters, the first, second, third, fourth and fifth, namely Yaśas, Pūrṇa, Vimala, Gavāṃpati and Subāhu, who are so very young and so fond of comfort, have shaved off their hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, gone forth from home into homelessness. Come, let us too shave off our hair and beards, put on saffron robes, and, out of genuine faith alone, go forth from home into homelessness."

Then those fifty youths, sons of the foremost citizens, went out from Vārāṇasī and went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they had sat down to one side, the fifty youths, sons of the foremost townsmen, said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, if you would grant us the going forth and full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, we would live the pure life in the presence of the Blessed One."

Those venerable ones received the going forth and full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. Having gone forth in this way,

those venerable ones dwelt alone, secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute. Dwelling alone, secluded, heedful, ardent and resolute, they, as before, for the sake of which sons of good family, and so on, up to: they became arhats, endowed with complete knowledge, their minds thoroughly liberated. At that time there were sixty arhats in the world, and the sixty-first was the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One was staying in the Deer Park at Ṛṣivadana near Vārāṇasī. Then the Blessed One said to the monks: "Monks, I am freed from all the bonds of gods and humans. Monks, you too are freed from all the bonds of gods and humans. Monks, for the benefit of many beings, for the happiness of many beings, out of compassion for the world, and for the benefit and happiness of gods and humans, set out wandering today, and do not go two of you by one way. I too shall go wandering to where the town of Senānī at Uruvilvā is."

Then Māra the Evil One thought: "This renunciant Gautama, staying in the Deer Park at Ṛṣivadana near Vārāṇasī, is teaching the Dharma to his śrāvakas in this way: 'Monks, I am freed from all the bonds of gods and humans. Monks, you too are freed from all the bonds of gods and humans. Monks, for the benefit of many beings,' and so on, up to 'set out wandering today,' and he says, 'I too shall go wandering to where the town of Senānī at Uruvilvā is.' Come, I shall approach him in order to do something to stir up trouble."

Then Māra the Evil One magically transformed himself into the guise of a brahmin youth, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived, he stood before the Blessed One and addressed him in verse:

"If, though not free, you perceive yourself as free,
How can you think yourself free?
Renunciant, you have not freed yourself,
And you are bound by a great bond."

Then the Blessed One thought: "Ah, this is Māra the Evil One; he has come here to stir up trouble." Realizing this, he spoke in verse:

"I am freed from all the bonds,
Whatever they may be, of gods and humans.
You who make obstacles are defeated:
Evil One, know that this is so."

Then Māra the Evil One thought: "The renunciant Gautama has recognized me with his mind." Realizing this, he was miserable, unhappy and filled with regret, and he vanished on the spot.

Then the Blessed One said to the monks a second time: "Monks, I am freed from all the bonds of gods and humans."

"Monks, you too are freed from all the bonds of gods and humans. Monks, for the benefit of many beings," and so on, up to "set out wandering today," as above. "I too shall go to where the town of Senānī at Uruvilvā is."

"Venerable One, we shall do as you say," the monks replied, having listened to the Blessed One, and they set out wandering through the countryside.

Then the Blessed One, having stayed in Vārāṇasī for as long as he wished, set out wandering toward the town of Senānī at Uruvilvā, and, wandering by stages, he arrived at the town of Senānī. Then the Blessed One went to a dense cotton grove, and when he arrived, he sat at the foot of a tree for his daytime rest.

At that time a company of sixty Bhadravargīyas would amuse themselves every day outside the town of Senānī with music made by women, delighting and indulging themselves. One of those women broke her agreement and ran away. Then the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas, searching for that woman, went to the dense cotton grove, and the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas saw the Blessed One sitting at the foot of a tree: handsome, inspiring faith, his senses calm, his mind calm, his mind supremely tamed, endowed with calm and with discipline, blazing with splendor like a golden pillar. Seeing him, they went to where the Blessed One was, and when they arrived, they said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, have you perhaps seen a woman?"

"Young men, what is a woman to you?"

"Venerable One, we, the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas, amuse ourselves here outside the town of Senānī with music made by women, delighting and indulging ourselves. While we were amusing ourselves with them, delighting and indulging ourselves, one woman broke her agreement and ran away, and we are searching for her."

"Young men, what do you think? Which would you choose: searching for a woman, or searching for yourselves?"

"Venerable One, what use is a woman to us? We would choose searching for ourselves."

"Young men, in that case, sit down, and I shall teach you the Dharma."

Then the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they had sat down to one side, the Blessed One instructed the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas with talk on the Dharma, and so on, as before. Then the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas, while still seated on those very seats, fully realized the Four Noble Truths, namely suffering, origin, cessation and the path.

Then the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond uncertainty and crossed beyond doubt; no longer relying on others and no longer led by others; and having gained confidence in the teachings the Teacher had taught, rose from their seats, draped their upper garments over one shoulder, joined their palms, bowed toward the Blessed One, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, we have gone beyond; we have gone utterly beyond. We go for refuge to the Blessed One, to the Dharma and to the Saṅgha of monks. Please accept us as lay followers. From this day forth, for as long as we live, even at the cost of our lives, we go for refuge with full faith."

Then the company of sixty Bhadravargīyas, delighting in and rejoicing at what the Blessed One had said, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and left the Blessed One's presence.

Then, when that night had passed, in the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe, took his bowl and robes, and entered the town of Senānī for alms. As the Blessed One entered the town of Senānī for alms, he thought: "Now then, to whom in the town of Senānī should I teach the Dharma first?" Then the Blessed One thought: "I shall teach the Dharma first to the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā, for when I was formerly dwelling devoted to the discipline of abandoning suffering, they served me with fresh butter and milk porridge as sweet as honey."

Then the Blessed One went to where the house of the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā was. The village girls Nandā and Nandabalā saw the Blessed One from far away. Seeing him, they prepared a seat for the Blessed One and said this: "Come, Blessed One. Welcome, Blessed One. Blessed One, please be seated on the seat that has been prepared." When they had said this, the Blessed One sat on the seat that had been prepared.

Then the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. When they had sat down to one side, the Blessed One instructed the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā with talk on the Dharma, and so on, up to "with full faith they went for refuge," as above.

Then the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, therefore, please take your meal here." The Blessed One consented to the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā by remaining silent. Then the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, and seeing the Blessed One comfortably seated, served him with their own hands pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, and satisfied him. Having served him with their own hands, in many ways, pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, they satisfied him. Knowing that the Blessed One had finished eating, had washed his hands and had put away his bowl, they took much lower seats and sat before the Blessed One in order to listen to the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One, with talk on the Dharma, instructed the village girls Nandā and Nandabalā, led them to take it up, inspired them and filled them with delight; then he rose from his seat and departed.

Then, as the Blessed One was leaving the town of Senānī, he thought: "Here in the land of Magadha, who is there, among the renunciants or brahmins honored for their good character, such that if I were to win him over, then through his being won over a great multitude of people would be won over with little trouble?"

At that time there was Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, a hundred and twenty years old, aged and decrepit. The people of Magadha honored, respected, revered and worshipped him, holding him in esteem as an arhat, and with a following of five hundred he practiced austerities at a hermitage on the bank of the Nairañjanā River.

Then the Blessed One thought: "This Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, a hundred and twenty years old, aged and decrepit, whom the people of Magadha," and so on as above, up to "practices austerities. Come, I shall win over Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic; if he is won over, a great multitude of people will be won over with little trouble."

Then the Blessed One went to where the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was. Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One from far away. Seeing him, he prepared a seat for the Blessed

One and said this: "Come, great renunciant. Welcome, great renunciant. Great renunciant, it has been a long time; from where have you come to these parts? Great renunciant, please be seated on the seat that has been prepared." The Blessed One sat on the seat that had been prepared.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, and the Blessed One exchanged many kinds of pleasant and agreeable talk face to face, and Kāśyapa sat down to one side. When he had sat down to one side, the Blessed One said this to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Kāśyapa, if it is no inconvenience to you, I would stay one night in your fire hall."

"Great renunciant, it is no inconvenience to me. However, a fierce nāga lives there, and he will do you harm."

"Kāśyapa, just give your permission; he will not harm me."

"Great renunciant, if it does not trouble you, great renunciant, stay just as you please."

Then the Blessed One went to where the fire hall of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was. When he arrived, he washed his feet outside the fire hall and went inside. He spread a mat of grass himself, held his body upright, crossed his legs, set his mindfulness before him, and sat.

The fierce nāga saw the Blessed One from far away. Seeing him, through the power of his anger he sent forth smoke. The Blessed One, too, through the power of his miraculous ability, sent forth smoke. The fierce nāga, through the power of his anger, burst into flame. The Blessed One, too, entered the meditative absorption of the fire element. Then, through the power of the fierce nāga's anger and the power of the Blessed One's miraculous ability, the whole fire hall blazed, blazed fiercely, blazed fiercely all around, and became a single mass of flame, burning.

When Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, looked at the stars in the night, he saw the whole fire hall blazing, blazing fiercely, blazing fiercely all around, a single mass of flame, burning. Seeing this, he thought: "Surely this handsome great renunciant Gautama has not been burned to ashes by the fierce nāga? Alas, the poor man did not heed my words."

Then the Blessed One thought: "Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, together with his following, has treated me with disdain. Come, I shall set my mind in concentration on producing such a miraculous display that my fire overpowers the fierce nāga's fire, yet does not harm his body; and having

tamed him, I shall place him in my bowl and make a gift of this kind to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic."

Then the Blessed One set his mind in concentration on producing such a miraculous display, and he brought it about that his fire overpowered the fierce nāga's fire, yet did not harm the nāga's body. Knowing that the nāga was tamed, he placed him in his bowl and, carrying it, went to where Uruvilvā Kāśyapa was.

Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One from far away. Seeing him, he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, you are still alive, I see!"

"Kāśyapa, I am alive."

"Great renunciant, what is it that you have brought in your bowl?"

"Kāśyapa, the fierce nāga by whose power your fire hall became a blaze of fire, who would give no room to anyone lacking miraculous power: I have tamed him, put him in my bowl and brought him here."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous power and great might; it is very wonderful. Yet we too are arhats."

Then the Blessed One stayed in the dense grove of the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic. At that time in the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, there were about five hundred brahmin youths who tended the fires, each with three fire altars, so that there were fifteen hundred fire altars. Then, when those brahmin youths wanted to tend the fires, they were unable to kindle them.

Then those brahmin youths went to where Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was, and when they arrived they said this to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Master, please be aware: here, when we wish to tend the fires, we cannot manage to kindle them."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not be his power at work?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: here, when my five hundred or so brahmin youths wish to tend the fires, they cannot manage to kindle them, and so I

think: 'Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not be his power at work?'"

"Kāśyapa, do you wish the fires to be kindled?"

"Great renunciant, please kindle them."

Then, through the buddha-power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those fires blazed up of their own accord.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then, when those brahmin youths had tended the fires and wished to put them out, they were unable to put them out.

Then those brahmin youths went to where Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was, and when they arrived they said this to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Master, please be aware: here, when we have tended the fires and wish to put them out, we cannot manage to put them out."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not be his power at work?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: here, when my brahmin youths have tended the fires and wish to put them out, they cannot manage to put them out, and so I think: 'Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not be his power at work?'"

"Kāśyapa, shall those fires be put out?"

"Great renunciant, please put them out."

Then, through the buddha-power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those fires died out of their own accord.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then again, at another time, when Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, himself wished to tend the fire, he was unable to kindle it; and so on, as above, up to "I too am an arhat." Likewise, from "when he had tended it and wished to

put it out" up to "I too am an arhat," it is as above.

Then, at another time, all the fire houses of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, blazed, blazed up fiercely, blazed up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, were burning; and though Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, together with his retinue, and a great crowd of other people as well, strove hard, they were unable to put it out.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not have come about through his power?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: great renunciant, here all my fire houses are blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, are burning; and though I with my retinue, and a great crowd of other people as well, strive hard, we cannot manage to put the fire out, and so I think: 'Since the great renunciant is staying near me, might this not have come about through his power?'"

"Kāśyapa, shall that fire be quelled?"

"Great renunciant, please quell it."

Then, through the buddha-power of the buddhas and the divine power of the gods, those fire houses were quelled of their own accord.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then the Blessed One stayed in the dense forest by the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic. Then, when night had fallen, the Four Great Kings, of surpassing radiance, came to where the Blessed One was, and when they arrived they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet. They were seen as four masses of fire, as it were, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, burning. And on seeing them he thought: "The great renunciant also tends fire, for in front of him there are four masses of fire, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, burning."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, rose early in the morning, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the

Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: here, last night, as I was looking at the stars, I saw in front of the great renunciant four masses of fire, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, burning. And on seeing them I thought: 'The great renunciant also tends fire, for in front of him there are four masses of fire, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, burning.'"

"Kāśyapa, do I tend fire? I do not tend fire.

The wise turn the mind
Wholly away from the afflictions;
What merit is there in devotedly
Serving fire or water?

Nevertheless, last night, when night had fallen, the Four Great Kings, of surpassing radiance, came to where I was, and when they arrived they bowed their heads at my feet and sat to one side, with bodies like four masses of fire, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, and, become a single mass of flame, burning."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then, when night had fallen, Śakra, lord of the gods, of surpassing radiance, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat to one side, with a body like a mass of fire, blazing, blazing up fiercely, blazing up fiercely on every side, become a single mass of flame, yet far greater, far more noble and far more excellent than those four. That same night, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, as he was looking at the stars, saw in front of the Blessed One a mass of fire blazing; and so on, as above, up to: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then, when night had fallen, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, of surpassing radiance, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat to one side, with a body like a mass of fire; as before, from "those very four masses of fire burning" up to "those five great masses of fire, become a single mass of flame, were burning," his body was even far greater, far more noble and far more excellent than those. That same night, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, as he was looking

at the stars, saw in front of the Blessed One a great mass of fire blazing; and so on, as above, up to: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

At that time the occasion came for a seven-day sacrifice to be held at the dwelling of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic. Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "If the people of Magadha learn that this great renunciant has such great miraculous powers and such great might, they will think of honoring him alone, and it will no longer be so for me. Oh, how good it would be if the great renunciant went elsewhere from here for seven days!"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his own mind the mind of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went elsewhere for seven days. During those seven days Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, received great gain and honor; he had food and drink in great abundance, and a great crowd of people came under his sway.

Then, when the seven-day sacrifice at the dwelling of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was over, he thought: "In these seven days I have received great gain and honor; I have had food and drink in great abundance, and a great crowd of people has come under my sway. Oh, how good it would be if the great renunciant came now! I would let him partake of alms from this as well."

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his own mind the mind of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was. Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One from far off, and on seeing him he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, have you come?"

"Kāśyapa, I have come."

"Great renunciant, why did you go elsewhere from here for these seven days?"

"Kāśyapa, when the occasion came for the seven-day sacrifice to be held at your dwelling, did you not think: 'If the people of Magadha learn that the great renunciant has such great miraculous powers and such great might, they will think of honoring him alone, and it will no longer be so for me. Oh, how good it would be if the great renunciant went elsewhere from here for seven days!'? Knowing your mind with my own mind, I went elsewhere from here for seven days."

"Then why have you come here?"

"Kāśyapa, when your seven-day sacrifice was over, did you not think: 'In these seven days I have received great gain and honor; I have had food and drink in great abundance, and a great crowd of people has come under my sway. Oh, how good it would be if the great renunciant came! I would let him enjoy this as well'?"

"Great renunciant, it is so."

"Knowing your mind with my own mind, I have come."

"Great renunciant, please enjoy it just as you please."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, therefore please stay near me, and I shall provide you with a livelihood in accordance with the Dharma." The Blessed One consented to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, by remaining silent.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, prepared food for the Blessed One with his own hands, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, it is mealtime; great renunciant, please consider that the time has now come."

"Kāśyapa, go on ahead then; I too shall come."

Then the Blessed One, knowing that Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, had not long gone, entered into such a meditative absorption that, as soon as he set his mind in equipoise, he filled his bowl with jambu fruits, full of color, fragrance and flavor, from the jambu tree after which Jambudvīpa is named, and, carrying it, went to the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic; and having arrived, he sat down on the seat that had been prepared.

Then, after that, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, arrived, and Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One seated on the seat prepared in the hermitage. On seeing him he said this: "Great renunciant, have you come?"

"Kāśyapa, I have come."

"Great renunciant, what is in your bowl?"

"Kāśyapa, here, knowing that you had not long gone, I entered into such a meditative absorption that, as soon as I set my mind in equipoise, I filled my bowl with jambu fruits, full of color, fragrance and flavor, from the jambu tree after which Jambudvīpa is named, and came here. If you wish, enjoy them."

"Great renunciant, I ask only that you do as you please."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

As with the jambu tree after which Jambudvīpa is named, so it was likewise with the forest of harītakī myrobalans not very far from it, the forest of bilva trees, the forest of kapittha trees, and the forest of āmalakī myrobalans.

Going to the northern continent of Uttarakuru, he filled his bowl with śāli rice that had been neither plowed nor sown, and, carrying it, went to the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic; and having arrived, he sat down on the seat that had been prepared. Then, after that, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, arrived, and Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One seated on the seat prepared in the hermitage. On seeing him he said this: "Great renunciant, have you come?"

"Kāśyapa, I have come."

"Great renunciant, what is in your bowl?"

"Kāśyapa, here, knowing that you had not long gone, I entered into such a meditative absorption that, as soon as I set my mind in equipoise, I went to the northern continent of Uttarakuru, filled my bowl with grains of śāli rice that had been neither plowed nor sown, and came here. If you wish, enjoy it."

"Great renunciant, I ask only that you do as you please."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then the Blessed One, having accepted alms from Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, sat down in another spot and took his meal. Then the Blessed One had need of water for washing. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that the Blessed One had need of water for washing, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he struck the ground with his hand in front of the Blessed One. Then a great spring arose and water flowed forth,

and with it the Blessed One washed.

Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, while walking about in the hermitage, saw that a great spring had arisen and water was flowing forth. On seeing it he thought: "There was no water here before; where has this water come from now?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: as I was walking about here in the hermitage, I saw the water of a great spring. And on seeing it I thought: 'There was no water here before; where has this water flowed from now?'"

"Kāśyapa, here, when I had accepted alms from you and was sitting in this spot taking my meal, I had need of water for washing. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing that I had need of water for washing, came to where I was, and when he arrived he struck the ground with his hand in front of me, and from that a great spring arose, and with it I washed. Kāśyapa, this pool is called the Pool Dug by Hand."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then the Blessed One, rising from seclusion in the late afternoon, went to where the Pool Dug by Hand was, and when he arrived he laid his robes and Dharma garments at one end of the bank of the Pool Dug by Hand, entered the Pool Dug by Hand and bathed. When he wished to come out of the Pool Dug by Hand, he stretched out his hand toward where an arjuna tree stood. Then a great branch of the arjuna tree bent down, and, taking hold of it, the Blessed One came out of the Pool Dug by Hand.

Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, while walking about in the hermitage, saw a great branch of the arjuna tree bent down on the bank of the Pool Dug by Hand. And on seeing it he thought: "This arjuna branch was not bent down before; who has now bent down this great arjuna branch?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: as I was walking about here in the hermitage, I saw a great branch of the arjuna tree bent down on the bank of the Pool Dug by Hand. And on seeing it I thought: 'This great arjuna branch was not bent

down before; who has bent it down?'"

"Kāśyapa, here, rising from seclusion in the late afternoon, I went to where the bank of the Pool Dug by Hand is, and when I arrived I laid my robes and Dharma garments at one end of the bank of the Pool Dug by Hand, entered the Pool Dug by Hand and bathed my body. Wishing to come out of the Pool Dug by Hand, I stretched out my hand toward where these arjuna trees stand, and then this great arjuna branch bent down; I took hold of it and came out of the Pool Dug by Hand. Kāśyapa, this is called the Arjuna Grasped by Hand."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

At that time the Blessed One had obtained hempen rags from a rubbish heap. Then the Blessed One thought: "Where shall I wash my hempen rags from the rubbish heap?"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing with his own mind the Blessed One's thought, took a large, long slab of stone from a rocky mountain, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please wash your hempen rags from the rubbish heap on this." And on it the Blessed One washed the hempen rags from the rubbish heap.

Then the Blessed One thought: "Where shall I spread out my hempen rags from the rubbish heap?" Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing with his own mind the Blessed One's thought, carried a large, long slab of stone from a rock, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please spread out your hempen rags from the rubbish heap on this." And on it the Blessed One spread out the hempen rags from the rubbish heap.

Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, while walking about in the hermitage, saw the large, long slabs of stone. And on seeing them he thought: "These large, long slabs of stone were not here before; who has now carried these large, long slabs of stone here?"

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, please be aware: as I was walking about here in the hermitage, I saw some large, long slabs of stone. And on seeing them I thought: 'These large, long slabs of stone were never here before; who has now brought these

large, long slabs of stone here?'"

"Kāśyapa, here I obtained hempen rags from a rubbish heap. Then I thought: 'Where shall I wash the hempen rags from the rubbish heap?' Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing my thought with his own mind, took a large, long slab of stone from a rock, came to where I was, and when he arrived he said this to me: 'Blessed One, please wash your hempen rags from the rubbish heap on this.' And on it I washed the hempen rags from the rubbish heap. I thought: 'Where shall I spread out the hempen rags from the rubbish heap?' Then Śakra, lord of the gods, knowing my thought with his own mind, took a large, long slab of stone from a rock, came to where I was, and when he arrived he said this to me: 'Blessed One, please spread out your hempen rags from the rubbish heap on this.' And on it I spread out the hempen rags from the rubbish heap. Kāśyapa, these large, long slabs of stone are called the Ones Brought by the Yakṣa."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then the Blessed One stayed in the dense forest by the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic. At that time the Nairañjanā came down in a great flood. Then, where the river had covered the land deeper than a man's height, the Blessed One walked up and down on dry, dusty ground in the open, above the water.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "Might not so beautiful a great renunciant have been carried away by the great flood? Come, let me look for the great renunciant." Thinking this, he got into a dugout boat, and as he was looking for the Blessed One, Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, saw the Blessed One, where the river had covered the land deeper than a man's height, walking up and down on dry, dusty ground in the open. And on seeing him he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, are you alive?"

"Kāśyapa, I am alive."

"Great renunciant, will you get into the dugout boat?"

"Kāśyapa, I will get in."

Then the Blessed One thought: "Come, let me bring about such a miracle that, as soon as I set my mind in equipoise, I enter the dugout boat just as it is on

the water." And then the Blessed One brought about such a miracle that, as soon as he set his mind in equipoise, he entered the dugout boat just as it was on the water.

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, thought: "This great renunciant truly has great miraculous powers and great might; it is most wondrous, and yet I too am an arhat."

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his own mind the mind of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, said this to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Kāśyapa, matted-hair ascetic, you are not an arhat. You have not even entered upon the way to realize directly the fruit of arhatship, and you do not even know what the path of the arhat is."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, realizing, "The great renunciant Gautama has known my mind with his own mind," said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, may I go forth and receive full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya; I would lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence."

"Kāśyapa, have you consulted your following?"

"Great renunciant, I have not."

"Kāśyapa, then for now consult your following. For a person of renown like you, well known and well connected, it is good to consult one's following."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where his own hermitage was, and when he arrived he said to the brahmin youths: "Brahmin youths, know this: brahmin youths, if I lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence, what will you wise ones do?"

"Master, whatever little we have is all owing to the master. So if the master leads the pure life in the great renunciant's presence, we too shall go forth after the master has gone forth."

"Brahmin youths, in that case throw these hides, bark garments, staffs, water pots and ladles into the river Nairañjanā right now."

"Master, as you command," said those brahmin youths, and they threw the hides, bark garments, staffs, water pots and ladles onto the bank of the river Nairañjanā. Then they went to where Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was, and when they arrived they said this to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Master, we have done what we had to do."

Then Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, together with his following of five hundred, went to where the Blessed One was, and when he arrived he said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, I have consulted my following. May I go forth and receive full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya; I would lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence."

"Come, Kāśyapa, lead the pure life."

By those very words those venerable ones went forth, by them received full ordination, and by them attained the state of monks.

At that time the brothers of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa, each with a following of two hundred and fifty, were practicing austerities in a hermitage on the bank at the lower reaches of the river Nairañjanā. The brothers Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa saw those hides, bark garments, staffs, water pots and ladles being carried along by the river Nairañjanā. And on seeing them they thought: "Might not some misfortune have befallen our companions in the pure life, from the king, or from robbers, or from fire or water? Come, let us look for our companions in the pure life."

Then the brothers Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa, looking for Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, went to where the hermitage of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, was. At that time the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, his hair shaved off and wearing the outer robe, was seated with his following of five hundred in the presence of the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa saw Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, his hair shaved off and wearing the outer robe, seated in the presence of the Blessed One in order to hear the Dharma. And on seeing him they said this to the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic: "Kāśyapa, is this the best, and is that not the best?"

"Kāśyapas, this is the best; that is not."

Then the brothers Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa thought: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, is surely nothing less than supreme, and the Dharma he teaches is surely nothing less than supreme. For now Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, more than a hundred and twenty years since his birth, old, decrepit and advanced in age, honored, revered, esteemed and worshiped by the people of Magadha and venerated as an arhat, has even he twice affirmed his going forth in the great renunciant's presence. Come, let us too

lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence." Thinking this, they said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, may we go forth and receive full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya; we would lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence."

"Have you consulted your following?"

"Great renunciant, we have not."

"Kāśyapas, then for now consult your following. For persons of renown like you, well known and well connected, it is good to consult one's following."

Then the brothers Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa went to where their own hermitage was, and when they arrived they said this to the brahmin youths: "Brahmin youths, know this: if we lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence, what will you wise ones do?"

"Masters, whatever little we have is all owing to the masters. So if the masters lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence, we too shall go forth after the masters have gone forth."

"Brahmin youths, know that now is the time for it."

Then the brothers Nadī Kāśyapa and Gayā Kāśyapa, each with a following of two hundred and fifty, went to where the Blessed One was, and when they arrived they said this to the Blessed One: "Great renunciant, we have consulted our following. Great renunciant, may we go forth and receive full ordination, the state of a monk, in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya; we too would lead the pure life in the great renunciant's presence."

"Come, Kāśyapas, lead the pure life."

By those very words those venerable ones went forth, by them received full ordination, and by them attained the state of monks.

Then the Blessed One, having given the going forth and full ordination to those thousand matted-hair ascetics, stayed at Uruvilvā for as long as he wished, and then set out wandering toward Gayā. Wandering by stages, he reached Gayā, and at the shrine of Gayāśīrṣa he stayed together with a thousand monks, all of them former matted-hair ascetics who had gone forth. Then the Blessed One instructed those thousand monks by means of the three kinds of miracle: the miracle of magical power, the miracle of reading minds, and the miracle of instruction.

Of these, the Blessed One's miracle of magical power was this. The Blessed One, just as he sat in meditative equipoise, vanished from his seat and rose up into the sky above the eastern quarter, and there he displayed the four modes of conduct: he walked, he stood, he sat, and he lay down. He entered into the samādhi of fire, and when he had entered into the samādhi of fire, rays of light of many kinds streamed forth from the body of the Buddha, the Blessed One: blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, and the color of crystal. He displayed the twin miracle: from the lower part of his body he blazed with fire, while from the upper part of his body he poured down streams of cold water; from the upper part of his body he blazed with fire, while from the lower part of his body he poured down streams of cold water. Such was the samādhi he entered. As in the east, so too in the south, the west, and the north. Having displayed the four kinds of the miracle of magical power in the four directions, he withdrew his magical manifestations and sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks. This, then, was the Blessed One's miracle of magical power.

Of these, the Blessed One's miracle of reading minds was this: "Monks, your mind is like this. Your mentation is like this. Your consciousness is like this. Reflect on this; do not reflect on that. Attend to this; do not attend to that. Abandon this; do not abandon that. Realize this directly with the body, bring it to completion, and abide in it." This was the Blessed One's miracle of reading minds.

Of these, the Blessed One's miracle of instruction was this: "Monks, all this is ablaze. Monks, what is the all that is ablaze? Monks, the eye, forms, eye consciousness, and eye contact are ablaze, and whatever inner feeling arises in dependence on eye contact, whether pleasant, painful, or neither pleasant nor painful, that too is ablaze. Monks, the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, the mind, mental phenomena, mind consciousness, and mind contact are ablaze, and whatever inner feeling arises in dependence on mind contact, whether pleasant, painful, or neither pleasant nor painful, that too is ablaze. With what are they ablaze? They are ablaze with the fire of desire, the fire of aversion, and the fire of delusion; they are ablaze with suffering: with birth, old age, sickness, death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, unhappiness, and distress. So I declare." This, then, was the Blessed One's miracle of instruction.

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the minds of those monks, all of whom had formerly been matted-hair ascetics, were liberated from the defilements without grasping. Then the Blessed One stayed at the

shrine of Gayāśīrṣa together with the thousand monks, all of whom had formerly been matted-hair ascetics, every one of them an arhat: their defilements exhausted, what was to be done done, their task accomplished, their burden laid down, their own aim attained, the fetters binding them to existence utterly exhausted, and their minds perfectly liberated through right understanding.

The men who lived on King Bimbisāra's wages, while traveling through the country, heard this: "A youth of the Śākyas has been born on the slope of the Himalaya, on the bank of the river Bhāgīrathī, not very far from the hermitage of the sage Kapila. The brahmin readers of marks and the soothsayers have predicted of him: If he becomes a householder and lives in the home, he will become a wheel-turning king, a righteous king, a king of Dharma, victorious to the four ends of the earth, possessed of the seven precious things. His seven precious things will be these: the precious wheel, the precious elephant, the precious horse, the precious jewel, the precious woman, the precious householder, and seventh, the precious minister. He will also have a full thousand sons, heroic and valiant, of supreme bodily form, crushers of enemy armies. He will dwell having conquered this whole great earth, bounded by the ocean, leaving it free of adversaries and free of oppression, without punishment and without the force of weapons, subduing it well in accordance with the Dharma and with impartiality. If he shaves his hair and beard, puts on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith goes forth from home into homelessness, he will become a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, whose renown will resound throughout the world."

Having heard this, they went to where King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha was, and when they had arrived, they said to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha: "Please know, Your Majesty, that while we were traveling here through Your Majesty's realm, we heard a prediction," and so on as above, from "a youth of the Śākyas on the slope of the Himalaya" up to "he will become a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, whose renown will resound throughout the world." "Your Majesty, be on your guard! He will become more preeminent even than Your Majesty, who is most preeminent."

"Good people, do not speak like this, saying," and so on as above, from "a youth of the Śākyas on the slope of the Himalaya" up to "his renown will resound," "Your Majesty, be on your guard! He will become more preeminent even than Your Majesty, who is most preeminent." "Why is that? Good people," and so on as above, from "a youth of the Śākyas" up to "has been born": "if he

becomes a wheel-turning king, I shall be his servant."

"If he shaves his hair and beard, puts on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith goes forth from home into homelessness, and his renown resounds throughout the world as a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, I shall declare myself his disciple."

Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, seated on the upper terrace of his palace, made five wishes, thinking: "Oh, may a Teacher of the world appear in my land, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a blessed one; may I approach him in order to see him; when I have approached him, may he teach me the Dharma; may I understand the Dharma he teaches; and when I have understood the Dharma, may he lay down the training, and may I take up that training and abide in it. How good that would be!"

Then the Blessed One said to the monks: "Monks, King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, seated on the upper terrace of his palace, made five wishes, thinking: Oh, may a Teacher of the world appear in my land, a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha," and so on as above.

A certain man who lived on the wages of King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, while traveling through the country, heard this: "The youth of the Śākyas who was born on the slope of the Himalaya, on the bank of the river Bhāgīrathī, not very far from the hermitage of the sage Kapila, of whom the brahmin readers of marks and the soothsayers," and so on as above, up to "predicted that his renown would resound throughout the world: he has shaved his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith gone forth from home into homelessness, and having fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, he is staying at Gayā, at the shrine of Gayāśīrṣa, together with a thousand monks, all of whom were formerly matted-hair ascetics, every one of them an arhat: their defilements exhausted, what was to be done done, their task accomplished, their burden laid down, their own aim attained, the fetters binding them to existence utterly exhausted, and their minds perfectly liberated through right understanding."

Having heard this, he went to where King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha was, and when he had arrived, he said to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha: "Please know, Your Majesty, that while we were traveling here through Your Majesty's realm, we heard that the youth of the Śākyas," and so on as above,

up to "his renown will resound throughout the world: he has shaved his hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith gone forth from home into homelessness, and having fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, he is staying at Gayā, at the shrine of Gayā, together with monks, all of whom were formerly matted-hair ascetics, every one of them an arhat, their defilements exhausted," and so on, up to "their minds perfectly liberated through right understanding." "Your Majesty, pay them honor! If you do so, Your Majesty, preeminent as you are, will become still more preeminent."

Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha commanded a man: "Come here, my good man! Go to where the Blessed One is, and when you have arrived, bow your head at the Blessed One's feet in my name and ask: Are you free from ailment? Are you free from affliction? Are you in good health? Do you move about with ease? Are you possessed of strength, well-being, and vigor? Are you living in comfort? And say this as well: Blessed One, I would serve the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks for as long as I live, with clothing and robes, alms food, bedding, medicine as a requisite for the sick, and other necessities. May the Blessed One please come to Rājagṛha."

"As Your Majesty commands," said the man, having listened to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, and he went to where the Blessed One was. When he had arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated, the man said to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha bows his head at the Blessed One's feet and asks after your health: Are you free from ailment? Are you free from affliction?" and so on as above, up to "Are you living in comfort?"

"Good man, may you and King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha be well."

"Venerable One, King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha sends this message: I would serve the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks for as long as I live, with clothing, robes, alms food, bedding, medicine as a requisite for the sick, and other necessities. May the Blessed One please come to Rājagṛha."

The Blessed One consented to this by remaining silent. Then the man, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One, wandering through the land of Magadha together with the great Saṅgha of monks, all of whom were formerly matted-hair ascetics,

every one of them an arhat, their defilements exhausted, and so on, up to their minds perfectly liberated through right understanding, went to the Supratiṣṭha shrine of the people of Magadha, where the Yaṣṭivana grove is. Then the Blessed One, having arrived at Supratiṣṭha, stayed at the Supratiṣṭha shrine of the people of Magadha, where the Yaṣṭivana grove is.

King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha heard that the Blessed One, together with the great Saṅgha of a thousand monks, all of whom were formerly matted-hair ascetics, and so on, up to "their minds perfectly liberated," wandering through the land of Magadha, had gone to the Supratiṣṭha shrine of the people of Magadha, where the Yaṣṭivana grove is, and was staying at the Supratiṣṭha shrine of the people of Magadha, where the Yaṣṭivana grove is. Having heard this, he mounted his fine chariot and, with great royal might and great royal splendor, together with some hundred thousand horses and chariots and many hundreds of attendants, set out from Rājagṛha and went into the presence of the Blessed One in order to see the Blessed One and to pay him homage. As he went, the wheels of his chariot sank into the ground. He thought, "Can it be that I have done some faulty deed?"

The gods said to him, "Great king, you have not done any faulty deed, but those who have shared in deeds with you are sitting in prison. Release them."

The king said, "If that is so, let them be released," and the king had the prisoners released.

Then, as the king set out again, his crown struck against the gate. Again he thought, "Without a doubt I have done some faulty deed, and that is why this further ill omen has befallen me, my crown striking against the gate."

Those gods said again, "Great king, you have not done any faulty deed, but of those who have shared in deeds with you, some have assembled, while others are in such and such other districts, carrying on their work. Summon them."

The king summoned all the people living in those lands. Then King Bimbisāra, together with twelve thousand chariots, eighteen thousand attendants and troops of horsemen, and many hundreds of thousands of brahmins and householders of Magadha, set out from Rājagṛha and went into the presence of the Blessed One in order to see the Blessed One and to pay him homage. He rode as far as the ground allowed for riding, then dismounted and entered the park on foot alone. From the point at which King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha first saw the Blessed One, he took off the five royal insignia: the turban, the parasol, the sword, the jeweled yak-tail whisk, and the colorful sandals.

Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, having set aside the five royal insignia, went to where the Blessed One was. When he had arrived, he arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and announced his own name three times: "Venerable One, I am King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha. Venerable One, I am King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha. I am the king."

"So it is, king, so it is. Great king, you are King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha. Great king, you are King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha. You are the king. Great king, sit down on your seat as you see fit."

Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Some of the brahmins and householders of Magadha bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Some exchanged with the Blessed One various kinds of talk that bring delight and satisfaction and sat down to one side. Some bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One and sat down. Some, seeing the Blessed One from far away, sat down to one side in silence.

At that time the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, together with his retinue, had also gathered there and was seated. Then the brahmins and householders of Magadha thought: "Does the great ascetic practice the holy life under Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, or does Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, practice the holy life under the great ascetic?"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts of the brahmins and householders of Magadha, put a question in verse to the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic:

"You who dwelt at Uruvilvā, what have you seen here,
that you have abandoned the fire and practice these observances?
How is it that you have given up the worship of fire?
Kāśyapa, tell me what this means."

Uruvilvā Kāśyapa replied:

"Here some speak only of food and drink, and likewise of tastes,
of sense pleasures, and of women.
I clearly saw these as stains of the aggregates;
therefore I take no delight in sacrifice, nor in burnt offerings."

"If your mind takes no delight
in sense pleasures, in food and drink, nor likewise in tastes,

then in what, in the world of gods and humans,
does your mind delight? Kāśyapa, tell me, since I ask."

"Where there are no aggregates, peaceful, where there is nothing at all,
free of clinging to craving for pleasures, without becoming otherwise:
I have seen that supreme state that is not led by another;
therefore I take no delight in sacrifice, nor in burnt offerings.

Not having seen the supreme, unfailing state,
I thought I would be freed by sacrifices, observances and fires;
my mind was deluded,
and, become blind, I saw only what follows on birth and death.

Now that I have seen and accepted the unconditioned state
well proclaimed by the supreme and foremost protector,
you, O sage Gautama, are the guide;
the great multitude, striving for the goal, enters the truth."

The Blessed One said:

"What you have understood, you have understood well;
you have not thought amiss.
Of the teachings that have been set forth,
you have taken up the one that is foremost.
Kāśyapa, stir your assembly to a sense of urgency."

Then the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, given leave by the Blessed One, just as he sat with his mind in equipoise, vanished from his seat.

He rose up into the sky above the eastern quarter and displayed the four modes of conduct. As before, he displayed the four kinds of the miracle of magical power in the four directions, and then withdrew his magical manifestations. He arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One: "The Blessed One is my Teacher; I am the Blessed One's disciple. The Blessed One is my Teacher; I am the Blessed One's disciple."

"So it is, Kāśyapa, so it is. Kāśyapa, I am your Teacher; you are my disciple. Kāśyapa, I am your Teacher; you are my disciple. Kāśyapa, sit down on your seat as you see fit."

Then the venerable Uruvilvā Kāśyapa bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Then the brahmins and householders of Magadha thought: "The great ascetic does not practice the holy life under Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic; rather, it is Uruvilvā Kāśyapa, the matted-hair ascetic, who practices the holy life under the great ascetic."

Then the Blessed One said to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha: "Great king, form has arising, and it has passing away; its arising and passing away should be understood. Great king, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness have arising, and they have passing away; their arising and passing away should be understood. Great king, a son of good family, having understood that it is the nature of form to arise and pass away, fully understands form. Great king, a son of good family, having understood that it is the nature of feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness to arise and pass away, fully understands consciousness. Great king, when a son of good family fully understands form, he does not take form to be a self or to belong to a self; he does not grasp it, does not dwell on it, and does not cling to it. Great king, when a son of good family fully understands feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, he does not take them to be a self or to belong to a self; he does not grasp them, does not dwell on them, and does not cling to them. Great king, when a son of good family does not take form to be a self or to belong to a self, does not grasp it, does not dwell on it, and does not cling to it, that is declared to be nirvāṇa, immeasurable and beyond count. Great king, when a son of good family does not take feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness to be a self or to belong to a self, does not grasp them, does not dwell on them, and does not cling to them, that is declared to be nirvāṇa, immeasurable and beyond count."

Then the brahmins and householders of Magadha thought: "If form is not the self, and feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are not the self, then who will it be: the self, the sentient being, the life principle, the one who is born, the nourisher, the person, the one born of Manu, the son of Manu, the agent, the instigator, the knower, the cognizer, the one who rouses, the one who instigates, the speaker, the declarer, the feeler, the experiencer, which never came into being and will not come into being and yet exists even now, by which one experiences, in this place and that, the ripening of the virtuous and evil deeds one has done, and which casts off these aggregates and links up with other aggregates?"

Then the Blessed One, knowing with his mind the thoughts of the brahmins and householders of Magadha, said to the monks: "Monks, 'self, self' is something that foolish, unlearned ordinary people fall into by following a mere designation. Here, monks, there is no self and nothing belonging to a self. When there is arising, this suffering arises; when there is ceasing, this suffering ceases. When there is arising, formations arise; when there is ceasing, formations cease. In dependence on that cause and that condition, the stream of formations of sentient beings goes on. Monks, the Tathāgata, having realized the linking of formations from one life to the next, designates the death and birth of sentient beings. Monks, with the divine eye, purified and surpassing that of humans, I know the death of sentient beings," and so on as above, up to "they are born among the gods in the happy destinies, in the heavenly world."

"Monks, since I know thus and see thus, I do not say," as above, from "self" or "sentient being" up to "experiencer," "this is that which never came into being, will not come into being, and does not exist even now, by which one experiences, in this place and that, the ripening of the evil deeds one has done, and which casts off these aggregates and links up with other aggregates," except as a conventional designation for phenomena.

That conventional designation for phenomena is this: when this exists, that comes to be; from the arising of this, that arises. That is to say: conditioned by ignorance, formations; conditioned by formations, consciousness; conditioned by consciousness, name and form; conditioned by name and form, the six sense sources; conditioned by the six sense sources, contact; conditioned by contact, feeling; conditioned by feeling, craving; conditioned by craving, grasping; conditioned by grasping, becoming; conditioned by becoming, birth; and conditioned by birth arise old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, unhappiness, and distress. Thus this entire great mass of suffering comes about.

That is to say: when this does not exist, that does not come to be; from the cessation of this, that ceases. That is to say: from the cessation of ignorance, formations cease; from the cessation of formations, consciousness ceases; from the cessation of consciousness, name and form cease; from the cessation of name and form, the six sense sources cease; from the cessation of the six sense sources, contact ceases; from the cessation of contact, feeling ceases; from the cessation of feeling, craving ceases; from the cessation of craving, grasping ceases; from the cessation of grasping, becoming ceases; from the

cessation of becoming, birth ceases; and from the cessation of birth, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, pain, unhappiness, and distress cease. In this way this entire great mass of suffering ceases.

"Monks, formations are suffering; nirvāṇa is peace. From the origination of the cause, suffering originates, and from the cessation of the cause, suffering ceases. This very cessation, in which, because the stream has been cut, nothing further arises, and in which there is no linking to a new life, is the end of suffering. Monks, what then is complete nirvāṇa? It is the cessation of suffering with nothing else remaining: that is utter pacification, that is becoming cool, that is the going down to rest. Monks, this is the state of peace: namely, the abandonment of all aggregates, the exhaustion of craving, freedom from desire, cessation, nirvāṇa."

Then the Blessed One spoke once more to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha: "Great king, what do you think? Is form permanent or impermanent?"

"Venerable One, it is impermanent."

"Is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable One, it is suffering."

"Would a learned noble disciple take what is impermanent, suffering, and subject to change as a self, thinking, This is I, I am this, this is my self?"

"No, Venerable One."

"Great king, what do you think? Are feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness permanent or impermanent?"

"Venerable One, they are impermanent."

"Is what is impermanent suffering, or is it not suffering?"

"Venerable One, it is suffering."

"Would a learned noble disciple take what is impermanent, suffering, and subject to change as a self, thinking, This is I, I am this, this is my self?"

"No, Venerable One."

"Therefore, great king, whatever form there may be, whether past, future, or present, inner or outer, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of it you should see as it really is with correct wisdom, thus: This is not I, I am not this, this is not my self. Therefore, great king, whatever feeling, perception, or formations there may be, and whatever consciousness there may be, whether past,

future, or present, inner or outer, coarse or subtle, inferior or excellent, far or near, all of it you should see as it really is with correct wisdom, thus: This is not I, I am not this, this is not my self.

"Great king, a learned noble disciple who sees in this way becomes disenchanted with form, and becomes disenchanted with feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness. Being disenchanted, he becomes free from desire. Being free from desire, he is liberated. Being liberated, he sees the knowledge of liberation: My birth is exhausted, the holy life has been lived, what was to be done has been done, I know no further existence beyond this."

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, there arose in King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, in eighty thousand gods, and in many hundreds of thousands of brahmins and householders of Magadha, the Dharma eye regarding phenomena, free of dust and free of stain.

Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma, and plumbed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond hesitation and crossed beyond doubt; no longer depending on others and no longer led by others; having attained fearlessness with regard to the teachings taught by the Teacher, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed with palms joined toward the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, I have gone beyond; I have truly gone beyond. Venerable One, I go for refuge to the Blessed One, to the Dharma, and to the Saṅgha of monks; please accept me as a layman. From this day onward, for as long as I live, staking even my life, I go for refuge with full faith. Blessed One, I would serve the Blessed One together with the Saṅgha of monks for as long as I live, with clothing and robes, alms food, bedding, and medicine and requisites for the sick. May the Blessed One please come to Rājagṛha."

The Blessed One consented to King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, of Rājagṛha, by remaining silent. Then King Śreṇya Bimbisāra of Magadha, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One, wandering on from Magadha, came to Rājagṛha, and at Rājagṛha he stayed at the Kalandakanivāpa.

At that time in Rājagṛha there were non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) known as the followers of Sañjayin, and not long after they had come into being, their

teacher passed away. Among them were two, called Upatiṣya and Kolita, who gathered and led the assembly. While they were leading it, the two made this pledge: "Whichever of us first finds the deathless shall tell the other."

Then, in the morning, the venerable Aśvajit put on his lower robe, took up his alms bowl and his Dharma robe, and entered Rājagṛha for alms, graceful in his going and his returning, in his glancing ahead and his looking about, in drawing in and stretching out his limbs, and in the way he carried his outer robe, his Dharma robe and his alms bowl.

At that time the wandering mendicant (parivrājaka) Upatiṣya had come into the town on some business in Rājagṛha, and from a long way off he saw the venerable Aśvajit going about Rājagṛha for alms, graceful in his going and his returning, in his glancing ahead and his looking about, in drawing in and stretching out his limbs, and in the way he carried his outer robe, his Dharma robe and his alms bowl. Seeing him, he thought: "Of all the renunciants who have come to Rājagṛha and stay here, never before have I seen any with such deportment as this renunciant. Let me go up to him and ask, 'Monk, who is your teacher? For whose sake did you go forth? In whose Dharma do you delight?'" With this in mind, he waited in a narrow lane, pacing back and forth most of the time.

Then the venerable Aśvajit came to where the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya was. And the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya said this to the venerable Aśvajit: "Monk, who is your teacher? For whose sake did you go forth? In whose Dharma do you delight?"

"Venerable one, there is a son of the Śākyas, the ascetic Gautama, who shaved off his hair and beard from the Śākya clan, put on saffron robes, and out of genuine faith went forth from home into homelessness. Having fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, that Blessed One is my teacher. It is for his sake that I went forth, and it is in his Dharma that I delight."

"Monk, then teach me the Dharma."

"Venerable one, I am young and newly gone forth, so it is not easy for me to set out in full the teaching of that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha. Nevertheless, I shall teach its meaning in this way."

"Monk, it is the meaning I need. What use to me are a great many words? Teach me the meaning, whether much or little."

Then the venerable Aśvajit spoke this verse:

Of those phenomena that arise from causes,
their cause, and also what their cessation is,
the Tathāgata himself has declared;
so speaks the great ascetic.

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the stainless, immaculate eye of Dharma regarding phenomena arose in the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya. Then the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma, and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond doubt and crossed beyond uncertainty; no longer relying on others, no longer led by others, and having gained confidence in the teachings the Teacher had taught, straightened his upper body, stretched out his right hand, bowed with palms joined toward where the venerable Aśvajit was, and spoke this verse:

This is the Dharma of the protectors.
Through countless tens of millions of eons
unseen before and unheard,
this state, deathless and free of sorrow,
has here been realized.

"Venerable one, where is that Blessed One staying now?"

"Venerable one, right here in Rājagṛha, at the Kalandakanivāpa in the Bamboo Grove."

Then the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya praised and rejoiced in what the venerable Aśvajit had said, bowed his head at the venerable Aśvajit's feet, circled the venerable Aśvajit three times, and departed, going to where the wandering mendicant Kolita was.

The wandering mendicant Kolita saw the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya from a long way off, and seeing him, he said this to the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya: "Venerable one, your senses are utterly clear, the color of your face is pure, and the color of your skin is radiant white. Have you found the deathless?"

"Venerable one, I have found it."

"Venerable one, then teach me the Dharma."

Then the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya spoke this verse:

Of those phenomena that arise from causes,
their cause, and what their cessation is,
the Tathāgata himself has declared;
so speaks the great ascetic.

"Venerable one, say it once more."

"Venerable one, I shall say it." "Of those phenomena that arise from causes," and so on, as before.

When this discourse on the Dharma had been spoken, the stainless, immaculate eye of Dharma regarding phenomena arose in the wandering mendicant Kolita. Then the wandering mendicant Kolita, having seen the Dharma, attained the Dharma, understood the Dharma, and fathomed the depths of the Dharma; having crossed beyond doubt and crossed beyond uncertainty; no longer relying on others, no longer led by others, and having gained confidence in the teachings the Teacher had taught, straightened his upper body, stretched out his right hand, bowed with palms joined toward where the wandering mendicant Upatiṣya was, and spoke this verse:

This is the Dharma of the protectors.
Through countless tens of millions of eons
unseen before and unheard,
this state, deathless and free of sorrow,
has here been realized.

"Venerable one, where is that Blessed One staying now?"

"Venerable one, right here in Rājagṛha, at the Kalandakanivāpa in the Bamboo Grove."

"Venerable one, come! Let us practice the holy life in the presence of that Blessed One."

"Venerable one, first we should consider our following. For people like us, who are known and recognized among the people, it is right to consider our following."

Then the two wandering mendicants, Upatiṣya and Kolita, said to the young brahmins, "Young brahmins, know this: the two of us are going to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One. What will you do?"

"Our two preceptors, whatever little understanding we have, all of it we have gained through relying on you two preceptors. If the two preceptors are to practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One, then we too shall go forth after the two preceptors have gone forth."

"Young brahmins, then know that the time has come for it."

Then the two wandering mendicants, Upatiṣya and Kolita, together with their following of two hundred and fifty, went to where the Blessed One was. At that time the Blessed One was seated teaching the Dharma in the midst of an assembly of many hundreds of monks. From a long way off the Blessed One saw the two wandering mendicants, Upatiṣya and Kolita, and seeing them, he said to the monks, "Monks, do you see those two, Upatiṣya and Kolita, who gather their company of companions, who lead that company, and who come at the head of that company?"

"Venerable One, we see them."

"These two will become my pair of śrāvakas, the foremost pair, the excellent pair. One will become foremost among those who possess miraculous powers, and the other will become foremost among those who possess wisdom."

Then a monk spoke this verse:

The Teacher, whose sphere of thought is boundless,
lord among men, who has reached the end of knowledge,
the Blessed One, who has made an end of existence,
saw the companions Upatiṣya and Kolita
coming thus, before they had reached the Bamboo Grove,
and in the midst of the excellent assembly
he declared of those two, "These two
will become the foremost pair of my śrāvakas."
He foretold that one would be foremost of those with miraculous powers,
and the other foremost of those with wisdom.

Then the two wandering mendicants, Upatiṣya and Kolita, went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable One, if you grant us going forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and full ordination into the state of a monk, we shall practice the holy life in the presence of the Blessed One."

The Blessed One gave the two of them the going forth with the words "Come, monk," declaring, "Come, monks, practice the holy life." And immediately

upon the Blessed One's words, their heads were shaven and they were clothed in the outer robe, holding alms bowls in their hands, with hair and beards like seven days' growth, and they stood with the deportment of monks who had been fully ordained for a hundred years.

It is further said:

When the Tathāgata declared, "Come,"
at once their bodies were shaven and clad in the outer robe,
and their senses came to rest in perfect peace;
by the Buddha's intention their bodily forms were clothed.

Then a great many monks put on their lower robes in the morning, took up their alms bowls and Dharma robes, and entered Rājagṛha for alms. Then those people of Rājagṛha who had gone forth from the non-Buddhist (tīrthika) community of Sañjayin and had received full ordination not long before, being displeased and dissatisfied, saw those various monks and, mocking them, spoke this verse:

The Buddha has come to Rājagṛha,
the foremost city of the Magadhans;
having led away all of Sañjayin's people,
whom will he lead away from now on?

At this the monks became ashamed and unhappy, and lost their confidence.

Then the great many monks, having gone about Rājagṛha for alms and having taken their meal, since they do not receive alms in the afternoon, put away their alms bowls and Dharma robes, washed their feet, and, pained and unhappy, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the great many monks said this to the Blessed One:

"Venerable One, here a great many of us monks put on our lower robes in the morning, took up our alms bowls and Dharma robes, and entered Rājagṛha for alms. Then those people of Rājagṛha who had gone forth from the non-Buddhist community of Sañjayin and had received full ordination not long before, being displeased and dissatisfied, saw those various monks and, mocking them, spoke this verse:

The Buddha has come to Rājagṛha,
the foremost city of the Magadhans;
having led away all of Sañjayin's people,

whom will he lead away from now on?

Saying this, they made us ashamed and unhappy, and we lost our confidence."

The Blessed One said, "Monks, to those people of Rājagṛha who speak in this way, say this:

Here the great heroes, the Sugatas,
lead by means of the true Dharma.
Since they lead by means of the Dharma,
what wise person would not accept it?"

When this is said, whatever conceit or boldness those people of Rājagṛha who speak in this way have will vanish entirely.

Then a great many monks put on their lower robes in the morning, took up their alms bowls and Dharma robes, and entered Rājagṛha for alms. Then those people of Rājagṛha who had gone forth from the non-Buddhist community of Sañjayin and had received full ordination not long before, being displeased and dissatisfied, saw those various monks and, mocking them, spoke this verse:

The Buddha has come to Rājagṛha,
the foremost city of the Magadhans;
having led away all of Sañjayin's people,
whom will he lead away from now on?

Then a monk spoke this verse:

Here the great heroes, the Sugatas,
lead by means of the true Dharma.
Since they lead by means of the Dharma,
what wise person would not accept it?

When he had said this, whatever conceit or boldness those people of Rājagṛha who spoke in this way had vanished entirely.

Then the Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying in Śrāvastī, in Prince Jeta's Grove, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. King Prasenajit of Kosala sent a letter to King Śuddhodana: "Your Majesty, please rejoice! Your son has attained the deathless and is satisfying beings with the deathless." When King Śuddhodana heard this message, he sent a messenger, but that messenger went forth right there; and whatever messengers he sent, every one of them went forth right

there in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya.

King Śuddhodana sat with his cheek resting on his hand, brooding, thinking, "Whatever messengers I send, every one of them goes forth right there in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya." Udāyin saw him and said, "Your Majesty, why do you sit with your face resting on your hand, so unhappy?"

He replied, "Udāyin, when Prince Sarvārthasiddha was enjoying his pleasures, whenever I sent men to carry letters, they would come back to me and say, 'Prince Sarvārthasiddha is staying here and there.' But now, when I send men to carry letters, not one of them comes back bearing a letter. How could I not brood?"

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, I shall go, deliver your message, and come back."

King Śuddhodana said, "Udāyin, whoever goes there sees the excellence of his teaching and stays right there. So if you go too, there is every reason that you will stay right there as well."

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, I will come back."

Then King Śuddhodana himself wrote a letter:

From the time you entered the womb
I cared for you and raised you well.
While the fire of the afflictions blazes fiercely,
if others take refuge in the tree of the Victor,
its branches and shoots, your disciples,
will spread and flourish,
and others will rejoice in happiness,
while I am the one whose lot is suffering.

Moreover, when you were like a tender sapling, I thought, "This is my son," and nurtured you from childhood.
Now that the people of other lands have come to enjoy the fruit of my only son,
you give no fruit of your good qualities to me: you have no compassion for me.

When you were first born,
you made this vow:
"Having accomplished my own aim,
I shall greatly benefit my kin."
Now that you have found that peace,
take me and the host of our kin

into your loving care,
and please resolve to come.

Udāyin took the letter carrying this message and set out, and in due course he reached Śrāvastī. Having rested from the weariness of the road, he went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, he offered the letter to the Blessed One, saying, "This is a letter of request from King Śuddhodana." The Blessed One took it himself and read it. Having read it, he set the letter aside, and Udāyin said, "Blessed One, what is it? Will you not go to Kapilavastu?"

The Blessed One said, "Udāyin, I will go."

Udāyin had formerly been especially intimate with the Blessed One, and out of that former intimacy he said, "Blessed One, if you will not go, I shall lead you there by force."

Then, on this occasion, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

The Buddha who is not attached to the queen of sense objects,
whom no craving whatever can lead away,
whose range is boundless:
he has no footing, so by what footing would you lead him?

The Buddha who is not attached to the queen of sense objects,
whom no craving whatever can lead away,
whose prowess is boundless:
he has no footing, so by what footing would you lead him?

He whose conquest, once won, is never undone,
and in the world there is nothing left unconquered,
the Buddha whose range is boundless:
he has no footing, so by what footing would you lead him?

Unable to give an answer, Udāyin said, "Blessed One, let me go and inform King Śuddhodana."

"Udāyin, a messenger of the Buddha is not like this."

Udāyin asked, "Blessed One, what is he like?"

"He is one who has gone forth, so you too go forth."

"Blessed One, I promised King Śuddhodana that I would come back."

The Blessed One said, "Udāyin, go forth, and then do as you promised."

For in the past, when the Blessed One was a bodhisattva, he had never once turned back any word in accord with the Dharma spoken by his father, his mother, his preceptor, his teacher, his guru, or those in the place of a guru. So Udāyin said, "Blessed One, if that is so, I shall go forth."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāriputra, "Śāriputra, give this Udāyin the going forth, for his lasting welfare, benefit and happiness."

"Venerable One, as you command," said the venerable Śāriputra, heeding the Blessed One. He gave Udāyin the going forth and full ordination, explained to him in detail the rules of conduct, and said, "Udāyin, this is your duty: from today onward you must not sleep in the same house as a woman."

"Venerable one, as you command," said Udāyin. He bowed his head at the venerable Śāriputra's feet and left, and went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am going to Kapilavastu."

The Blessed One said, "Udāyin, go. Do not enter the royal palace straightaway; stay at the gate and say, 'A Śākya monk has come.' If they say, 'Please come in,' then you may enter. Once inside, if they say, 'Are there other Śākya monks too?' you should say, 'There are.' If they ask, 'Does Prince Sarvārthasiddha also look like this, and dress like this?' you should say, 'He looks like this, and dresses like this.' You must not stay in the royal palace. If they ask, 'Does Prince Sarvārthasiddha also not stay in a royal palace?' you should say, 'He does not.' If they ask, 'Where does he stay?' you should say, 'In the wilderness, or in a monastery.' If they ask, 'What is a monastery like?' you should draw the layout of Prince Jeta's Grove and show it to them. If they ask, 'Will Prince Sarvārthasiddha come?' you should say, 'He will come.'"

"If they ask, 'When will he come?' you should say, 'When seven days have passed.'"

Udāyin said, "Blessed One, I am going."

The Blessed One said, "Go.

Lords of the earth accomplish things by their word;
gods accomplish them by thinking of them;
and likewise, for those who meditate,
all is accomplished by a mere arising of the mind."

The Blessed One blessed the venerable Udāyin so that in that very instant he went to the city of Kapilavastu. The venerable Udāyin, in whom intense faith in

the Blessed One had arisen, stood at the gate of the royal palace and said, "Sirs, please tell the king that a Śākya monk has come."

They said, "What, are there other Śākya monks as well?"

"Sirs, there are."

They said to the king, "A Śākya monk has come."

The king said, "Let him in."

When he had come in, King Śuddhodana saw him and said, "Udāyin, have you gone forth?"

"Your Majesty, I have gone forth."

"Did you not say that you would come back? What is this?"

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, the Blessed One declared, 'A messenger of the Buddha is not like this,' and so I went forth; but because the Dharma and Vinaya are well spoken, I also went forth out of my own faith."

The king embraced him with all his limbs and had him sit on a seat already prepared. For his sake he had water strained and fruit prepared, made it clean, and had him eat. The venerable Udāyin, supremely peaceful and abiding in discipline, partook of it according to the procedure he had been taught. The king observed him, and, filled with wonder, said, "Udāyin, is Prince Sarvārthasiddha also as peaceful as this?"

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, my discipline and peace are only a tiny fraction. To give a simile, it is like Mount Meru compared to a mustard seed, like the ocean compared to the water in a hoofprint, like the sun compared to a firefly, like the sky compared to the hollow in a lotus stalk."

King Śuddhodana said, "Udāyin, does Prince Sarvārthasiddha also look like this, and dress like this?"

"Your Majesty, he looks like this, and dresses like this as well."

King Śuddhodana fell to the ground in a faint. When they had sprinkled him with plenty of water, he came to again and said, "Udāyin, will Prince Sarvārthasiddha come?"

Udāyin said, "Your Majesty, he will come."

"When?"

"When seven days have passed."

King Śuddhodana commanded his ministers, "Sirs, Prince Sarvārthasiddha is going to come. Clean the royal residence and the palace."

Udāyin said, "The Blessed One does not stay in palaces."

The king said, "Where does he stay?"

Udāyin said, "In the wilderness, or in a monastery."

King Śuddhodana said, "Udāyin, what is a monastery like?"

The venerable Udāyin drew the layout of Prince Jeta's Grove as a picture and showed it to him. Then the king said to his ministers, "Sirs, in the Nyagrodha Park, have sixteen great monastery buildings and sixty small dwellings built after the design of Prince Jeta's Grove."

"Your Majesty, as you command," said the ministers, heeding King Śuddhodana, and in the Nyagrodha Park they had sixteen great monastery buildings and sixty small dwellings built after the design of Prince Jeta's Grove.

Then the Blessed One said this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Maudgalyāyana, go and instruct the monks: 'The Blessed One is going to Kapilavastu, where father and son will meet. Whichever of you would like to see it, take up your robes.'"

"Venerable One, as you command," said the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, heeding the Blessed One, and he said to the monks, "Venerable ones, the Blessed One has declared: 'The Blessed One is going to Kapilavastu, where father and son will meet. Whichever of you would like to see it, take up your robes.'"

Then the Blessed One, disciplined and with a disciplined following, peaceful and with a peaceful following, liberated and with a liberated following, consoled and with a consoled following, thoroughly disciplined and with a thoroughly disciplined following, an arhat with a following of arhats, free of desire and with a following free of desire, beautiful and with a beautiful following; like a bull surrounded by a herd of cattle, like a great elephant surrounded by a herd of young elephants, like a lion surrounded by a pack of fanged beasts, like a king of geese surrounded by a flock of geese, like a garuḍa surrounded by a flock of birds, like a brahmin surrounded by a group of students, like a skilled physician surrounded by a crowd of patients, like a warrior surrounded by his troops, like a guide surrounded by a band of travelers, like a caravan leader surrounded by a company of merchants, like a regional king surrounded by a council of ministers, like a wheel-turning king

surrounded by his thousand sons, like the moon surrounded by the host of constellations, like the sun surrounded by its thousand rays, like Dhṛtarāṣṭra surrounded by a host of gandharvas, like Virūḍhaka surrounded by a host of kumbhāṇḍas, like Virūpākṣa surrounded by a host of nāgas, like Vaiśravaṇa surrounded by a host of yakṣas, like Vemacitrin surrounded by a host of asuras, like Śakra surrounded by the host of the Thirty-Three, like Brahmā surrounded by the host of the Brahmakāyika gods; like the ocean, unshaken; like a cloud, laden with rain; like a noble elephant, free of arrogance; his senses well tamed, so that his deportment was never disturbed; his body thoroughly adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being and beautified by the eighty excellent minor marks; his body adorned with a halo a fathom wide, its radiance surpassing a thousand rays of the sun; altogether beautiful, like a moving mountain of jewels; possessed of the ten powers, the four fearlessnesses, the three unmixed applications of mindfulness, and great compassion, came together with a great Saṅgha of monks to the Rohitaka River.

King Śuddhodana heard that Prince Sarvārthasiddha had come to the Rohitaka River.

When he heard this, King Śuddhodana had the city of Kapilavastu cleared of stones, pebbles and gravel and sprinkled with sandalwood water. He had bowls of exquisitely fragrant incense set out and many silk streamers hung up, and the whole road from the Rohitaka River to the Nyagrodha Park was made exceedingly beautiful. And across a broad, spacious area he had colorful seats arranged.

Meanwhile, at the Rohitaka River, some monks were washing their hands, some were discarding their tooth sticks, and some were bathing. The Śākyas living in Kapilavastu heard that Prince Sarvārthasiddha had come. When they heard it, some, urged on by their former roots of virtue, and some, filled with curiosity, all came out from the Nyagrodha Park, thinking, "Let us see whether the father will bow at the feet of the son, or the son at the feet of the father."

Then the Blessed One thought, "If I go to Kapilavastu on foot, the proud Śākyas will lose faith, saying, 'Alas! Prince Sarvārthasiddha went to the forest of austerities, and all he achieved was an empty belly, look! Such a one ought to come through the sky above, attended by many hundreds of thousands; yet after practicing hundreds of thousands of austerities for so long and attaining the deathless, look, he comes on foot!'"

Then the Blessed One composed his mind in meditation, rose up into the sky in the east, and displayed the four kinds of deportment: walking, standing, sitting and lying down. He also entered the samādhi of fire, and having entered the samādhi of fire, he sent forth from the body of the Buddha, the Blessed One, rays of light of many kinds: blue, yellow, red, white, crimson, and the color of crystal. He also displayed the twin miracle: flames blazed from the lower part of his body while streams of cool water poured from the upper part of his body, and flames blazed from the upper part of his body while streams of cool water poured from the lower part of his body. Such was the samādhi he entered. As in the east, so too in the south, the west and the north.

Having displayed the four kinds of miraculous display in the four directions, he withdrew his manifestation of miraculous power and remained at the height of seven palm trees, while the monks were at the height of six palm trees. When the Blessed One was at the height of six, the monks were at the height of five. When the Blessed One was at the height of five, the monks were at the height of four. When the Blessed One was at the height of four, the monks were at the height of three. When the Blessed One was at the height of three, the monks were at the height of two. When the Blessed One was at the height of two, the monks were at the height of one palm tree.

When the Blessed One remained at the height of seven men, the monks were at the height of six men. When the Blessed One was at the height of six, the monks were at the height of five. When the Blessed One was at the height of five, the monks were at the height of four. When the Blessed One was at the height of four, the monks were at the height of three. When the Blessed One was at the height of three, the monks were at the height of two. When the Blessed One was at the height of two, the monks were at little more than a man's height. When the Blessed One was at little more than a man's height, the monks were on the ground.

When King Śuddhodana saw such a miracle and so many monks, he was bewildered and did not know which of them was the Blessed One. So he said to the venerable Udāyin, "Udāyin, there are a great many renunciants here wearing saffron robes. Which of them is the prince?"

The venerable Udāyin pointed out the Blessed One and said:

"This is the Blessed One, the Ender of existence, the lord of the mind, the Guide.
This is the sun that dispels the afflictions, who teaches every aim.

This is he who has attained what he intended, possessed of the ten powers, gone beyond all.
He who sought the stainless, the lord of Dharma, is your son. Lord of men, behold him!"

Then King Śuddhodana bowed his body, prostrated at his feet, and spoke in verse:

O you of vast wisdom, with this
I have bowed three times at the feet of the All-Seeing One:
when at your birth the earth shook,
and when the jambu tree's shade did not pass from your body.

Then the Śākya men and women, seeing King Śuddhodana touch his head to the Blessed One's feet, lost faith, saying, "What sort of conduct is this, a father bowing at the feet of his son?"

To make the Śākya men and women understand, King Śuddhodana said this: "Sirs, it is not only now that I have bowed at the feet of Prince Sarvārthasiddha. When Prince Sarvārthasiddha was born, there was a great earthquake, and this whole world was lit up with a vast radiance. Even the dark intervals between the worlds, black and pitch dark, never reached by the light of the sun and moon, so mighty in miraculous power and so great in strength, were at that time lit up by a great radiance. By that light the beings born there saw one another and recognized one another, saying, 'Friends, look, other beings are born here too! Friends, look, other beings are born here too!' At that time too I bowed my head at the feet of the Bodhisattva.

When Prince Sarvārthasiddha went to watch the work at the edge of the fields, he sat in the shade of a jambu tree. Secluded from desires, secluded from evil and unwholesome phenomena, with conception and with analysis, he attained and dwelt in the first meditative concentration, which has the joy and happiness born of seclusion and is congruent with the undefiled. Then the shadows of the other trees inclined toward the east and sloped toward the east, but although they fell toward the east, the shadow of the jambu tree did not move away from the body of the Bodhisattva. At that time too my mind was captivated by that wondrous and marvelous phenomenon, and I bowed once more at the feet of the Blessed One. With this, I have bowed three times at the feet of the Blessed One. Therefore he said:

O you of vast intelligence, with this
I have bowed three times at the feet of the All-Seeing One:
when you were born this earth shook,
and the shadow of the jambu did not move away from your body.

Then the Blessed One withdrew the miracle he had manifested and, outshining an assembly of many hundreds, sat down on the seat that had been prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks.

Then King Śuddhodana, his voice faltering and his eyes filled with tears, questioned the Blessed One in the melody of verse:

From dwellings like celestial palaces,
from living in your father's house,
how is it that you now dwell alone
in wildernesses full of dangers?

The Blessed One said:

Lord of men, wherever they may be,
freed from the bonds of household life,
the sages make their dwelling
in the ten abodes of the noble ones.

The king said:

You used to sleep upon a couch
of ivory with feet of gold,
spread with the softest coverings:
how do you not suffer on a simple mat?

The Blessed One said:

O king, on the bed of liberation,
strewn with the flowers of joy and the limbs of awakening,
I sleep without attachment,
free of every torment.

The king said:

Hero, in your own palace
you went by elephant, chariot and horse:
how do you now go on foot
over ground full of thorns?

The Blessed One said:

My chariot is the bases of miraculous power,
driven on by right effort;
though I roam through every land,
the thorns of the afflictions do me no harm.

King Śuddhodana said:

Hero, once you wore garments
of Kāśi cloth and were splendid:
how does your body now bear
a coarse saffron robe?

The Blessed One said:

O king, my garment is a sense of shame;
what I wear is the patched outer robe;
wearing it, the peaceful sages
become beautiful in the forest.

King Śuddhodana said:

Once you ate rice of many flavors
from bowls of gold;
now, O lord, how does this alms food,
this common fare, go down your throat?

The Blessed One said:

Having abandoned all craving for food,
I partake of the supreme taste of my Dharma,
which brings renunciation and meditative equipoise;
yet I take alms out of compassion for the world.

King Śuddhodana said:

You used to drink grape wine and sugared water,
which bring much delight to the throat:
how do you drink water
that is murky and foul-smelling?

The Blessed One said:

Lord of men, I drink the water of supreme taste;
when one has drunk it,
all other drinks

appear to me like poison.

King Śuddhodana said:

Once you dwelt in cool chambers, in mansions like celestial palaces,
and on the upper storeys, each according to its season;
now that you dwell alone in the forest,
O noble-minded one, how do you live without fear?

The Blessed One said:

Gautama, since I have abandoned the root of fear,
the stains together with their habitual tendencies,
I dwell free of sorrow and fear;
here I have not the slightest fear.

King Śuddhodana said:

Once, in your most delightful bathhouse,
you were always cooled by the finest, most exquisite baths;
now, Lord of Sages, as you dwell alone in the forest,
who will bathe you?

The Blessed One said:

Gautama, the stainless pool of the Dharma
has the ford of moral discipline, praised by the holy;
people of virtue who touch it and bathe there
cross over to the far shore with bodies unwet.

King Śuddhodana said:

Hero, in your own house
you were bathed from vases of gold and silver:
how do you now bathe in water
that is murky and foul-smelling?

The Blessed One said:

Gautama, the river of faith is unclouded;
it has the ford of merit, praised by the holy;
people endowed with knowledge who bathe there
cross over to the far shore with bodies unwet.

King Śuddhodana said:

Hero, once in Kapilavastu
your body was bathed with sandalwood,
and you were splendid, clothed in the finest Kāśi cloth;
parted from all that, you are splendid no longer.

The Blessed One said:

Moral discipline is my ornament;
moral discipline itself is my unguent.
Gold, jewels and earrings, born of delusion,
what use are they to me?

King Śuddhodana said:

What makes you disdain these things?
From what does fear arise?
And from what does weariness arise?
Tell me the things I have asked.

The Blessed One said:

What makes me disdain them,
what it is that brings fear,
and from what weariness has arisen,
listen, and I shall explain it to you.
Old age, sickness and death:
if these three did not exist,
I too would take delight
in objects that are most pleasing.

King Śuddhodana said:

Joy of the Śākya clan,
hero, well born, excellent!
You are in no way stained
by the eight worldly concerns.

Then, overjoyed, his faith grown strong,
he circumambulated the Saṅgha of sages,
bowed his head at the feet of the Sage,
and sat gazing at the Sugata.

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "That my son has gained such a wealth of good qualities means that I have truly gained what is worth gaining."

Then the Blessed One, in the Nyagrodha Park, knowing the intentions, the latent tendencies, the constituents and the natures of that assembly, taught the Dharma in accord with them. Hearing it, seventy-seven thousand Śākyas, Śuklodana and the others, directly realized the fruit of stream-entry, all except King Śuddhodana.

Devadatta, who was arrogant with pride upon pride, of evil desires, and who had not seen the truth, said in a fit of anger, "If I knew how to bring people under my control with an illusion like this, I too would bring the whole world under my control." The Śākyas rebuked him with words of reproach: "Devadatta, the Blessed One has great miraculous power. Do not speak like that!" Thus restrained, he sat without saying anything.

In the pleasure grove called Encircled by Brahmā, the Blessed One taught the Dharma in the same way, and on hearing it sixty-six thousand Śākyas, Droṇodana and the others, all except King Śuddhodana, directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Even then Devadatta said the very same thing.

In the Rohitaka pleasure grove the Blessed One taught the Dharma in the same way, and on hearing it seventy-five thousand Śākyas, Amṛtodana and the others, all except King Śuddhodana, directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Even then Devadatta said the very same thing.

Of the rest of the assembly, some set their minds on the awakening of a śrāvaka, some on the awakening of a pratyekabuddha, and some on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Some directly realized the fruit of stream-entry, some the fruit of once-returning, and some the fruit of non-returning. Some went forth, abandoned all the afflictions, and became arhats. Some went for refuge to the Buddha, some to the Dharma, and some to the Saṅgha. Indeed, most of that assembly were established so as to incline toward the Buddha, slope toward the Dharma, and flow toward the Saṅgha.

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "Formerly the Blessed One was honored, revered and praised by the world with its gods and asuras, but now he is honored by humans and not by the gods."

Then a young Śākya addressed him in verse:

Great sage, supreme among speakers, with the rain
of the true Dharma you satisfy these beings.
This world that has fallen onto a terrible path,
lead it, please, and set it on the path of liberation.

Then the Blessed One reflected, "King Śuddhodana is thinking, 'Only my son has such great miraculous power and such great might,' and he has become excessively elated. In short, I must make him give up his pride. For two reasons one does not come to see the truths: excessive dejection and excessive elation. He has both a dejected mind and excessive elation, so I shall make him give up both his dejection and his excessive elation."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, go to King Śuddhodana."

"Venerable One, I shall do as you say," replied the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, heeding the Blessed One, and he went to where King Śuddhodana was. King Śuddhodana saw the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana coming from far off, and when he saw him he said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Come, Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana! Mahāmaudgalyāyana, you are welcome. Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, please sit on the seat that has been prepared." The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana sat on the seat that had been prepared.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana settled his mind in such a way that he vanished from his seat, rose into the sky above in the east, and there adopted the four modes of conduct, namely walking, standing, sitting and lying down. He also entered the absorption of fire, and when he had entered the absorption of fire, his body emitted light rays of many kinds, namely blue, yellow, red, white, crimson and the color of crystal. He also displayed the twin miracle: he made fire blaze from the lower part of his body and a stream of cold water pour down from the upper part of his body; he made fire blaze from the upper part of his body and a stream of cold water pour down from the lower part of his body. Such was the meditative absorption that he entered. As in the east, so too in the south, the west and the north. Having displayed these four kinds of miraculous display in the four directions, he withdrew his miraculous manifestation and sat down on the seat that had been prepared.

Then King Śuddhodana said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, are there other śrāvakas of the Blessed One who have such great miraculous power and such great might?"

"There are, great king," he said, and spoke in verse:

Those of great might, possessing the three knowledges,
those who know the minds of others,
and arhats whose defilements are exhausted:

the Sage has many such śrāvakas.

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "It is not only my son who has such great miraculous power and such great might; there are other renunciants too who have such great miraculous power and such great might." And with that he was freed of his excessive elation.

On that occasion the Blessed One brought forth a worldly thought: "Ah, if Śakra, Brahmā and the other gods would come, I would teach the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods." By the nature of things, when the buddhas, the blessed ones, bring forth a worldly thought, even the minds of tiny creatures such as ants and beetles come to know the Blessed One's intention, so what need is there to mention Śakra, Brahmā and the other gods? But when they bring forth a thought that transcends the world, not even the minds of the great śrāvakas know the Blessed One's intention, so what need is there to mention Śakra, Brahmā and the other gods? How could tiny creatures such as ants and beetles know it?

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, wondered, "Why has the Blessed One brought forth a worldly thought?" and he realized, "He wishes to teach the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods." So he commanded the god Viśvakarman, "Viśvakarman, the Blessed One wishes to teach the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods. Conjure up in the Nyagrodha Park a multistoried pavilion of the four kinds of precious substance, furnished with all kinds of seats."

"Kauśika, your word is excellent indeed," said the god Viśvakarman, heeding Śakra, lord of the gods, and in the Nyagrodha Park he conjured up a multistoried pavilion of the four kinds of precious substance, furnished with all kinds of seats.

At its four gates were stationed the Four Great Kings: Dhṛtarāṣṭra, Virūḍhaka, Virūpākṣa and Kubera. At the eastern gate was Dhṛtarāṣṭra, adorned with armlets, earrings, bracelets, garlands and all kinds of ornaments. On the south was Virūḍhaka, adorned with every divine ornament. On the west was Virūpākṣa, adorned with the seven kinds of precious substance. On the north was Kubera, adorned with every ornament.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, had the Nyagrodha Park lavishly adorned, went to where the Blessed One was, and on arriving reported the matter to the Blessed One in full. Then the Blessed One, surrounded by Śakra, Brahmā and many hundreds of thousands of gods, entered the multistoried pavilion and sat

on a lion throne adorned with all kinds of jewels, in the midst of a vast assembly of gods.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, bringing King Śuddhodana with him, went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana went inside, but the Great King Dhṛtarāṣṭra stopped King Śuddhodana, saying, "Great king, do not go in. Stay here."

"Why?"

"The Blessed One is teaching the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods, and no one who is human may enter there."

"Fair one, who are you?"

"Great king, I am Dhṛtarāṣṭra."

Then King Śuddhodana went to the southern gate, and when the Great King Virūḍhaka saw him, he said, "Great king, do not enter. Stay here."

King Śuddhodana looked at him and said, "Fair one, who are you?"

Virūḍhaka said, "Great king, I am Virūḍhaka."

"Why?"

"The Blessed One is teaching the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods, and no one who is human may enter there."

Then King Śuddhodana went to the western gate, and when the Great King Virūpākṣa saw him, he said, "Great king, do not enter. Stay here."

King Śuddhodana looked at him and said, "Fair one, who are you?"

Virūpākṣa said, "Great king, I am Virūpākṣa."

"Why?"

"The Blessed One is teaching the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods, and no one who is human may enter there."

Then King Śuddhodana went to the northern gate, and when the Great King Vaiśravaṇa saw him, he said, "Great king, do not enter. Stay here."

King Śuddhodana said, "Fair one, who are you?"

Vaiśravaṇa said, "Great king, I am Vaiśravaṇa."

"Why?"

"The Blessed One is teaching the Dharma to a pure assembly of gods, and no one who is human may enter there."

Then in King Śuddhodana there arose the longing, "Oh, how I wish I could watch the Blessed One teaching the Dharma to the pure assembly of gods!" And with that King Śuddhodana was freed from his state of dejection.

Then the Blessed One reflected, "If King Śuddhodana does not see me, he will reach a state in which he will vomit warm blood and die. I must devise a means for this." So the Blessed One transformed the multistoried pavilion of the four kinds of precious substance so that it was made of crystal, and then King Śuddhodana saw the body of the Buddha without obstruction. When he saw it, joy and delight arose in him; he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One, knowing King Śuddhodana's intention, latent tendencies, constituents and nature, taught him the Dharma in such a way that he would come to realize each of the four noble truths. Hearing it, King Śuddhodana shattered with the vajra of wisdom the lofty twenty-peaked mountain of the view of the perishable collection, and directly realized the fruit of stream-entry. Having seen the truths, he three times uttered this solemn utterance:

"Venerable One, what was not done for me by my father, nor by my mother, nor by the king, nor by the gods, nor by my departed ancestors, nor by ascetics and brahmins, nor by my loved ones, my own people and the host of my kin, that the Blessed One has done for me. He has dried up the ocean of blood and tears, rescued me from the mountain of bones, closed the doors to the lower realms, opened the doors to the higher realms and to liberation, and established me among gods and humans."

And he said further:

The kindness a worthy son should do
to repay his father,
you have done for me:
you have turned my mind toward liberation.
You drew me up out of the lower destinies
and set me where I need not strain
for the higher realms and liberation;
well have you brought me joy.
Loving protector, like a merchant

who has found his profit,
you have let me gain the higher realms
and the riches of existence.

Then King Śuddhodana rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, I am preparing a midday meal at my residence tomorrow; please consent to come, together with the Saṅgha of monks." The Blessed One consented to King Śuddhodana by remaining silent.

Then King Śuddhodana, understanding that the Blessed One had consented by remaining silent, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, departed from the presence of the Blessed One, and went to where Śuklodana was. When he arrived, he said to Śuklodana, "Prince, the kingdom has come to you. Take the kingdom."

"Why is that?"

"Because I have seen the truth in the presence of the Blessed One."

"On what day?"

"Just today."

"I too saw the truth, together with seventy-seven thousand Śākyas, on the day the Blessed One taught the Dharma in the Nyagrodha Park."

In the same way he said to Droṇodana, "Take the kingdom," and he replied, "I too saw the truth, together with seventy-six thousand Śākyas, at the time the Blessed One taught the Dharma in the pleasure grove called Encircled by Brahmā."

In the same way he said to Amṛtodana, "Take the kingdom," and he replied, "I too saw the truth, together with seventy-five thousand Śākyas, at the time the Blessed One himself taught the Dharma in the Rohitaka pleasure grove."

"If that is so, whom shall we place on the throne?"

They said, "Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, shall take it." So they assembled and consecrated Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, to sovereign rule over the kingdom.

Then King Śuddhodana spent that very night preparing pure and delicious food, both hard and soft. Rising early the next morning, he had the seats set out and a jeweled water vessel placed, and he sent a messenger to invite the Blessed One and announce the time: "Venerable One, it is time for the midday

meal. Please know that the time has come."

In the morning the Blessed One put on his lower robe, took up his bowl and Dharma robe, and, surrounded by the company of monks and preceded by the Saṅgha of monks, went to the dining hall of King Śuddhodana. When he arrived, he sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the Saṅgha of monks.

Then King Śuddhodana, seeing that the Saṅgha of monks headed by the Buddha was comfortably seated, served them with his own hands with pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, and satisfied them; in many ways he served them with his own hands with pure and delicious food, both hard and soft, and satisfied them. When he saw that the Blessed One had finished his meal, had washed his hands and had put away his bowl, he took up a golden spouted pitcher and offered the Nyagrodha Park to the Blessed One. The Blessed One, with a voice of five qualities, dedicated the offering:

By whatever merit there is in this gift,
may the hopes the Śākyas have held
in their minds be fulfilled,
and may they attain the permanent state.

Then the Blessed One stayed at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park. Accordingly, the meditators too set it down in the sūtras: "The Blessed One was staying at Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park."

While the Blessed One stayed at Kapilavastu, on one day he took his midday meal in the king's palace and on another day in the women's quarters.

King Śuddhodana saw that the monks who had gone forth from among the matted-hair ascetics, though serene in their conduct and inspiring confidence, were unlovely in body, their bodies wasted by various kinds of fierce ascetic vows. When he saw this, he thought, "These matted-hair ascetics are serene in conduct and inspire confidence, but they are not lovely in body. With what kind of retinue would the Blessed One look splendid?" And he concluded, "With a retinue of Śākyas."

So he gathered all the Śākyas and said, "Friends, if Prince Sarvārthasiddha had not gone forth, what would he have become?"

"He would have become a universal monarch."

"And what would you have done?"

"We would have served him."

"Now Prince Sarvārthasiddha has become the unsurpassed king of Dharma; why do you not serve him?"

"Your Majesty, are we to go forth?"

"Go forth!"

"All of us?"

"One from each household."

"As you command."

King Śuddhodana had it proclaimed with bells throughout the city of Kapilavastu: "The king has commanded: Of the Śākyas who live in my realm, one from each household must go forth!"

Droṇodana had two sons, Aniruddha and Mahānāman. Mahānāman devoted himself above all to work in the fields, while Aniruddha stayed on the upper terrace of the palace, amusing himself, delighting and enjoying himself with music played without men.

His mother said to Mahānāman, "Son, the king has had it proclaimed with bells, commanding that of the Śākyas one from each household must go forth. You go forth."

He said, "I will not go forth. Have your darling son, who lives in comfort, go forth."

"Son, do not try to compete with that being of great merit and fortune."

"Mother, the one you favor may well have great merit and fortune, but today send him nothing at all, and it will become clear whether he has great merit and fortune or not."

"Son, I will do just that, and we shall see for certain."

She filled an empty basket with dishes, wrapped its mouth in white cloth, and sealed it with a seal of lac. She sent it in the hands of a serving girl, instructing her, "If he asks what is in it, say, 'There is nothing.'"

The girl took it and set off. Now the knowledge and vision of Śakra, lord of the gods, reaches down below, and he thought, "Why should the one who offered alms to the pratyekabuddha All-Knowing go short of food today? I shall prepare a meal for him." So he filled those dishes with lentil soup, vegetables

and food of every flavor.

In due course the serving girl brought it to Aniruddha. He said, "Girl, what is in this?"

She said, "Young master, there is nothing."

Aniruddha thought, "If my mother did not love me, why would she send this empty? Surely she has sent a food called 'nothing.' Let me have a look." When at last he opened it, the whole pleasure grove was filled with the delicious smell of food. Tasting it, Aniruddha was utterly amazed. Since he was respectful toward his mother, he sent her the first portion of the food with the message, "Mother, every day you should send me this kind of food called 'nothing.'"

She too saw it and was utterly amazed. She showed it to Mahānāman: "Son, do you see?"

"Mother, I see."

"Did I not tell you before not to try to compete with that being of great merit and fortune, who has a human's best of fortune?"

He said, "Mother, whether he has great merit and fortune or not, I will not go forth." Thus Mahānāman would not under any circumstances agree to go forth.

Then she said to Aniruddha, "Son, the king has had it proclaimed with bells, commanding that of the Śākyas one from each household must go forth. Will you go forth, or will you remain a householder?"

He said, "Mother, what are the benefits of going forth, and what are its drawbacks? What are the benefits of remaining a householder, and what are its drawbacks?"

"Son, if one who has gone forth practices well, he will attain nirvāṇa. If he does not practice well, he will attain the state of gods and humans. If one remains a householder and keeps to the good, he will attain the state of gods and humans. If he does not, he will be reborn among hell beings, animals and hungry ghosts."

"Mother, the drawback of going forth is the very benefit of living in a household. Therefore I do not wish to live in a household. Please give me your permission, and I will go forth."

She said, "Good, son. Do so."

Aniruddha's close friend was Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, so he went to see him. At that moment Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, was playing the vīṇā, and as he played, a string broke and the sound changed. Aniruddha was skilled at playing the vīṇā, and noting how the sound had changed, he stayed at the door and said to the doorkeeper, "Hey, chamberlain, go and tell King Bhadrika: 'Aniruddha wishes to see Your Majesty's face and is waiting at the door.'"

The doorkeeper went and said to Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, "Your Majesty, Aniruddha wishes to see Your Majesty's face and is waiting at the gate."

He said, "Friend, who would keep Aniruddha out? Friend, let Aniruddha in."

When he came in, the king embraced him, had him sit down, and said, "How long is it since you arrived?"

He said, "Since the moment when, as you were playing the vīṇā, the string broke and the sound changed."

The king was utterly amazed and said, "You are skilled at playing the vīṇā." Then Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, said, "Prince, what have you come for?"

Aniruddha said, "Your Majesty, King Śuddhodana has had it proclaimed with bells, commanding that of the Śākyas one from each household must go forth. Please take note of this: I am going forth."

The king said, "If that is so, I too shall go forth. There are things to discuss, so stay here today." So he lodged right there.

The bed-maker had spread the bed with cloth that smelled of fever and strewn it with loose flowers. When Aniruddha lay down on it, he felt the touch of a flower stalk underneath and said, "Is there a pebble under here?" When they began to search, they found a flower stalk, and they were utterly amazed. Aniruddha slept badly that night until dawn.

The king said, "Aniruddha, did you sleep well?"

He said, "Your Majesty, I did not sleep well."

The king said, "Why?"

Aniruddha said, "Your Majesty, a cloth smelling of fever was spread out, and among the loose flowers strewn over it a flower stalk hurt my body."

The king summoned the bed-maker and said, "Why did you spread a cloth smelling of fever?"

The bed-maker said, "Your Majesty, the treasurer handed it to me."

The king summoned the treasurer and said, "Why did you issue a cloth smelling of fever?"

He said, "Your Majesty, the weaver handed it to me."

The king summoned the weaver and said, "Why did you supply a cloth smelling of fever?"

The weaver said, "Your Majesty, when only a little of the cloth was left to weave, I finished it while stricken with fever."

The king said, "Prince, how did you know?"

He said, "I felt a feverish touch, so it was the smell of fever."

The king was utterly amazed and said, "Friend Aniruddha is the Śākya endowed with the best of fortune."

Then Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, said, "Prince, if I go forth, Devadatta will become king of the Śākyas, and he will do harm to the Śākyas. So let us all gather and stir up Devadatta's enthusiasm for going forth." So Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, summoned him, and when they had all gathered, they said, "Devadatta, if all of us go forth, what will you do?"

Devadatta thought, "If I say, 'I will not go forth,' then Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, will not go forth either. I must devise some means for this and deceive him."

"Moreover, on the day that the Blessed One displayed a miracle of magic in the Nyagrodha Park, the thought arose in me, 'Just as this man brings a great multitude of people under his sway by his magic, so too shall I bring them under my sway.'" With this in mind, he said, "If you all go forth, why would I stay behind?"

Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, thought, "He is speaking falsely. I will make him bind himself by a pledge, so that many people will each come to know of it." Then the king wrote these words on a tablet and had them proclaimed with a bell throughout the city of Kapilavastu: "Listen, you wise ones who dwell in the city of Kapilavastu! Five hundred Śākyas, Bhadrika, Revata, Aniruddha, Devadatta and others, are going to go forth. Take note of this, and rejoice greatly!"

When Devadatta heard this, great suffering and unhappiness arose in him, and he thought, "Had I known that Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, would certainly go forth, I would never have agreed. Now, if I do not go forth, it will be said, 'He is

a liar,' and I will not gain the kingship either. Is everything then altogether lost at this point? Why not go forth? Even while having gone forth, I will exercise the kingship."

Then King Śuddhodana thought, "I shall look upon this last splendor of the Śākyas." He had the city cleared of gravel and potsherds and sprinkled with sandalwood water, had parasols and victory banners raised and many silk streamers hung, had censers of exquisitely fragrant incense set out, and had it made delightful with scatterings of every kind of flower. Then, surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of Śākyas, he sat upon a lion throne at the city gate. The Śākya women and the wonderstruck Śākya youths took their places at the latticed windows, the windows, and the terraces. Crowds of men who had come from many lands, wishing to see the splendor of the Śākyas, stood along the highways, in the marketplaces, at the crossroads and at the junctions of three roads. He summoned brahmin soothsayers and diviners to discern which of the Śākyas would bring satisfaction and which would bring grief.

The Śākyas, adorned with necklaces, bracelets, armlets and other ornaments, looked upon their fathers and mothers, each mounted his own chariot, and they began to ride out. When the soothsayers saw Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, come out at their head, they said, "This one, for his part, will bring satisfaction." Likewise, when Revata, Aniruddha and the others came out, the soothsayers made predictions about them too. Then Devadatta came out, and as he came out, the soothsayers saw a hawk snatch away the jewel from his crown. They said, "Judging by this sign, he will without doubt quarrel with the Teacher and plunge into hell." When Kokālika, Khaṇḍadravya, Kaṭamoraka, Tiṣya and Samudradatta came out, a donkey brayed, and the soothsayers made a prediction about them as well: "These too will speak abusively to the great śrāvakas and plunge into hell." As Upananda, riding on an elephant, was looking this way and that, his pearl necklace fell, and he climbed down from the elephant and picked it up. Of him too they predicted, "This one, being exceedingly greedy, will be reborn among the beings of hell."

Then those five hundred Śākyas, Bhadrika, Revata, Aniruddha, Devadatta and the rest, vying with one another in finery as though going to a festival in a pleasure garden, went to where the Blessed One was. The Blessed One reflected, "If I give the Śākyas the going forth with the words 'Come, monk,' some will bring satisfaction and some will not, and those who will not would think otherwise. Those who go forth by 'Come, monk' are all beings in their

final existence. Therefore I shall have the monks give all of them the going forth and full ordination by a formal act of motion and three proclamations." With this in mind, he declared to the monks, "Monks, give the Śākyas of Kapilavastu the going forth and full ordination by a formal act of motion and three proclamations." "Venerable One, as you command," said those monks, heeding the Blessed One.

King Śuddhodana sent the Śākyas' barber, who was called Upāli, to cut their hair as they went forth. When he was cutting the hair of Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, he cut it with his eyes darkened, his tears falling, his voice choking, and his breath heaving with sighs. Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, said, "Upāli, why are you like this?" In a pitiful, faint voice, slowly, word by word, he said, "My lord, just think: I, who have served the foremost men of Jambudvīpa, shall now have to serve common people! Abandoned by you, I would rather die than live."

Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, said, "Upāli, you have already shown heartfelt devotion in pleasing your master. Enough; do not grieve. I will see to it that you will not have to serve common people." Having said this, he spread a cloth out to one side and said to the Śākya youths, "Listen, wise young men! This barber Upāli has shown us honor, and we will not dwell in the household again, so place your ornaments on the cloth to provide for his livelihood." And upon the cloth they heaped up a great pile of their splendid ornaments, adorned with every kind of jewel: chains, necklaces, collars, bracelets, armlets, earrings and the rest.

Upāli cut their hair one after another, and when they had gone to bathe, he thought, "Well now, if these young men, endowed with noble birth and wealth, in the prime of youth, possessed of wives and rich in treasuries and storehouses, abandon all this and go forth, then it is not fitting for me to cling to these mere ornaments; it would only bring me suffering."

"If only I had not been born into a low caste, I too would go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and would strive in seeking and in effort in order to cross over the floods and pass completely beyond the yokes."

Now it is the nature of things that, just as the buddhas, the blessed ones, survey the world with the buddha eye three times by day and three times by night, so too do the great śrāvakas. Thus the venerable Śāriputra saw that the barber Upāli had become deeply disheartened. Having seen this, he went to where the barber Upāli was, and when he arrived, he said this to the barber

Upāli: "Upāli, why are you sitting so very unhappily, with your cheek resting in your hand, sunk in brooding?"

Upāli said, "Venerable Śāriputra, it is because now these young men, endowed with noble birth and wealth, in the prime of youth, possessed of wives and rich in treasuries and storehouses, abandon all this and go forth; so it is not fitting for me to cling to these mere ornaments, and it would only bring me suffering. If only I had not been born into a low caste, I too would go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya, and would strive in seeking and in effort in order to cross over the floods and pass completely beyond the yokes. How could I not be sunk in brooding?"

The venerable Śāriputra said, "Good friend, in this teaching of the Lord of Sages, caste is not what counts as essential, lineage is not what counts as essential, ancestry is not what counts as essential, and learning is not what counts as essential. Rather, in this teaching of the Lord of Sages, it is practice that counts as essential.

The tathāgatas do not consider
Caste, or ancestry, or lineage;
It is deeds that were done
Long ago that they consider.

If you wish to go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya and to attain full ordination and the state of a monk, come, let us go before the Blessed One, and the Blessed One will give you the going forth." He agreed.

Then the venerable Śāriputra took the barber Upāli with him and went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable One, this Upāli wishes to go forth in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya and to attain full ordination and the state of a monk. Out of your loving kindness, please take him in, and may the Blessed One give him the going forth and full ordination."

The Blessed One said to him, "Come, monk! Practice the pure life!" The very moment the Blessed One spoke these words, his head was shaven and he was wearing the monk's robe; his hands held an alms bowl and a water pot with a spout; his hair and beard were like those grown for just seven days; and he stood with the deportment of a monk fully ordained for a hundred years. It is said:

When the Tathāgata declared, "Come!"
His head was shaven, his body clad in the monk's robe,
At once his senses came to rest in perfect peace,
And by the Buddha's intention his bodily form was clothed.

The Śākyas who had gone forth paid homage in order of seniority. When Bhadrika, king of the Śākyas, was bowing down, he recognized that these were Upāli's feet. Then he raised his face and said, "Blessed One, this is Upāli. Must I bow at his feet too?"

The Blessed One said, "Son, you have gone forth in order to abandon pride. He is your senior, so enough of the arrogance of pride: bow down!"

When he touched his head to Upāli's feet, the great earth quaked in six ways. This great earth shook, shook strongly, and shook strongly all over; it rocked, rocked strongly, and rocked strongly all over. When the east rose, the west sank; when the west rose, the east sank; when the south rose, the north sank; when the north rose, the south sank; when the center rose, the edges sank; and when the edges rose, the center sank. In this way all of them, one after another, touched their heads to his feet.

When Devadatta did not bow down, the Blessed One said, "Son, you have gone forth in order to abandon pride, so bow down!"

He replied, "If I do not touch my head to his feet, what harm is it to you?" He would not bow down, and there, for the first time, Devadatta defied the command of the Blessed One.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, was staying in the land of Kapilavastu, in the Nyagrodha Park. At that time a great many Śākyas living in Kapilavastu assembled and gathered in the council hall, and this sort of conversation arose among them: "Friends, from whom were the Śākyas born? What was their beginning? What was their origin? What was the ancient lineage of the Śākyas? If someone were to come to us and ask, 'Friends, from whom were the Śākyas born? What was their beginning? What was their origin? What was the ancient lineage of the Śākyas?', and we did not know from whom the Śākyas were born, what their beginning was, what their origin was, or what the ancient lineage of the Śākyas was, what answer could we give? Come, let us go to where the Blessed One is, and when we arrive, let us ask the Blessed One about this very matter, and keep it in mind just as the Blessed One explains it to us."

Then a great many Śākyas living in Kapilavastu went to where the Blessed One was. When they arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the Śākyas of Kapilavastu said this:

"Venerable One, here a great many of us Śākyas of Kapilavastu assembled and gathered in the council hall, and this sort of conversation arose among us: 'From whom were the Śākyas born? What was their beginning? What was their origin? What was the ancient lineage of the Śākyas? If someone were to come to us and ask, "Friends, from whom were the Śākyas born? What was their beginning? What was their origin? What was the ancient lineage of the Śākyas?", and we did not know from whom the Śākyas were born, what their beginning was, what their origin was, or what the ancient lineage of the Śākyas was, what answer could we give? Come, let us go to where the Blessed One is, and when we arrive, let us ask the Blessed One about this very matter, and keep it in mind just as the Blessed One explains it to us.' For that reason we ask the Blessed One about this very matter. Blessed One, from whom were the Śākyas born? What was their beginning? What was their origin? What was the ancient lineage of the Śākyas?"

Then the Blessed One thought, "If I give a Dharma talk on the ancient lineage of the Śākyas, there is the possibility that non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and other wandering ascetics will say, 'The monk Gautama declares whatever he likes and so praises himself.' Which of my śrāvakas is able to give a Dharma talk on the ancient lineage of the Śākyas?"

At that time the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana was present, seated in that very assembly. Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Maudgalyāyana, my back is aching, so for now, you take this up. Be inspired to give the monks a Dharma talk on the ancient lineage of the Śākyas." The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana consented to the Blessed One by remaining silent.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had consented by remaining silent, folded his monk's robe, placed it as a pillow, and lay down on his right side, with one foot placed upon the other, attending only to the perception of light and to the perception endowed with mindfulness and vigilance, and so he slept.

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana thought, "Now then, I shall enter into a samādhi such that, when my mind is settled in it, I will see from whom the

Śākyas were born, what their beginning was, what their origin was, and what the ancient lineage of the Śākyas was." Having thought this, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana entered into a samādhi such that, when his mind was settled in it, he would see the ancient lineage of the Śākyas. And the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana saw the ancient lineage of the Śākyas: from whom the Śākyas were born, what their beginning was, what their origin was, and what the ancient lineage of the Śākyas was. Having seen it, he arose from that samādhi and sat down on the seat prepared in the midst of the monastic Saṅgha. Seated there, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said to the Śākyas of Kapilavastu:

"Gautamas, when this world is destroyed, and after the world has perished, most beings are reborn among the gods of Clear Light. There they have mind-made forms, perfect, with unimpaired faculties and nothing lacking, possessed of all their limbs, major and minor. They abide with a fine complexion, are self-luminous, and move through the sky. They feed on joy, and on the food of joy they live long and remain for a long time.

"At that time this great earth becomes nothing but water, a single ocean. On this great earth that has become a single ocean of nothing but water, the wind causes a skin to form, to harden, and to spread over it. Just as, when boiled milk cools, the wind causes a skin to form on it, to harden, and to spread over it, so the wind causes a skin to form, to harden, and to spread over this great earth that has become a single ocean of nothing but water. That essence of the earth is perfect in color, perfect in fragrance and perfect in taste. Its color is like this: like fresh butter. Its taste is like this: like pressed honey from bees. Such was that time.

"Gautamas, when this world forms again, and the world has come into being, then certain beings, through the exhaustion of their lifespan, the exhaustion of their karma and the exhaustion of their merit, die and pass from among the gods of Clear Light, and come here, sharing the same lot as humans. Here they have mind-made forms, perfect, with unimpaired faculties and nothing lacking, possessed of all their limbs, major and minor. They abide with a fine complexion, are self-luminous, and move through the sky. They feed on joy, and on the food of joy they live long and remain for a long time.

"At that time neither sun nor moon appears in the world; there are no constellations; there are no instants, moments or hours; there is neither night nor day; and months, fortnights, seasons and years do not appear in the world

either. Nor is there any distinction of male and female; rather, they are counted simply as beings, as 'beings.'

"Then a certain being of greedy nature tastes the essence of the earth with the tip of a finger. The more it tastes, the more it craves; and the more it craves, the more it eats it, mouthful by mouthful. Other beings, too, see that being tasting the essence of the earth with the tip of a finger, craving it the more it tastes, and eating it mouthful by mouthful the more it craves. Seeing this, they too begin to taste the essence of the earth with the tips of their fingers. The more they taste, the more they crave; and the more they crave, the more they eat it, mouthful by mouthful."

"When those beings ate the essence of the earth mouthful by mouthful, coarseness and heaviness entered their bodies. The radiance of their fine complexions faded, and so darkness arose in the world. Gautamas, it is the nature of things that when darkness arises in the world, the sun and moon appear in the world. Constellations, instants, moments, hours, nights and days, months and fortnights, seasons and years appear in the world.

"They ate it, and by taking it as food they lived long and remained for a long time. Among them, whoever ate very little of the food kept a good complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion. Because of the two measures of food, two kinds of complexion appeared; and because there were two kinds of complexion, being looked down on being, saying, 'Hey, being, I have a good complexion; you have a poor complexion.' Because those who were proud of their complexions took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the essence of the earth vanished.

"Gautamas, when the essence of the earth vanished, those beings assembled and gathered and said, 'Alas, the taste! Alas, the taste!' They lamented, and grieved, and suffered. Just as people nowadays, after eating a little tasty food, recall those very letters, words and syllables of old and say, 'Alas, the taste! Alas, the taste!', so those beings, when the essence of the earth vanished, assembled and gathered and said, 'Alas, the taste! Alas, the taste!' They lamented, grieved and suffered, yet they did not know its meaning, that is, 'This is the meaning of what is said; this is the meaning of what is said.'

"Gautamas, when the essence of the earth had vanished for those beings, the fat of the earth appeared, perfect in color and perfect in taste. Its color was like this: like the karṇikāra flower. Its taste was like this: like pressed honey from bees. They ate it, and by taking it as food they lived long and remained

for a long time. Among them, whoever ate very little of the food kept a good complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion. Because of the two measures of food, two kinds of complexion appeared; and because there were two kinds of complexion, being looked down on being, saying, 'Hey, being, I have a good complexion, and you have a poor complexion.' Because those who were proud of their complexions took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the fat of the earth vanished.

"Gautamas, when the fat of the earth vanished, those beings assembled and gathered and said, 'Alas, the taste! Alas, the taste!' They lamented, and grieved in their suffering. Just as people nowadays, when touched by nothing but suffering and unhappiness, recall those very letters, words and syllables of old and say, 'Ah, alas! Ah, alas!', so those beings, when the fat of the earth vanished, assembled and gathered and said, 'Alas, the taste! Alas, the taste!' They lamented, grieved and suffered, yet they did not know 'This is the meaning of what is said; this is the meaning of what is said.'

"Gautamas, when the fat had vanished for those beings, a grove of shoots appeared, perfect in color, perfect in fragrance and perfect in taste. Its color was like this: like the flower of the kadamba tree. Its taste was like this: like pressed honey from bees. They ate it, and by taking it as food they lived long and remained for a long time. Among them, whoever ate very little of the food kept a good complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion. Because of the two measures of food, two kinds of complexion appeared; and because there were two kinds of complexion, being looked down on being, saying, 'Hey, being, I have a good complexion, and you have a poor complexion.' Because those who were proud of their complexions took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the grove of shoots vanished.

"Gautamas, when the grove of shoots vanished, those beings assembled and gathered and said, 'Get away from before me! Get away from before me!' They lamented, grieved and suffered. Just as people nowadays, when they wish to punish someone with a harsh punishment, repeat those very letters, words and syllables of old and say, 'Get away from before me! Get away from before me!', so those beings, when the grove of shoots vanished, assembled and gathered and said, 'Get away from before me! Get away from before me!' They lamented, grieved and suffered, yet they did not know its meaning, that is, 'This is the meaning of what is said; this is the meaning of what is said.'

"Gautamas, after the grove of shoots had vanished for those beings, unplowed and unsown sāli rice grew, its grains four finger-breadths long, without husk, without chaff, without bran, clean and pure. If it was reaped in the evening, it grew and ripened again by morning; if it was reaped in the morning, it grew and ripened again by evening. Since it grew back however much it was reaped, no sign of reaping could be seen. They ate it, and by taking it as food they lived long and remained for a long time.

"From the time those beings ate the unplowed and unsown sāli rice mouthful by mouthful, distinct sexual organs appeared in them: some had the male organ, and some had the female organ. Then those with the female organ and those with the male organ gazed at one another, eye to eye. The more they gazed at one another eye to eye, the more they became infatuated; and the more they became infatuated, the more they clung to one another."

"And the more they clung to one another, the more they engaged in misconduct. Other beings saw beings engaging in misconduct with beings. Having seen this, they pelted them with earth, clods, gravel and potsherds, saying, 'Wretched, base beings are doing what should not be done! Wretched, base beings are doing what should not be done! Hey, being, how could you now defile a being?' Just as people nowadays, when a bride is taken, shower her with powders, perfumes, garlands, cloth and parched rice, saying, 'May the bride be happy!', so, when beings saw beings engaging in misconduct, they pelted them with earth and pelted them with clods, gravel and potsherds too, saying, 'Wretched, base beings are doing what should not be done! Wretched, base beings are doing what should not be done! Hey, being, how could you now defile a being?' Such was that time.

"Gautamas, thus what was formerly considered contrary to Dharma and what was formerly considered contrary to discipline is now considered Dharma and considered discipline; what was formerly considered blameworthy is now considered praiseworthy. They shunned those beings for a single day, and then shunned them for two days, for three, and for seven. Then those beings, who, in that wicked and ignoble practice, followed an exceedingly wicked way of conduct, set about building houses, saying, 'Here we may do what should not be done; here we may do what should not be done.' And so the word 'house' came to be known. Gautamas, this was the first undertaking from which the works of house-building arose in the world. This came about in accordance with what is right, not with what is wrong; for in the Dharma of the Lord of Victors this is what is foremost.

"Those who wished to eat in the evening went for sāli rice in the evening, and those who wished to eat in the morning went for it in the morning. Then a certain being of lazy nature took the morning's sāli rice in the evening. Then another being said to that being, 'Hey, being, come, let us go for sāli rice.' That being replied to the other, 'Hey, being, look to your own sāli rice. I took the morning's sāli rice in the evening.' Then that being thought, 'Ah, that is good! Ah, that is very good! Well then, I shall take sāli rice for two days, for three days, and for up to seven days.' And he took sāli rice for two days, for three days, and for up to seven days.

"Then a certain being said to that being, 'Hey, being, come, let us go for sāli rice.' That being replied, 'Hey, being, look to your own sāli rice. I have already taken sāli rice for two days, for three, and for up to seven days.' Then that being thought, 'Ah, that is good! Ah, that is very good! Well then, I shall take sāli rice for a fortnight and for a month.' And he took sāli rice for a fortnight and for a month.

"From the time those beings ate the unplowed and unsown sāli rice by storing up the grain for their use, the grains of that sāli rice became covered with husk, chaff and bran. What was reaped did not grow back, so the reaping could be seen, and the sāli rice came to be enclosed in husks or in stalk sheaths.

"Then those beings assembled and gathered and said, 'Friends, formerly we had mind-made forms, perfect, with unimpaired faculties and nothing lacking, possessed of all our limbs, major and minor. We abode with a fine complexion, were self-luminous, and moved through the sky. We fed on joy, and on the food of joy we lived long and remained for a long time. Then the essence of the earth appeared for us, perfect in color, perfect in fragrance and perfect in taste. We ate the essence of the earth mouthful by mouthful, and when we ate the essence of the earth mouthful by mouthful, roughness and heaviness entered our bodies. The radiance of our fine complexions faded, and so darkness arose in the world. We ate it, and by taking it as food we lived long and remained for a long time. Among us, whoever ate very little of the food kept a fine complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion. Because of the two measures of food, two kinds of complexion appeared; and because there were two kinds of complexion, being looked down on being, saying, "Hey, being, I have a good complexion, and you have a poor complexion." Because we who were proud of our complexions

took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the essence of the earth vanished.

"'When the essence of the earth vanished, the fat appeared, perfect in color, perfect in fragrance and perfect in taste. We ate it, and by taking it as food we lived long and remained for a long time. Among us, whoever ate very little of the food kept a good complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion. Because of the two measures of food, two kinds of complexion appeared; and because there were two kinds of complexion, being looked down on being, saying, "Hey, being, I have a good complexion, and you have a poor complexion." Because we who were proud of our complexions took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the fat of the earth vanished.

"'When the fat of the earth vanished, the grove of shoots appeared, perfect in color, perfect in fragrance and perfect in taste. We ate it, and by taking it as food we lived long and remained for a long time. Among us, whoever ate very little of the food kept a good complexion, and whoever ate a great deal of the food took on a poor complexion, and two kinds of complexion appeared.

"'Because there were two kinds of complexion, being treated being with contempt, saying, "Hey, being, I have a good complexion, and you have a poor complexion." Because we who were proud of our complexions took up those very evil, nonvirtuous things, the grove of shoots vanished.

"'When the grove of shoots vanished, there grew sāli rice, unplowed and unsown, with grains four finger-widths long, without husk, without chaff, without bran, pure and clean. What was reaped in the evening grew again and ripened by morning; what was reaped in the morning grew again and ripened by evening. Because it grew back again however often it was reaped, no sign of reaping could be seen. We ate it, and by taking it as food we lived long and remained for a long time.

"'From the time we began to store up the unplowed and unsown sāli rice grain and to consume it, the grain of that sāli became covered with husk, chaff and bran. However often it was reaped, it did not grow back, so the reaping could be seen, and the sāli came to stand in clumps, in sheaths on its stalks. So we said, "Come, let us gather and assemble, measure out the fields, mark their limits, and set up boundary markers, saying, 'This is yours, and this is mine.'" They gathered and assembled, divided the fields, and set up boundary markers at their limits.

"'Gautamas, this was the first beginning in the world of the work of setting up boundary markers. That too came about through Dharma, not through what is

contrary to Dharma; therefore, in the Dharma of the Lord of Victors, this is the supreme Dharma.

"'Then one being, though he had sāli of his own, took another's sāli that had not been given. Other beings saw that this being, though he had sāli of his own, had taken another's sāli that had not been given. When they saw it, they said to that being, "Hey, being, why do you take another's sāli that has not been given when you have sāli of your own?" They dragged him this way and that, and at length led him into the midst of the assembled people, and reviled him, saying, "Friends, three times now this being, though he has sāli of his own, has taken another's sāli that was not given."

"'Then those beings said to that being, "Hey, being, why do you take another's sāli that has not been given when you have sāli of your own? Hey, being, go, and from now on do not do that."

"'Then that being said to those beings, "Friends, over sāli this being dragged me this way and that, at length even brought me out into the midst of the assembly, and reviled me." Then those beings said to that being, "Hey, being, why did you drag a being this way and that over sāli, at length even bring him out into the midst of the assembly, and revile him? Hey, being, go, and from now on do not do that."

"'Then those beings thought, "Friends, we see people dragged this way and that over sāli, and at length reviled in the midst of the assembly. Come, let us gather and assemble, and appoint as lord of our fields whichever being among us is most handsome in form, most pleasing to behold, most beautiful, and most renowned for great merit. He will punish those of us who are to be punished and will benefit those who are to be benefited, and from whatever grows in our fields we will give him a share of the harvest in accordance with Dharma." So they gathered and assembled, and appointed as lord of the fields whichever of them was most handsome in form, most pleasing to behold, most beautiful, and most renowned for great merit, saying, "Hey, being, come here. Punish those among us who are to be punished, and benefit those who are to be benefited. From whatever grows in our fields we will give you a share of the harvest in accordance with Dharma."

"'He punished those among them who were to be punished and benefited those who were to be benefited, and they offered him a share of the harvest from whatever grew in their fields, in accordance with Dharma. Because he was honored by a great multitude of people, honored by a great multitude of

people, he became known as Mahāsammata, the one honored by many. Because, having become lord of those fields, he protected them from harm, he became known as a kṣatriya, a kṣatriya. Because he delighted the people with Dharma, and lived practicing moral discipline and practicing wisdom, he became known as a king, a king.

"'Gautamas, in the time of King Mahāsammata, people were called "beings, beings." Gautamas, the son of King Mahāsammata was called Roca. Gautamas, in the time of King Roca, people were called "come here, come here." The son of Roca was called Kalyāṇa. Gautamas, in the time of King Kalyāṇa, people were called "the marked ones, the marked ones." Gautamas, the son of Kalyāṇa was called Varakalyāṇa. Gautamas, in the time of King Varakalyāṇa, people were called "cloud-throats, cloud-throats." The son of Varakalyāṇa was called Upoṣadha. Gautamas, in the time of King Upoṣadha, people were called "palm-trunks, palm-trunks."

"'On the crown of King Upoṣadha's head there grew a swelling, smooth and exceedingly soft, like a tuft of tree cotton or a tuft of cotton wool, which caused him not the slightest pain. When it ripened and burst open, there appeared a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Because he was born from the crown of the head, he was called Mūrdhaja, Born from the Crown.

"'As soon as the prince was born, he was carried among King Upoṣadha's sixty thousand queens, and milk flowed from the breasts of them all. Each one said, "Suck from me, suck from me," and so he became known as Māndhātṛ, Suck-from-Me.

"'Gautamas, at the time when King Māndhātṛ was reigning, people would think, weigh things up, and examine them closely. Having thought, weighed and closely examined, they took up the various crafts and the various occupations, and for that reason they became known as "mind-born (mānavas), mind-born."

"'Gautamas, these six kings had an immeasurable span of life, a lifespan beyond reckoning.

"'Gautamas, on King Māndhātṛ's right thigh there grew a swelling, smooth and exceedingly soft, like a tuft of tree cotton or a tuft of cotton wool, which caused him not the slightest pain. When it ripened and burst open, there appeared a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Because he was born from the

right thigh, he was named Cāru, Cāru. Because that prince had great miraculous power and great might, he too came to wield sovereign lordship over the four continents.

"'Gautamas, on King Cāru's left thigh there grew a swelling, smooth and exceedingly soft, like a tuft of tree cotton or a tuft of cotton wool, which caused him not the slightest pain. When it ripened and burst open, there appeared a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Because he was born from the left thigh, he was named Upacāru, Upacāru. Because that prince had great miraculous power and great might, he too came to wield sovereign lordship over three continents.

"'Gautamas, on King Upacāru's right foot there grew a swelling, smooth and exceedingly soft, like a tuft of tree cotton or a tuft of cotton wool, which caused him not the slightest pain. When it ripened and burst open, there appeared a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Because he was born from the right foot, he was named Cārumat, Cārumat. Because that prince had great miraculous power and great might, he too came to wield sovereign lordship over two continents.

"'Gautamas, on King Cārumat's left foot there grew a swelling, smooth and exceedingly soft, like a tuft of tree cotton or a tuft of cotton wool, which caused him not the slightest pain. When it ripened and burst open, there appeared a boy, handsome, pleasing to behold, beautiful, fully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being. Because he was born from the left foot, he was named Upacārumat, Upacārumat. Because that prince had great miraculous power and great might, he too came to wield sovereign lordship over one continent.

"'Gautamas, thus the son of King Mahāsammata was Roca. The son of Roca was Kalyāṇa. The son of Kalyāṇa was Varakalyāṇa. The son of Varakalyāṇa was Upoṣadha. The son of Upoṣadha was Māndhātṛ. Māndhātṛ's son was Cāru. Cāru's son was Upacāru. Upacāru's sons were Cārumat, Upacārumat, Bhadra, Subhadra, Relinquisher, Relinquisher-Holder, Aṅga, Aṅga-Chariot, Evil-Shunner, Bhāgīrathī, Sāgara, Son of Sāgara, Mahāsāgara, Śakuni, Mahāśakuni, Kuśa, Upakuśa, Mahākuśa, Sudarśana, Mahāsudarśana, Well-Attained, Great Well-Attained, Praṇāda, Mahāpraṇāda, Light-Maker, Hero, Possessed of Meru, Having Meru, Ray, Rayed, Having Rays, and All-Around

Ray.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of All-Around Ray, a full hundred kings arose in the land of Potala. The last of them was a king called Arindama; because he tamed his enemies, he was called Arindama, Arindama, the Tamer of Foes.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Arindama, fifty-four thousand kings arose in the land of Ayodhyā. The last of them was a king called Victor over the Unvanquished; because he was victorious over those who had never been vanquished, he became known as Victor over the Unvanquished, Victor over the Unvanquished.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Victor over the Unvanquished, thirty-six thousand kings arose in the land of Vārāṇasī. The last of them was a king called Hard to Bear.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Hard to Bear, eighty-four thousand kings arose in the city of Kāmpilya. The last of them was a king called Brahmadatta.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Brahmadatta, thirty-two thousand kings arose in the city of Hastināpura. The last of them was a king called Elephant-Given.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Elephant-Given, five thousand kings arose in the land of Takṣaśilā. The last of them was a king called Woolen-Robed.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Woolen-Robed, thirty-two thousand kings arose in the city of Lying-on-the-Breast. The last of them was a king called Tamer of Great Elephants.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Tamer of Great Elephants, thirty-two thousand kings arose in the city of Victor over the Unvanquished. The last of them was a king called Jayadatta.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Jayadatta, thirty-two thousand kings arose in the city of Kanyakubja. The last of them was a king called Jayasena.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Jayasena, eighteen thousand kings arose in the city of Campā. The last of them was a king called Nāgadeva.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Nāgadeva, twenty-five thousand kings arose in the city of Palm Garland. The last of them was a king called Naradeva.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Naradeva, twelve thousand kings arose in the city of Tamala. The last of them was a king called Sāgaradeva.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Sāgaradeva, eighteen thousand kings arose in the city of Dantapura. The last of them was a king called Sumati.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Sumati, twenty-five thousand kings arose in the city of Rājagṛha. The last of them was a king called Dispeller of Darkness.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Dispeller of Darkness, a full hundred kings arose, again in the city of Vārāṇasī. The last of them was a king called Maheśvarasena.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Maheśvarasena, eighty-four thousand kings arose in the city of Kuśāvatī. The last of them was a king called Sāgarasena.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Sāgarasena, a thousand kings arose, again in the city of Potala. The last of them was a king called Practitioner of Austerities.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Practitioner of Austerities, eighty-four thousand kings arose, again in the city of Kuśāvatī. The last of them was a king called Face of the Earth.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Face of the Earth, a hundred thousand kings arose, again in the city of Vārāṇasī. The last of them was a king called Lord of the Earth.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Lord of the Earth, a hundred thousand kings arose, again in the city of Ayodhyā. The last of them was one called Held by Kings.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of Held by Kings, eighty-four thousand kings arose in the city of Mithilā. The last of them was a king called Mahādeva.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Mahādeva, eighty-four thousand kings, again in the city of Mithilā, practiced the pure conduct of the sages (ṛṣis). The last of them was a king called Nemi.

"'After Nemi came Middling, Dṛḍhanemi, Digger, Near Digger, Possessed of Digging, All-Around Digger, Splendid Appearance, Śrutasena, Dharmasena, Realization, Great Realization, Army of Realization, Aśoka, Vigataśoka, Steadfast Army, Jarāsandha, Fool-Slayer, Dawn, Diśāṃpati, Reṇu, Śaṅkara, Ānanda, Ādarśamukha, Generator, All-Around Generator, Bull among Men, Provider of Food and Drink, Provider of Abundant Food and Drink, Ajita, Aparājita, Abiding, Well-Abiding, Mahābala, Rider of Great Strength, Good Intellect, Steady Rider, Daśadhanu, Śatadhanu, Navatidhanu, Victorious Bow, Citradhanu, Dṛḍhadhanu, Daśaratha, Śataratha, Navatiratha, Citraratha, Victorious Chariot, and Dṛḍharatha.

"'Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Dṛḍharatha, seventy-seven thousand kings arose in the city of All-Illuminating. The last of them was a king called Kṛkin.

"'At that time there appeared in the world the Teacher, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Kāśyapa. In his presence the Blessed One, as a bodhisattva, made the aspiration to attain awakening in the future and practiced pure conduct, and was born in the company of the Tuṣita gods.

"'Gautamas, the son of King Kṛkin was Sujāta. Gautamas, in the line of the sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons of King Sujāta, a full hundred kings arose, again in the city of Potala. The last of them was a king called Karṇa.

"'Gautamas, King Karṇa had two sons, Gautama and Bharadvāja. Of the two, Gautama delighted in renunciation, and Bharadvāja delighted in kingship. Gautama saw his father ruling the kingdom both in accordance with Dharma and contrary to Dharma, and he thought, "When my father has passed away I will become king, and I too will rule both in accordance with Dharma and contrary to Dharma, and so I will be bound for the hells as a being. If one asks what the time calls for here, I should go forth from home into homelessness." With this thought he went to where King Karṇa was, and when he arrived he touched his head to his feet and made this request: "Father, please know this: out of faith I am going forth from home into homelessness."

"'His father said, "Son, the reason I perform sacrifices, make fire offerings and practice austerities is precisely this: when I have passed away, the kingdom will come into the palm of your hand and you will reign as king. So why would you go forth?"

"'He replied, "Father, I cannot bear to rule the kingdom both in accordance with Dharma and contrary to Dharma. So please know this: I am going forth."

"'Then the king, realizing that he could not be dissuaded, gave his permission.

"'At that time a sage (ṛṣi) called Kṛṣṇavarṇa was living in a hermitage. Prince Gautama, having been given leave by the king, was glad and delighted, and vast joy and happiness arose in him. He went to where the sage Kṛṣṇavarṇa was, and when he arrived he bowed at his feet with gentle demeanor and said, "Great sage, I wish to go forth. Please let me go forth." And Kṛṣṇavarṇa let him go forth. The sage Kṛṣṇavarṇa lived on fruits and roots and drank water, and so did Gautama, and he became known as the sage Gautama, the sage Gautama.

"'Some time later King Karṇa died, and Prince Bharadvāja came to wield sovereign lordship over his father's kingdom.

"'Some time later the sage Gautama said to his preceptor, "Preceptor, I cannot sustain myself with food in this place in the wilderness, so I shall live on the outskirts of a town."

"'His preceptor said, "Son, very well. Whether a sage lives in a town or in the wilderness, in short what matters is guarding the senses. Go, build a hut of leaves near Potala, and stay there."

"'Saying, "Preceptor, I will do as you say," the sage Gautama built a hut of leaves near Potala and stayed there.

"'At that time there lived in the city of Potala a courtesan called Bhadrā and a rogue called Mṛṇāla. He sent her clothes and ornaments so that they might enjoy themselves together. She had put on the clothes and ornaments and was setting out, when another man arrived carrying five hundred kārṣāpaṇas and said, "Bhadrā, come here and enjoy yourself with me." She thought, "If I go, I will not get the five hundred kārṣāpaṇas, and to turn away someone who has come to my house and go elsewhere would not be good." So she said to her maidservant, "Go to Mṛṇāla and tell him from your lady: 'For the moment I have no opportunity; I will come later.'" The girl went to him and told him.

"'That other man had a great deal of business to see to, so after enjoying himself with her he left in the very first watch of the night. She thought, "There is still a long time until dawn, so I can still keep his good will." So she again instructed the girl: "Go to Mṛṇāla and say from your lady: 'I have made myself ready; to which pleasure grove shall I come?'" The girl went to him and said this, and he said, "A moment ago your lady had no opportunity, and a moment later she has an opportunity?"

"'The girl was not on good terms with her mistress, and she said, "Son of my lord, it is not that she had no opportunity. Wearing your clothes and ornaments, she was enjoying herself with another man."

"'The attachment that had bound him fell away, and in its place the bond of malice arose. Seized by rage, he said, "Girl, go and tell Bhadrā that Mṛṇāla says, 'Come to such-and-such a pleasure grove.'" She went and told Bhadrā, and Bhadrā then went to the pleasure grove. The rogue Mṛṇāla said, "Is it right for you to enjoy yourself with another man wearing my clothes and ornaments?"

"'She said, "Son of my lord, I did wrong in that. But women are always full of faults, so please forgive me."

"'Then, seized by rage, he drew his sword from its sheath and killed her. The maidservant raised a great outcry: "My lady has been killed! My lady has been killed!" A great crowd of people heard it and came running. Now it so happened that the sage Gautama was staying in that very place. The rogue Mṛṇāla, terrified, threw the bloodstained sword down in front of the sage Gautama and slipped in among that very crowd of people.

"'When that great crowd of people saw the bloodstained sword, they said, "This renunciant has killed Bhadrā!" Then they surrounded the sage Gautama and, seized with rage, said, "Hey, renunciant, while bearing the banner of a

sage, do you do a deed like this?"

"'He said, "What have I done?"

"'They said, "You enjoyed yourself with Bhadrā and then killed her."

"'He said, "Because my evil has been stilled, I do not do such deeds." But although he spoke calmly, that crowd of people bound his arms tightly behind his back and handed him over to the king, saying, "Your Majesty, this renunciant enjoyed himself with Bhadrā and then killed her."

"'Since kings do not examine things, he said, "If that is what happened, I give up this renunciant. Impale him on a stake."

"'They hung a garland of karavīra flowers around that renunciant's neck, and surrounded by men wearing blue garments and bearing weapons in their hands, he was proclaimed by public announcement along the highways, in the marketplaces, at the crossroads and at the junctions of three roads. He was led out through the southern gate of the city and impaled on a stake while still alive.

"'His preceptor Kṛṣṇavarṇa used to visit his hermitage from time to time. Some while later he went there and did not find him, and he began to search for him here and there. At length he saw him impaled on the stake, and in a faltering voice, his eyes filled with tears, he said slowly, in words of compassion, "Alas, son, what is this?"

"'He too, in a faltering voice, despairing, tormented by the harmful feelings that had arisen in his vital points, said, "Preceptor, what else could it be? It is karma."

"'His preceptor said, "Son, have you not done some wound or some harm?"

"'"Preceptor, my body has been wounded, but not my mind."

"'"Son, how can that be known?"

"'"Preceptor, I shall make a declaration of truth. Listen. By the truth and by the words of truth that my body has been wounded but not my mind, by that truth and those words of truth, may the dark color of my preceptor's skin turn to the color of gold!"

"'Because that great being had cultivated superior resolve, as soon as he had spoken these words the dark skin of the sage Kṛṣṇavarṇa disappeared and turned the color of gold. The news spread everywhere: "The sage Kṛṣṇavarṇa has turned the color of gold!" And so he came to be named Golden-Hued. It

was most wonderful.

"'Then the sage Gautama said, "Preceptor, when I die and pass from here, where will I go? Where will I be born? What will my next life be?"

"'His preceptor said, "Son, the brahmins say that for one without a son there is no good destiny. Have you produced any son at all?"

"'"Preceptor, when my father urged me toward kingship, I went forth while still a youth, and I have not even known the touch of a woman. How then could I have had a son born to me?"

"'"Son, if that is so, call to mind the sensual pleasures you enjoyed in the past."

"'"Preceptor, I am racked by fierce feelings. Now my vital points are severed and my joints are coming apart, and I can think of nothing but dying. How could I call to mind the sensual pleasures I enjoyed in the past?"

"'His preceptor had attained the higher knowledges, so by his miraculous power he conjured up a great storm of wind and rain, and the raindrops struck Gautama's body. Then, as the touch of the rain and the cool wind subdued his suffering, he began to call to mind the sensual pleasures he had enjoyed in the past. When he called to mind the desire of sexual union, two drops of semen fell, together with blood.

"'There are four domains that are inconceivable: thinking about the self, thinking about the world, thinking about the karmic maturation of the actions of beings, and thinking about the domain of the buddhas, the buddha domain.

"'Those two drops of semen turned into two eggs, and at the time of sunrise they were ripened by the rays of the sun and burst open. Two boys came forth, and the two of them went into a thicket of sugarcane not at all far from there. Then the sun's rays grew very hot, and the sage Gautama, tormented by the rays of the sun, died.

"'Then the sage Golden-Hued came and saw that he was dead. When he looked around the stake, he found two broken eggshells lying there. He followed the tracks this way and that into the sugarcane thicket, and there at length he saw two boys. When he set himself to thinking whose sons these two were, he realized that they were the sons of the sage Gautama. Then a special affection arose in him, and he took the two of them to the hermitage and raised them.

"'He gave the two of them names. Because they were born when, at sunrise, they had been ripened by the rays of the sun, they were of the solar lineage, and so they were called "Solar Lineage, Solar Lineage." Because they were the sons of the sage Gautama, their second name was "Gautama, Gautama." Because they were born from his own limbs, their third name was "Āṅgirasa, Āṅgirasa." Because they were found in a sugarcane thicket, their fourth name was "Ikṣvāku, Ikṣvāku."

"'Some time later King Bharadvāja died without a son. The ministers assembled and began to deliberate: "Friends, whom shall we empower as king?"

"'Others said, "His elder brother Gautama went forth among the sages. Since this kingdom has come down in his family line, let us empower him."

"'Having deliberated, they went to the sage Golden-Hued, and when they arrived they touched their heads to his feet and said, "Great sage, where is Gautama?"

"'He said, "You yourselves killed him."

"'They said, "Great sage, we do not even remember having seen him. How could we have killed him?"

"'"I will remind you. Make no mistake." When he had reminded them, they said, "Great sage, if that is so, let that evildoer be; his very name is not to be spoken aloud."

"'"What evil deeds did he do?"

"'"This and this."

"'"That faultless man, who did no harm, did no evil deed, and you killed him."

"'"How is that evident?" He told them in detail how it had happened, and they, growing distressed, said, "Great sage, if that is so, then he did no wrong; it is we who committed an evil deed."

"'As they were saying this, the two boys also came into the sage's presence. The ministers said, "Great sage, whose are these two boys?"

"'He said, "They are that very man's sons."

"'They said, "How were these two born? What are their names?"

"'He told them in detail, together with all that had happened. When the ministers heard it, they were filled with the greatest wonder. They petitioned

the sage, and of the two they consecrated the elder prince with the consecration of kingship. Having been consecrated, he too died without a son. Then they consecrated the other, the younger, and his name became King Ikṣvāku.

"'Gautamas, in the line of King Ikṣvāku's sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons, a hundred King Ikṣvākus arose in the city of Potala, and the last of them was the one called King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka.

"'Gautamas, King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka had four sons: Ulkāmukha, Karakarṇin, Hastinika and Nūpura.

"'At another time his chief queen died, and he sat with his hand to his cheek, brooding. The ministers said, "Your Majesty, why do you sit with your face in your hand, displeased?"

"'He said, "My chief queen has died. Why should I not sit brooding?"

"'"Your Majesty, if that is so, the kings of the world have daughters. Why not seek a chief queen for Your Majesty?"

"'The king said, "These princes long for the kingship, and while there are these rivals, who would give a daughter?"

"'"Let Your Majesty consider it, and we shall search."

"'In time the men discovered that another king had a daughter who was beautiful, handsome and lovely, fit to be a chief queen. They went to that king, and when they had made themselves known to him through one intermediary after another, the king commanded, "Bring them in."

"'Then they went before the king, touched his two feet, made conversation at first, and sat down. Finding an occasion in the conversation and seeing the king's face, they said, "May Your Majesty be fortunate! May you be fortunate!"

"'The king said, "Gentlemen, what is your request?"

"'"The chief queen of King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka has died, and we ask for your daughter for him."

"'The king said, "Since he is the finest of matches, it may be agreed. But let a pledge be made: if my daughter has a son, I will give her provided that he is to be placed in sovereignty over the kingdom."

"'"Your Majesty, it shall be as you command. We shall go and report it to our lord." So they went and told King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka what had happened.

"'The king said, "Gentlemen, to pass over the elder princes, who delight in the kingship, and set a younger one on the throne is not fitting."

"'"Your Majesty, nothing is certain in this matter. For now, take the queen, and with her sport, delight and enjoy yourself. Who knows whether she will bear a son, or a daughter, or have no child at all?"

"'The king said, "Gentlemen, if that is so, fetch her today."

"'They went and received her, and in time she was brought with the great splendor and wealth of royalty. The king became enamored of her, and he sported with her, delighted in her and made love with her. As he sported, delighted and made love, at another time the queen conceived. When eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a boy who was beautiful, handsome and lovely. After his birth they held a great birth celebration, and in naming him they asked, "What name shall be given to this boy?"

"'The ministers said, "Your Majesty, since even before he was born he has thus been one who delights in the kingship, let the boy's name be Delight in Kingship."

"'The prince Delight in Kingship was entrusted to eight nurses, and so on, as before, up to: he grew quickly, like a lotus in a pond.

"'When he was not placed in the kingdom as heir apparent, his maternal uncle, the king, heard of it and sent him a messenger bearing a letter filled with harsh words: "If you do as you formerly promised and pledged, that is well. If you do not, then wait, with whatever might and prowess you have for overcoming foes. I shall come there and lay waste your realm to dust."

"'Because that king was very mighty, when he heard this he was afraid. He gathered his ministers and said, "Gentlemen, that king has sent me this message. How should I deal with it?"

"'They said, "Your Majesty, consecrate Delight in Kingship as heir apparent."

"'He said, "Gentlemen, to pass over the elder princes, who delight in the kingship, and consecrate a younger one with the kingship is not fitting."

"'They said, "Your Majesty, that king has vast forces and mounts. If he comes here, there is the danger that he will certainly lay waste the country. So consecrate Delight in Kingship to wield the sovereignty of heir apparent, and please banish those princes."

"'The king said, "Gentlemen, how can I banish princes who are faultless and have done no harm?"

"'"Your Majesty, we are ministers, intent on what benefits Your Majesty. We would banish even those without fault and without offense; never mind those with faults who have committed offenses."

"'The king remained in equanimity and sat without saying anything.

"'The ministers gathered and began to deliberate among themselves: "Gentlemen, we must devise a means by which the king will become displeased with the princes." So they had the pleasure garden cleaned, set out very fragrant incense in places painted with all kinds of designs, hung up many silk streamers, and had it made delightful with all kinds of flowers.

"'Then those headstrong princes, seeing from far off the ministers cleaning that pleasure garden, went toward the pleasure garden. When the ministers had finished cleaning the pleasure garden and came out to the gate, the princes asked, "Whose pleasure garden is this?"

"'They said, "It is His Majesty's."

"'As the princes started to turn back, the ministers said, "Princes, go inside. Why turn back?"

"'They said, "If it is His Majesty's pleasure garden, how could it be proper to go in here?"

"'The ministers said, "What harm is there, whether for His Majesty or for the princes, in amusing yourselves here?" So they went inside and began to play.

"'The ministers said to the king, "Your Majesty, the pleasure garden has been well cleaned, and the time has come for Your Majesty to view it."

"'The king set out, and in the pleasure garden he heard the sound of an uproar. Hearing it, he said to the ministers, "Gentlemen, since there is the sound of an uproar in the pleasure garden, who is in there?"

"'The ministers said, "Your Majesty, it is the princes."

"'"If that is so, I renounce the princes."

"'The ministers touched his two feet and said, "Your Majesty, please be forbearing, and banish the princes."

"'The king said, "So be it." When it had been decided to banish the princes, they touched the king's two feet and said, "Your Majesty, if that is so, it would

be right for you to command that, if we go together with our people and retinue, we are in no way to be prevented."

"'The king gave the command. When they set out, a great host of people from the palace retinue who were fond of them set out together with them, and for seven days the gates of the city of Potala were opened and the crowds of people streamed out. The ministers said to the king, "Your Majesty, if the city gates are left open, before long Potala will become empty."

"'"If that is so, close the gates."

"'Then those princes, taking their own sisters, made their way by stages to a place on the bank of the river Bhāgīrathī, near the Himalaya mountains, not very far from the hermitage of the sage Kapila. There they made huts of leaves and settled. They lived by killing game, and three times a day they would go to the hermitage of the sage Kapila. Gripped by the arrogance of youth and the prime of life, they were sorely tormented by desire, and they became thin, sickly, pale and gaunt.

"'At length, at another time, the sage Kapila saw them in this state and asked, "Why have you become pale and gaunt?"

"'They said, "Great sage, it is because we are sorely tormented by sensual desire."

"'He said, "Leave aside each your own sister, and live with your half-sisters born of other mothers."

"'"Great sage, is it permissible for us to do such a thing?"

"'"Gentlemen, it is permissible for those of royal caste who have thus lost their kingdom."

"'Then, thinking, "The words of the sage are authoritative," and being tormented by sensual desire, they were filled with joy and delight, and they sported, delighted and made love with their half-sisters born of other mothers. As they sported, delighted and made love with them, sons and daughters were born, and these grew up. Because noise is the thorn of meditative concentration, the sage Kapila could not attain one-pointedness of mind, and he said, "Gentlemen, I have seen enough. I shall go elsewhere."

"'"Great sage, why?"

"'"Because noise is the thorn of meditative concentration, I cannot attain one-pointedness of mind."

"'"Great sage, stay right here. We will go elsewhere. But assign us some piece of ground."

"'"Gentlemen, very well."

"'Because that great-souled sage was one whose wishes were fulfilled just as he desired, he took a golden water jar and traced the outline of a city with a stream of water, and they built the city. Because the sage Kapila gave up the site entirely for their dwelling, it came to be called Kapila's Site, Kapilavastu.

"'They flourished there and became a great multitude, but because it was cramped, they could not grow any further. The gods, knowing their minds with their own minds, showed them another place, and they went there and built another city, which came to be called Shown by the Gods.

"'Then they assembled and gathered together and began to deliberate among themselves: "Gentlemen, the reason we were banished is that we did not take wives from those of equal birth. Therefore none of us should take a wife who is not of equal birth, and we should be content with one alone." From then on they took a wife only from a single family of equal birth, and they did not take co-wives.

"'Then, at another time, King Virūḍhaka remembered his beloved sons and said to the ministers, "Ho, citizens, where are those princes now?"

"'They said, "When Your Majesty banished them for some offense, they took their own sisters and went away from here. Near the Himalaya, on the bank of the river Bhāgīrathī, not very far from the hermitage of the sage Kapila, they settled. Leaving aside each their own sister, they sport, delight and make love with their half-sisters born of other mothers. As they sport, delight and make love, sons and daughters have been born."

"'"Citizens, did the princes dare to do such a thing?"

"'"Your Majesty, they were capable of it."

"'Then King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka straightened his upper body, stretched out his right hand, and uttered this inspired utterance: "Ah, the princes are capable! Ah, the princes are truly capable!" Because a being of great power had spoken these words, "Ah, the princes are capable! Ah, the princes are truly capable!", they came to be called Śākyas, the Śākyas.

"'At another time King Ikṣvāku Virūḍhaka died, and they consecrated Delight in Kingship in the kingship. He too died without a son, and Ulkāmukha was

made to wield the sovereignty of the kingdom. He too died without a son, and Karakarṇin became king. He too died without a son, and Hastinika became king. He too died without a son, and Nūpura became king. His son was Abode Founder. Gautamas, the son of Abode Founder was Earth House.

"'Gautamas, in the line of King Earth House's sons, grandsons, great-grandsons and great-great-grandsons, fifty-five thousand kings arose in the city of Kapilavastu. The last of them were Daśaratha, Śataratha, Navatiratha, Citraratha, Victorious Chariot, Dṛḍharatha, Daśadhanu, Śatadhanu, Navatidhanu, Victorious Bow, Citradhanu and Dṛḍhadhanu.

"'Gautamas, Dṛḍhadhanu had two sons: Siṃhahanu and Siṃhanāda. Gautamas, of all the archers there were in Jambudvīpa, Siṃhahanu was renowned as the foremost.

"'Gautamas, Siṃhahanu had four sons: Śuddhodana, Śuklodana, Droṇodana and Amṛtodana; and daughters: Śuddhā, Śuklā, Droṇā and Amṛtā.

"'Śuddhodana had two sons: the Blessed One and the venerable Nanda. Śuklodana had two sons: the venerable Tiṣya and the Śākya king Bhadrika. Droṇodana had two sons: Mahānāma and the venerable Aniruddha. Amṛtodana had two sons: the venerable Ānanda and Devadatta.

"'The son of Śuddhā was Suprabuddha. The son of Śuklā was Garlanded. The son of Droṇā was Taker of Good. The son of Amṛtā was Increase of Virtue.

"'The son of the Blessed One is Rāhula. Gautamas, the line of Mahāsammata culminates in the venerable Rāhula. The stream of existence is cut off, saṃsāra is exhausted, and now there is no further becoming.'"

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana's discourse was complete, rose and sat up. Having sat up, he said to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Excellent, Maudgalyāyana, excellent! Maudgalyāyana, it was excellent of you to give this Dharma discourse before the monks concerning the ancient lineage of the Śākyas. Maudgalyāyana, again and again you should give this Dharma discourse concerning the ancient lineage of the Śākyas, for it will bring them long-lasting benefit, help and happiness."

Then the Blessed One said to the monks, "Monks, take up this Dharma discourse concerning the ancient lineage of the Śākyas. Retain it. Recite it. Why is that? Monks, the Dharma discourse concerning the ancient lineage of the Śākyas is meaningful, in accord with the Dharma, and so on, up to:

connected with the holy life. Monks, sons of good family who have gone forth out of faith should retain and recite the Dharma discourse concerning the ancient lineage of the Śākyas."

Then the Śākyas of Kapilavastu delighted in what the Blessed One had said and rejoiced in it. They bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

At that time, in the city of Kapilavastu, a king called Siṃhahanu held the kingship. The kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful and blessed with good harvests, and filled with many folk and people. It was free of fighting, strife, quarrels, disputes and robbers, and illnesses had been fully quelled. It was rich in rice, rows of sugarcane, cattle and buffalo, and he ruled the kingdom as one cherishes an only son.

In the city of Shown by the Gods, a king called Suprabuddha held the kingship. The kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful and blessed with good harvests, and filled with many folk and people. It was free of fighting, strife, quarrels, disputes and robbers, and illnesses had been fully quelled. It was rich in rice, rows of sugarcane, cattle and buffalo, and he ruled the kingdom as one cherishes an only son.

King Suprabuddha had a chief queen, beautiful, handsome and lovely, the fairest lady of the land, called Lumbinī.

In Shown by the Gods there lived a householder who was rich, of great wealth and great means, with vast and extensive possessions, possessing the wealth of Vaiśravaṇa, rivaling Vaiśravaṇa in wealth. His park was rich in flowers, rich in fruits and rich in water, and with all kinds of birds calling, that park was delightful. From time to time the king would go there with his retinue of queens and enjoy pleasant amusements there.

When Lumbinī saw it, she conceived a desire for it, and she said, "Your Majesty, please grant me this park."

The king said, "Since this park belongs to the householder, how can I give it to you? If you need a park, I will have another made for you that is finer than this one."

Then King Suprabuddha had a park made for Lumbinī that was far superior to that one, and its name came to be Lumbinī Grove.

For a long time King Siṃhahanu had held this thought: "Ah, how wonderful it would be if a wheel-turning monarch were born in my line!" And for a long time

King Suprabuddha too had held this thought: "Ah, how wonderful it would be if I became related by marriage to Siṃhahanu!"

In time, as he sported, delighted and made love with his queen, at another time the queen conceived. When eight or nine months had passed, she gave birth to a daughter who was beautiful, handsome and lovely, complete in all her limbs and features. At the beauty of the newborn child, King Suprabuddha, together with his retinue of queens, and the crowds of people living in Shown by the Gods were filled with the greatest wonder. They fell into doubt and thought, "Is this a girl, or is it an illusion conjured up by various karmic forces?"

They held a great birth celebration for three weeks, twenty-one days, and in naming her they asked, "What name shall be given to this girl?"

The ministers said, "Among the crowds of people living in Shown by the Gods, talking on the highways, in the marketplaces, at the junctions of three roads and at the crossroads, some say, 'She is simply a girl, who through the ripening of her former karma has become beautiful and perfect in complexion.' Others say, 'She is not a girl. What then? She is an illusion conjured up by various karmic forces.' Therefore let the girl be given the name Māyā, Illusion." And so she was named.

The girl Māyā was entrusted to eight nurses, and so on, as before, up to: she grew up. The soothsayers who read the marks prophesied of her, "She will give birth to one endowed with many excellent marks, who will become a wheel-turning monarch by force."

Again, as he sported, delighted and made love, a daughter was born who was beautiful, handsome and lovely, of fine complexion, endowed with the most perfect development. When she was born, that entire city was lit up with a vast radiance, and just as with Māyā, her beauty could not be fully gauged in every respect. Again they held a great birth celebration, and in naming her they asked, "What name shall be given to this girl?"

The ministers said, "Since she is even more beautiful than Māyā, let her be given the name Mahāmāyā, Great Illusion." And so she was named.

She too was raised and nurtured until she grew up, and the soothsayers who read the marks prophesied of her, "She will give birth to one endowed with the thirty-two marks of a great being, and he will become a wheel-turning king."

King Suprabuddha sent a messenger to King Siṃhahanu: "Two daughters have been born to me, Māyā and Mahāmāyā. Of one it has been prophesied that she

will give birth to a son perfect in all the marks, who will become a wheel-turning king by force. Of the other it has been prophesied that she will give birth to a son adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being, who will become a wheel-turning king. Whichever of these two you wish, take her as a wife for Prince Śuddhodana."

Siṃhahanu sent back word: "The prince would indeed want both. But one should not give two such wives to one man. For now I want the one of whom it was prophesied that she will give birth to a son adorned with the thirty-two marks of a great being, who will become a wheel-turning king. As for the other, I shall have to consult the assembly." So Suprabuddha sent her off with a retinue of five hundred.

At that time there were mountain people called the Pāṇḍavas, enemies of the Śākyas. The Śākyas gathered and went to King Siṃhahanu and said, "Your Majesty, the Pāṇḍava mountain people are doing us harm. Please help us."

He said, "Gentlemen, I am old and cannot do battle with them."

"Your Majesty, please send Prince Śuddhodana."

"Let a pledge be made: I will send him provided that, whatever boon the prince asks, that boon will be granted."

They said, "Your Majesty, as you command; we shall grant it."

The king assigned the fourfold army to Prince Śuddhodana, and he defeated those mountain people, routed them utterly and wiped them out. Then the Śākyas, delighted, went to King Siṃhahanu and said, "Your Majesty, since the prince has defeated the mountain people, routed them utterly and wiped them out, we are overjoyed. Let the prince say what boon he wishes, and we shall grant it."

"Gentlemen, the Śākyas have laid it down as law that no one may take a co-wife, even from those of equal birth."

"Your Majesty, does this mean breaking the law?"

He said, "You should rather keep it all the more strictly, not break it. Yet the one boon the prince asks is to take a co-wife from those of equal birth."

"Your Majesty, it is permissible, so let it be done."

Then Siṃhahanu sent a messenger to Suprabuddha: "I have consulted the assembly, so send the other daughter as well." He sent her too with a retinue of five hundred, and Prince Śuddhodana took them both.

In time, at another time, King Siṃhahanu died, and in Kapilavastu King Śuddhodana took up the kingship. The kingdom was prosperous, flourishing, peaceful and blessed with good harvests, and filled with many folk and people. It was free of fighting, strife, quarrels, disputes and robbers, and illnesses had been fully quelled. It was rich in rice, rows of sugarcane, cattle and buffalo, and he ruled the kingdom as one cherishes an only son.

At another time he went with Queen Mahāmāyā to the upper terrace of the palace, where no men were present, and there, with music, he sported, delighted and made love.

This is the nature of things: when the bodhisattva dwells in the abode of Tuṣita, he surveys the world with five surveys: he surveys the family, he surveys the country, he surveys the time, he surveys the lineage, and he surveys the woman. For the details, connect this with the earlier sūtra.

The Sūtra of the Great Departure is complete.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Ācārya Dharmaśrībhadra and the chief editor-translator, the monk Rinchen Zangpo.

Translator's Notes

• In the fourth verse, □□□□□□□□□ ("fruit-effort") is read as □□□□□□□□, "labor, effort." In the closing prose, □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□ □□□□, "and now." The lord of elephants story follows the tradition in which King Prabhāsa first resolved on awakening on seeing an untamable elephant in rut.
• Among the six proclaimers, the names rendered Illusion-Crosser (□□□□□□□□□), Ear-Striker (□□□□□□□□) and Endowed with Goodness (□□□□□□□) could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning; likewise, among the six attainers of absorption, the brahmin youth All-Victorious (□□□□□□□□) and the sage Free of Afflictions (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□). Puṣkarasārin (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and Lohita (□□□□□□) are probable identifications with the brahmins known in Pāli as Pokkharasāti and Lohicca.
• The tree called □□□□□□□□□ is taken as the aśoka (usually □□□□□□□□□); other versions of the story name a plakṣa or śāla tree. The wanderer □□□□□□□ is translated by meaning as Red-Eyes, since no Sanskrit form can be identified with confidence.
• "It is the nature of things" renders the recurring formula □□□□□□□□□□□□ (dharmatā), meaning this is what invariably happens at the birth of every bodhisattva. Kauśika is Śakra's clan name, used here in address. The Tibetan □□□, rendered "membranes," most likely refers to the afterbirth. In the verse on the bath, the nāgas' offering is grammatically to the lineage (or to him, within it); the meaning is that the nāgas honored the bodhisattva's family. □□□□□□□□ is rendered generically as "incense"; the exact substance (possibly tagara) is uncertain.
• The kings and princes named here follow the account of the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya: Aranemi Brahmadatta (father of Prasenajit), Mahāpadma (father of Bimbisāra, whose mother was Bimbī), Śatānīka (father of Udayana), and Anantanemi (father of Pradyota). The Tibetan for Brahmadatta's epithet, literally "flying by spokes," is taken as a rendering of Aranemi,

"spoke-rimmed"; this identification is probable rather than certain. The name explanations are puns in the Indic originals that do not carry fully into English. The closing sentence is an abbreviation formula indicating that the soothsayers' declaration is to be understood in full as given earlier.

• "The lord of riches" renders □□□□□□□, literally "the Wealthy One," taken as an epithet of the god of wealth; the exact figure intended is uncertain. "The sacred verses" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, here the brahmanical treatises on bodily marks rather than Buddhist mantras. The refrain literally reads "this is the great man's mark of a great man of the prince," repeated after each mark. Some marks are grouped together under a single refrain, so the count of refrains does not equal thirty-two.

• The verse line "with few troubles, and wise" is compressed in the Tibetan; it may describe the king's sons rather than the king himself. The verse phrase rendered "born of karma" is literally "arisen from karma, with karma," an awkward doubling in the Tibetan.

• The sage's name, □□□□□□□□□□□□ (literally "Free of Afflictions"), is taken as this text's rendering of Asita, since the episode, including his nephew Naradatta, is the well-known story of Asita's visit to the infant Buddha. The mountain □□□□□□□□ is translated literally as "Mount All-Bearing"; it is not identified with confidence, though parallel accounts place Asita on the Vindhya or in the Himalaya. "The deathless" renders □□□□□□□□ (amṛta), meaning nirvāṇa.

• The writing master's name, Tibetan "Worm Armor," and the archery master or masters "Good Taker and With the Gods," could not be confidently identified with Sanskrit names in this version of the story, so they are translated literally; the Tibetan may denote either one master or two. The "kettledrums" render an uncertain instrument name. "Fast" renders the poṣadha observance.

• The tree called Essence of Virtue is translated literally, since its Sanskrit name could not be confidently identified. □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Suprabuddha, the Śākya elder known from the Buddha's family. The phrase "to be told at length" renders an abbreviation formula: the Tibetan text cuts the archery episode short.

• The Elephant Pit renders the Tibetan "elephant hollow," known in Sanskrit sources as Hastigarta. The "working estates" render □□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. karmānta), the royal farmlands.

• □□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□ are taken as Gopikā and Mṛgajā, the bodhisattva's wives known from the Vinaya account. Their fathers' names, the Śākya "Good Time" and the Śākya "Bell Sound," could not be confidently identified with Sanskrit forms and are translated literally. The second group of four verse lines appears to be the narrator's voice rather than Mṛgajā's. Mṛgajā's verse plays on the word nirvṛta, which means both "blissful, at peace" and "having attained nirvāṇa."

• In the first verse, the phrase rendered "not set his mind on leaving" (bdag ngor mi gzhug) is obscure; the sense is clearly the king's aim of keeping the prince absorbed in pleasures so that he would not renounce, but the literal wording is uncertain. "What is beneficial" (don) and "what is wholesome" (dge legs) render two items in the list of goods that are close in meaning; the Sanskrit parallels list such terms as artha and kuśala.

• In the prophecy verse, □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "without punishment," the classic description of a wheel-turning monarch who rules without rod or sword, rather than the glossary's doctrinal sense of annihilation. In Mahāprajāpatī's dream, □□□□□□ ("sweepings, refuse") and the clause about seeing herself outside weeping and laughing for an instant are rendered literally; the omens are terse and their exact imagery is somewhat uncertain. In Śuklodana's verse, □□□□□□ is taken as the measure (droṇa) of liquor drunk; it may also be a wordplay on Droṇodana's name.

• In the first of the five dreams, the Tibetan reads only "he made the great one his bed"; "the great earth" is supplied from context and from the parallel accounts of this dream. The grass "called Upright" (□□□□□□□) is translated literally because its Sanskrit name cannot be identified

with confidence. The clause about the white, black-headed birds ("could be seen up as far as his kneecaps") is terse and its exact sense is uncertain. In the bodhisattva's reply, □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "encircled by a net" (reading rgya, net), the lord of beasts being the lion.
• In two verses the Tibetan reads □□□□□□□□□; □ is taken as a slip for □ ("sickness"), giving the standard triad old age, sickness and death. Likewise □□□□□□□□□□ ("people will ...") is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "will wake up." The four sons of the gods are rendered by meaning where the name cannot be confidently identified: "Sprout" (□□□□□□), "Radiant" (□□□□□□□□□□) and "Leaf-Clad" (□□□□□□□□□□); Maṅkura is a transcription. The phrase □□□□□□□□□ after Mahānāman's verse to the king is obscure and is rendered by sense ("so he said, but").
• The city reached after twelve leagues, □□□□□□, is rendered by meaning as "Peerless," since its Sanskrit name cannot be fixed with confidence. □□□□□□ is the standard Tibetan rendering of Kubera. In Chandaka's verse the forest is said to be "full of herdsmen" (□□□□□□□□□), which reads oddly beside lions and tigers but is translated as written.
• The sage's name □□□□□□□ ("one who shuns evil") could not be identified with confidence as the rendering of a known Sanskrit name, so it is translated by meaning as "Shunner of Evil". The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "a renowned brahmin", is literally "a brahmin possessing sound"; it may instead be a place or clan name. The sentence "From 'In the city of Peerless...' up to 'ten sons were born to him'" is the text's own abbreviation formula, referring to a stock narrative not written out here. The bodhisattva's instruction to Chandaka not to lead Kaṇṭhaka into the palace is given as the Tibetan has it.
• In the verse line ending □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the word □□ ("man") makes little sense; the reading □□ ("fire") gives the well-known simile of a fire never sated by fuel, and has been translated as "a fire fed with wood in the scorching heat of summer". In the final verse, □□□□□□□□□□ is taken in the sense "to where it delights", in line with the parallel verse of the Pabbajjā Sutta. □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered Ikṣvāku and □□□□□□□□□□ "the solar clan" (Ādityagotra). The aims of the sages, "to be Śakra, Brahmā, or Māra", are elliptical in the Tibetan ("Śakra himself", and so on).
• "The market town of the community of Uruvilvā Kāśyapa" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it corresponds to the town of Senāni at Uruvilvā in other accounts. In the teachers' invitations, the phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; □□□ ("heard") has been taken loosely and the sense "we are alike" given. As the Tibetan stands, Udraka himself, rather than his father Rāma, claims the attainment.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the meditations of swelling", corresponds to the breathless meditations (āsphānaka) of the Sanskrit biographies. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken in the sense of the familiar formula "the painful feeling did not overpower his mind and remain".
• □□□□□□, here rendered "a mere handful", corresponds to the Pāli formula "a little, by the handful". In the list of single grains, the text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("a single fruit"); the parallel list in the following passage has □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("a single grain of rice"), which has been followed. The identifications of the pulses (□□□□□□□□ chickpea, □□□□□□□ pea, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ lentil, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ mung bean) are approximate.
• The phrase rendered "pining for him all the more" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; the sense of longing is inferred from context. The line about Yaśodharā's womb reflects the tradition, found in Mūlasarvāstivāda sources, that her pregnancy with Rāhula was arrested during the bodhisattva's six years of austerity; the wording (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is terse and the rendering is interpretive. In the second simile the Tibetan reads literally "is (□□□) fully brought to an end in their minds and remains," which contradicts the argument (these practitioners still cannot awaken); it is translated according to the evident sense, as still present and not brought to an end, probably a slip for a negated form. The text as it stands gives the same image (wet wood taken out of the water) for both the first and second similes;

this is kept as written.
• The town □□□□□□ (literally "having an army") is identified with Senānī, the village near Uruvilvā known from parallels (Pāli Senānigama); the identification is likely but not certain. The wandering ascetic □□□□□□□ is given as Upaga, the standard equivalent of this Tibetan rendering. The name of the medicine (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is translated by meaning as "Strength-Giving." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is unclear; "dried his robes" is a contextual guess. The attendants who leave are the five companions of the bodhisattva's austerities, not named in this passage.
• The nāga king □□□□□□ is given as Kālika, the name he bears in Sanskrit accounts of this episode. The grass seller □□□□□□□ is Svastika, as in the Sanskrit tradition. The phrase rendered "dried your robes" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure, as in the previous passage, and the rendering is a contextual guess.
• The verb in "the Śākyas have been subjugated" (□□□□□) is uncertain; it may mean they have been overpowered or plundered. The phrase rendered "Your hope ... is vain" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is idiomatic and the rendering follows the evident sense. In the final sentence "as a bird does upon the ground" reads the evident □□□□□□□□□□ for the written □□□□□□□□□, a copyist's slip.
• Of Māra's three daughters, □□□□□□ is the standard rendering of Tṛṣṇā ("Craving"). The other two, □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□, do not match the usual Tibetan forms of the familiar names (Rati, Arati, Rāgā) with confidence, so they are translated literally as "Delight-Maker" and "Delight-Enjoyer". In the final section, □□□□□□ is the common noun "desire," not the name Chandaka.
• The names explained here depend on their Tibetan meanings: Rāhula is rendered as "Seized by Rāhu," matching the eclipse at his birth, and Ānanda as "Joy," matching the city's rejoicing. The last line of Māra's speech in verse may also be read as "He will surely remove it from you." I have translated □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□ as two classes of wandering mendicants, carakas and parivrājakas.
• The opening sentence continues from the previous piece: Yaśodharā, distressed by Śuddhodana's doubt, sets her son on a stone. "□□□□□" is unclear; I have read it as "the size of the bodhisattva's lap," but it might mean the stone's weight or another measure. The food the merchants offer, □□□□□□, is uncertain; "barley meal" follows the barley preparation and honey of the parallel accounts of Trapuṣa and Bhallika.
• The last verse of the rejoicing is compressed. I read "rnam par mthong" as the clear seeing (insight) that ends suffering, which the generous person "touches" or attains. The second mention of the barley meal is spelled □□□□□□, a variant of □□□□□□ in the previous line, and is taken as the same food.
• The illness is called a "chill" (bser ma) in Śakra's speech and a "wind disorder" (rlung nad) in the narration; the text treats them as the same complaint, and both terms are kept.
• In the refrain of the opening verses, □□□□□ renders Sanskrit brāhmaṇa in its sense of the true brahmin, the accomplished practitioner, as in the parallel Udāna verses; it is not the god Brahmā here. In the lotus simile, the Tibetan says the flowers "rise from the water" and then lists those level with it and those submerged; it is read as the usual threefold division. The word □□□□ in "highest respect" is taken in the sense of honoring or respecting, in line with the parallels in which the teacher honored the Bodhisattva; the form is unusual. The speech beginning "Venerable One, among the beings born in the world" has no stated speaker, but the humble verbs and the request mark it as Brahmā Sahāṃpati's entreaty.
• "Yesterday evening" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, an unusual expression read in the light of the following sentence ("died in the evening") and the parallels. The phrase about the seat the five monks planned to offer, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is obscure; it is taken as a seat simply set out, without the courtesy of rising. "The yoga of abandoning suffering" translates the Tibetan literally; it refers to the Bodhisattva's period of ascetic striving, when the five attended him.

• In the five monks' reply, □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□ ("if ... then now"), which the sentence plainly requires. In the eightfold path, □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□, "right speech," an evident scribal slip. The unattributed question about the Tathāgata's complexion is the Blessed One's reply to the five monks.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the Harmful River," is taken as the Varaṇā, the river at Vārāṇasī named in the parallel accounts of Yaśas. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "head of the family," is understood as the guild master (śreṣṭhin) who is Yaśas's father in the parallels. The phrase describing the sleeping women, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is obscure; "slack and drooling" follows the sense of the parallel descriptions.
• "I have gone beyond; I have gone utterly beyond" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the stock exclamation of a new convert (Skt. abhikrānto 'haṃ bhadanta abhikrāntaḥ); here □□□□ is the verb "to go beyond, excel," not the noun "noble one." In the verse, □□□□ means punishment or the rod (Skt. daṇḍa, "having laid down the rod toward all beings"), not annihilation, and □□□□□□□□ means beings in general (Skt. bhūta), not a class of spirits. "Beyond training" and "in training" render □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ (aśaikṣa, śaikṣa): the arhat versus the stream-enterer and other trainees. The father's line reads □□□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as the usual □□□□□ "realized."
• □□□□□ is rendered "former wife," since Yaśas has by now gone forth as a monk. In the guild master's request, "to where the guild master lives" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□: the householder is speaking of himself in the third person and inviting the Buddha to his house. □□□□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is a double negative ("not not supreme"), rendered "can surely be no ordinary one." The four friends are named with the usual Sanskrit forms: □□□□□ Pūrṇa, □□□□□□□ Vimala, □□□□□□□□ Gavāṃpati, □□□□□□□ Subāhu. They are listed as the "second" to "fifth" sons, counting Yaśas as the first to go forth.
• "The unsurpassed culmination of the pure life" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

rendering keeps the abbreviation as it stands.
• The phrase "phye ma red (du / nang du)" before "rising from seclusion" is obscure; it is taken here as a time expression, "in the late afternoon," matching the parallel narratives in which the Buddha rises from seclusion toward evening. In the second meal episode the text again has "great monk" for "great renunciant," read as a copyist's slip. The sentence on the four forests is an abbreviation indicating that the same episode is repeated with fruits from each.
• The final phrase "mi grags pa dang ldan pa shes nyen can" is taken as "a person of renown, well known and well connected," reading "nyen" for "gnyen" (kin, connections); the general sense, that a teacher with many followers should consult them first, is clear.
• The text once reads "che dang ldan pa," evidently a slip for "tshe dang ldan pa," "venerable," as in the parallel sentence. The phrase "lan gnyis kyi bar du" ("twice") in the brothers' reflection is rendered as it stands; it may refer to Uruvilvā Kāśyapa's two requests for ordination.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the miracle of reading minds (ādeśanā-prātihārya), and the passage that follows it is a version of the Fire Sermon (Ādittapariyāya). In the description of the wheel-turning king's rule, □□□□ means punishment (Skt. daṇḍa, "the rod"), not annihilation; the phrase parallels the stock Sanskrit formula "without punishment and without the sword" (adaṇḍena aśastreṇa). □□□□□□□ ("shrink back, take care") is rendered as a warning, "be on your guard." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the king's paid men or servants. The repeated cross-references ("and so on as above") abbreviate the prophecy given in full earlier and are rendered as such.
• The grove □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is identified as the Yaṣṭivana (Pāli Laṭṭhivana) by the Sanskrit and Pāli parallels, which place the Buddha at the Supratiṣṭha shrine in that grove near Rājagṛha; the Tibetan name itself is unusual, so this identification rests on the parallel. In the man's report the text once has "the shrine of Gayā" rather than "the shrine of Gayāśīrṣa"; it is translated as written. The courtesy questions (free from ailment, free from affliction, living in comfort) follow the standard Vinaya greeting formula.
• In the king's reply "if that is so, let them be released," □□□□ is the verb "take out, release" (future of □□□□), not the noun for a seizing spirit. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "those who have shared in deeds with you," that is, people bound to the king by common karma. In Kāśyapa's verses □□□□□□, here rendered "aggregates," corresponds in the parallels to upadhi, the substrata of existence. □□□□ in "sacrifices, observances and fires" is taken as the honorific word for fire. The line "seen and accepted the unconditioned state" reads the somewhat unclear □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally. The final instruction, □□□□□□□□□□□□□, corresponds to Sanskrit saṃvejaya, "rouse to a sense of urgency."
• The list of terms for a self (self, sentient being, life principle, one who is born, nourisher, person, one born of Manu, son of Manu, and so on) renders the standard Sanskrit series ātman, sattva, jīva, jantu, poṣa, pudgala, manuja, mānava, kāraka, kārāpaka, and so on. The brahmins' thought describes the self as something "which never came into being and will not come into being and yet exists even now", that is, an uncreated, permanent self. The Buddha's reply denies that such a thing exists now. In the reply the text mentions only "evil deeds", where the brahmins' version has "virtuous and evil deeds"; both are translated as written. "Linking up" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is rebirth-linking (pratisaṃdhi).
• In "the abandonment of all aggregates", □□□□□□ corresponds in the parallels to upadhi, the substrata of existence. The king's exclamation "I have gone beyond; I have truly gone beyond" renders □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, matching the Sanskrit formula abhikrānto 'haṃ bhadanta abhikrāntaḥ. The list of qualities for form omits "coarse or subtle", which the list for the other aggregates includes; both are translated as written. □□□□□□□□ is taken as the first-person plural "we", so "whichever of us". The names Sañjayin, Upatiṣya (later Śāriputra), and Kolita (later Maudgalyāyana) follow the standard identifications of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□,

□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□.
• The phrase rendered "known and recognized among the people" (mi grags pa dang ldan pa … shes par gyur pa) is read with mi as "people", i.e. "renowned among people", matching the Sanskrit parallels (jñātā abhijñātāḥ); read as a negative ("unknown") it would contradict the reasoning. The opening word of that exchange (rje) is taken as "first".
• The size of the following reads literally "two hundred fifty, fifty"; it is taken as "two hundred and fifty", the traditional number of Upatiṣya's and Kolita's disciples, the extra "fifty" being apparently a repetition. In the Blessed One's instruction the result of reciting the verse ("will vanish") is given in a past form in the Tibetan, which is read as the anticipated outcome.
• In the Blessed One's instructions to Udāyin, rgyal po'i khab is read in its literal sense, "the king's residence, the royal palace" in Kapilavastu, not the city Rājagṛha, since Udāyin is going to Kapilavastu and is told to wait at its gate. In the Buddha's verses (parallel to Dhammapada 179 to 180), the "queen of sense objects" renders yul gyi rgyal mo literally; the Pāli parallel speaks instead of craving as an ensnaring net, and the Tibetan image is uncertain.
• As in the preceding piece, rgyal po'i khab is read here as "the royal palace" or "royal residence" in Kapilavastu, not the city Rājagṛha. The phrase rendered "fell to the ground in a faint" reads brgya la nas sa la 'gyel ba; brgya la is taken as an idiom of sudden collapse, which the sprinkling with water and reviving confirm.
• The proud Śākyas' imagined complaint is compressed in the Tibetan; ltog po zhig grub pa is taken as "achieved only an empty belly", i.e. nothing but hunger from his austerities, and the following clauses as contrasting how such a one should arrive (through the sky, attended by multitudes) with his coming on foot. In Śuddhodana's verse, the three bows are taken as the present one together with the two earlier occasions the verse names, at the birth and under the jambu tree, as the king's prose explanation goes on to recount.
• The text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which makes no sense here; the evident reading is □□□□□□, "bowl, basin", translated "bowls of gold." Similarly □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "wearing a garment." In the two bathing verses the text has □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("those of virtue who touch it") in the first and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("those endowed with knowledge") in the second; each is translated as written, though the parallel verse elsewhere (Pāli vedagū, "knowers") suggests the second reading is the original in both. The king is addressed as Gautama, his clan name. The ten abodes of the noble ones are the ten āryavāsas.
• The grove □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated literally as "Encircled by Brahmā," since its Indian name could not be identified with confidence. In the Buddha's instruction to Maudgalyāyana the text reads □□□□□□□□ ("consider!"); the context and the reply show that □□□□□□□□, "go!", is meant, and it is translated so. □□□□□□□ is a madder or crimson red.
• The list of the Four Great Kings at the gates names the guardian of the north as Kubera (□□□□□□□□□), while the following dialogue at the northern gate names him Vaiśravaṇa (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□); the two are commonly identified, and each is given as the text has it. The view of the perishable collection is satkāyadṛṣṭi, the view that takes the aggregates to be a self; its twenty peaks are the twenty forms of that view.
• Droṇodana here says seventy-six thousand Śākyas saw the truth with him in the grove called Encircled by Brahmā, whereas the earlier narrative gave sixty-six thousand; each figure is translated as the text gives it. "Music played without men" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the standard phrase for music performed entirely by women. The Śākya king □□□□□□□ is identified as Bhadrika.
• The pratyekabuddha □□□□□□□, to whom Aniruddha offered alms in a former life, could not be identified with confidence; the name is translated literally as "All-Knowing." In the bed-maker episode the text once reads □□□□□□□ for □□□□□□□□, "bed-maker," and is translated accordingly.
• The opening sentence continues Devadatta's private reasoning from the preceding piece; the closing "sñam nas" shows it as his thought before he speaks. □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□ are taken

as two names, Kaṭamoraka and Tiṣya, as the list separates them with □□; in Sanskrit sources this companion of Devadatta is often a single figure, Kaṭamorakatiṣyaka. The syllables □□□□□ in the Blessed One's reflection make no sense as written and are read as "therefore I" (as if □□□□□□□□). □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "his eyes." The phrase "those who will not would think otherwise" is rendered literally; it seems to mean that those not destined to please would fall short of the 'Come, monk' ordination, which is reserved for those in their final existence.

• The "floods" and "yokes" are the standard sets of four oghas and four yogas (sensual desire, existence, views and ignorance). In the third sentence of the Blessed One's command, the Tibetan □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "he is your senior," since Upāli was ordained first.

• □□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□, "sharing the same lot." □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□, "unimpaired," as in the parallel sentence later in the passage. The phrase about the Blessed One's back follows the familiar Vinaya motif in which the Buddha, citing back pain, hands a discourse over to a disciple.

• □□□□□ is taken as the karṇikāra flower, its usual Sanskrit equivalent; □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the kadamba tree. Both are golden or yellow blossoms, which suits the comparison of color. The cries of "Get away from before me!" are rendered literally; the point of the narrative is that these old phrases survive in later speech without their meaning being understood.

• The naming of the "house" rests on a wordplay in the Indic original (Sanskrit agāra, "house," heard as a place for what is "not to be done," akaraṇīya); the Tibetan keeps the explanation but not the pun. The sentence "This came about in accordance with what is right …" reflects the refrain of the Sanskrit Vinaya version of this origin story, "by Dharma, not by non-Dharma"; its last clause, "in the Dharma of the Lord of Victors this is what is foremost," is rendered as the Tibetan stands. The syllable □ before □□□□□□□□□□□ is treated as a stray letter. The piece ends in the middle of the beings' recollection, which continues in the next piece.

• The names the people bore in successive reigns (beings, come here, the marked ones, cloud-throats, palm-trunks) are translated literally from the Tibetan, since their Indian equivalents could not be identified with confidence. The refrain "through Dharma, not through what is contrary to Dharma" echoes the Aggañña-sutta formula; the Tibetan here has "in the Dharma of the Lord of Victors," translated as it stands. The kṣatriya and rājan etymologies rest on Sanskrit wordplay (protecting fields from harm; delighting the people).

• "Mind-born" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, the folk etymology of mānava (from manas) found in the parallel Vinaya accounts. In the genealogy the Tibetan, read strictly, makes Cāru the son of Māndhātṛ, Upacāru the son of Cāru, and the long list that follows the descendants of Upacāru (the possessive with a list joined by "and"); the narrative above it makes Upacāru, Cārumat and Upacārumat successive generations, so the list is best taken as a succession of kings. Several names in it could not be identified with confidence and are translated from their meaning: Relinquisher, Relinquisher-Holder, Aṅga-Chariot, Evil-Shunner, Son of Sāgara, Well-Attained, Great Well-Attained, Light-Maker, Hero, Possessed of Meru, Having Meru, Ray, Rayed, Having Rays, All-Around Ray, and Victor over the Unvanquished. □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Potala and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as Ayodhyā ("unassailable by armies").

• Many of the kings and cities in this genealogy are given in the Tibetan only in translation and could not be identified with confidence; these are rendered by their meaning: Hard to Bear, Elephant-Given, Woolen-Robed, Lying-on-the-Breast, Tamer of Great Elephants, Palm Garland, Dispeller of Darkness, Practitioner of Austerities, Face of the Earth, Lord of the Earth, Held by Kings, Middling, Digger, Near Digger, Possessed of Digging, All-Around Digger, Splendid Appearance, Realization, Great Realization, Army of Realization, Steadfast Army, Fool-Slayer, Dawn, Generator, All-Around Generator, Bull among Men, Provider of Food and Drink, Provider of Abundant Food and Drink, Abiding, Well-Abiding, Rider of Great Strength, Good Intellect, Steady Rider, Victorious Bow and Victorious Chariot. Mahādeva here is a king of Mithilā (the Makhādeva of the Pāli tradition), not the god Śiva. The Tibetan reads "Gautama, these"

(□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and "Gautama and" (□□□□□□□□□□) in two places, evidently slips for the recurring address "Gautamas" (□□□□□□□□□□), and is translated so.
• The city □□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is rendered by its meaning, "All-Illuminating." The king □□□□□□□ ("the one with ears") is given as Karṇa, the name the parallel Vinaya accounts appear to have; the courtesan's lover □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("lotus root") is taken as Mṛṇāla, and the sage □□□□□□□□ ("dark-hued") as Kṛṣṇavarṇa. The second mention of the coin spells it □□□□□□□□□, evidently a slip for kārṣāpaṇa.
• The renaming of the sage from Kṛṣṇavarṇa ("Dark-Hued") to Golden-Hued (Tibetan □□□□□□□□□, perhaps Suvarṇavarṇa) rests on the change of his skin color, so the new name is given in English. □□□□□□□□□□□ ("born from the limbs") is taken as Āṅgirasa and □□□□□□□□□□□ ("of the sugarcane") as Ikṣvāku, the clan names the Buddhist tradition explains in this way. The Tibetan here spells the sage's name □□□□□□□, a variant of □□□□□□□□.
• The four sons are identified from the parallel lineage account of the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya (Ulkāmukha, Karakarṇin, Hastinika, Nūpura). The youngest prince's name, literally "Delight in Kingship," is translated rather than given a reconstructed Sanskrit form, which could not be confirmed. Several evident scribal slips are read in context: □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□ ("gentlemen"), □□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□ ("eight months"), and □□□□□□□□□□□ as "have no child at all." The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is taken as "the finest of matches."
• The river □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the Bhāgīrathī, and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is Kapilavastu, whose name the text explains as "Kapila's site." The second city, □□□□□□□□, is translated literally as "Shown by the Gods" since its Sanskrit form could not be confirmed. The closing exchange turns on □□□ ("to dare, be capable"), which the next passage develops into the etymology of the Śākya name (Skt. śakya, "able"). The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered loosely as "I have seen enough"; it may simply be a formula of leave-taking.
• The Śākya name is explained here from □□□□□, "capable, daring" (Skt. śakya). Several names are translated literally because their Sanskrit forms could not be confirmed: □□□□□□□□ ("Abode Founder"), □□□□□□ ("Earth House"; the following □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□), and the sons of the four daughters other than Suprabuddha: □□□□□□□□□ ("Garlanded"), □□□□□□□ ("Taker of Good") and □□□□□□□□ ("Increase of Virtue"). Śuklodana's son □□□□ is identified as Tiṣya following the parallel lineage in the Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya; this is less certain. Mahāmaudgalyāyana's discourse on the Śākya lineage, which has been running as a long quotation, closes with Rāhula, and the sūtra's frame narration resumes.
• The two sisters' names are explained from □□□□□□□□□□, "illusion" (Skt. māyā), so the meaning is given once beside each name. The hostile mountain people □□□□□□□□ ("pale and gaunt") are identified as the Pāṇḍavas, as in the parallel Mūlasarvāstivāda Vinaya account; this rests on the parallel. The exchange about breaking the Śākya law is terse, and its assignment to speakers is inferred. The title is rendered from the Sanskrit Abhiniṣkramaṇa ("going forth, great departure").

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.